Avatar: The Last Hope

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/30595007.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/F

Fandoms:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018), Avatar: The Last Airbender

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Angella/Micah (She-Ra), Mermista/Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Perfuma/Scorpia (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Micah, Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Frosta (She-Ra), Netossa (She-Ra), Spinnerella (She-Ra), Castaspella (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Horde Prime (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Avatar & Benders Setting, Canon Lesbian Relationship, Useless Lesbians, Trauma, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder - PTSD, SPOP x ATLA, spop set in the atla universe because why not, Firebender Catra, Avatar Adora, Drama & Romance, Slow Burn, Sexual Tension, Enemies to Friends to Lovers, Friends to Enemies, Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner's A+ Parenting, Daddy Prime - Freeform, Daddy Issues, Mommy Issues, Trust Issues, Princess Catra (She-Ra), adora - Freeform, Smut

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of SPOP x ATLA/TLOK AU

Collections:
Banco Fic

Stats:
Published: 2021-04-10 Completed: 2021-08-04 Words: 82,087 Chapters: 15/15

Avatar: The Last Hope

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/30595007.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/F

Fandoms:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018), Avatar: The Last Airbender

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Angella/Micah (She-Ra), Mermista/Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Perfuma/Scorpia (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Micah, Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Frosta (She-Ra), Netossa (She-Ra), Spinnerella (She-Ra), Castaspella (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Horde Prime (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Avatar & Benders Setting, Canon Lesbian Relationship, Useless Lesbians, Trauma, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder - PTSD, SPOP x ATLA, spop set in the atla universe because why not, Firebender Catra, Avatar Adora, Drama & Romance, Slow Burn, Sexual Tension, Enemies to Friends to Lovers, Friends to Enemies, Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner's A+ Parenting, Daddy Prime - Freeform, Daddy Issues, Mommy

Issues, Trust Issues, Princess Catra (She-Ra), adora - Freeform, Smut

Language:
English

Series:
Part 1 of SPOP x ATLA/TLOK AU

Collections:
Banco Fic

Stats:
Published: 2021-04-10 Completed: 2021-08-04 Words: 82,087
Chapters: 15/15

Avatar: The Last Hope

by etheriastribe

Summary

Catra, princess of the Fire Nation, ran away from home five years ago wtih Scorpia, Entrapta and Melog. When things go extremely bad, she's forced to team up with her former childhood bestfriend -Avatar Adora- and her lousy friends in order to get the people she loves back and defeat Fire Lord Prime.

Promise?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes



“You can have it, I’m full.” Catra said once Scorpia offered her a possum chicken that a girl –Perfuma, if remembered correctly-

gifted them before their departure from the foggy swamp. It smelled terribly, so of course Catra was going to pass on that one.

"Okay. But can you lit up a fire up for me so I can at least cook it?" The tall woman asked with her usual gentle tone. Catra sighed and grabbed a fire striker to start a fire. She carefully stroked the flint against the steel, generating sparks that eventually lit up the dry wood.

"You know you could've just used your-"

"You know it takes a lot of my energy to produce fire. Besides, it's dangerous. What if someone is watching us? It's better to just not risk it." It was late at night and they were in the middle of nowhere, as always.
That had been their life for the past five years, but it was worth it, for the most part at least. The downside of it all was constantly moving from one place to another, never stopping. Who knew your horrible father cared so much for you that he'd send a search party over all four nations to look for you? Definitely not Catra, daughter of Fire Lord Prime.

Knowing him though, it was all an act. He had never cared for her, not even once. In fact, he only spoke to her to remind her of her failures as a bastard daughter and fire bender, if she could even be called as such.

Catra had always had problems with her bending; it was chaotic, unpredictable, explosive, anything but controlled and gracious. Not even the Royal Fire Academy for Girls managed to help with the problems, so Catra just gave up on her bending abilities, focusing on martial arts, swordsmanship and everything that might've helped her in battle, armed or disarmed.

Nothing compared to her former ex best friend: Adora. Everything came to her naturally, perfectly easily, but of course, that was one of the advantages of being the *Avatar*.

“You should’ve eaten that; it was absolutely delicious!” Scorpia recalled with a happy sigh once she had finished the food. Always so happy and relaxed, no matter how tight in a spot they were in, she always found the good side of things. Catra *wanted* that kind moral support, *needed* it even.

“Honestly? It smelled horrible. I wouldn’t have eaten that in a million years. Besides, that girl gave it to you specifically. I really wonder why...” She replied with a teasing smirk once the fire burned down. Now it was fully dark, their tents behind them and Melog sleeping peacefully on the sandy ground, their purrs filling the growing silence.

“Don’t be like that. She was just being nice to me, that’s all. She’s really awesome. Are we going back to the swamp?”

“Scorp, we just got out of there. Also, that place gives me the creeps.”

“Maybe someday?”

Catra looked at her companion, she seemed to really enjoy that place, but it wasn’t worth risking their safety. “Someday.” She whispered. It was a blatant lie, but at least it would’ve made her friend feel better about it, and it totally did.

“Hey, how about I teach you lightning bending?” At that question, the brunette glared at her in suspicion. She had never proposed it before.

“Why?”

“I figured, well, maybe you’re just like me. You can’t firebend but you can do something else? Maybe lightning or combustion, we have to try.”

“It’s too-”

“We’ll go up that hill and try there. I’m sure that nobody’s here. Pretty please?”

Saying no to those pleading eyes was becoming harder and harder for Catra, especially after Entrapta's... departure. She made her best efforts to distract Scorpia from it, and apparently that meant trying to bend lightning for the first time.

"Ugh, okay. We'll try for an hour max. If I can't do it then we'll drop the matter and accept that I'm an incapable firebender."

"Okay, first of all: you're not, you just need to find something that works for you. Second: let's go!"

"It's not fueled by rage or emotion; the way other fire bending is. Some call lightning the 'cold-blooded fire'. It's precise and deadly. To perform the technique requires peace of mind." Scorpia explained once they were on top of the relatively short hill. It took them only half an hour to get up there. Ahead of them were miles and miles of sand, no trace of soldiers. They were safe.

"There is energy all around us. The energy is both ying and yang. Positive energy and negative energy. Only selected few firebenders can separate these energies. This creates and imbalance; the energy wants to restore balance and, in the moment, the positive and negative energy come crashing back together. You provide release and guidance, creating lightning." Scorpia explained patiently, but Catra scoffed away the thoughtful lesson.

"Yeah, yeah. Spiritual things. Can you show me now?" The short-haired woman proceeded to make a circular motion with her arms, already creating sparks and then a bolt came out of her right claw and short right through the sky. Catra took in all the

movements and shift in breathing in from her friend and took mental notes to relax.

“Awesome, I’m ready to try!”

“Remember: once you separate the energy, you do not command it. You are simply its’ humble guide. Breathe first.” And she did. Catra followed all the movements, all the breathing exercise she previously saw, but instead of producing lightning she produced an explosion instead. It wasn’t a big one, but it was enough to make her fall backwards.

“Wildcat, are you okay?” The short woman painfully stood back up and got ready to repeat the process again. She was too fixated to learn this new technique.

“Did you separate the two energies like I told you to?”

To be honest, Catra had no idea what she was talking about when it came to spirituality, energies and ying and yang or peace of mind. At that point she worked on auto-pilot; get to a place, live there for a while, leave before it’s too late. Calm and peace weren’t exactly on top of her list.

“Y-Yes. Let me try again! I’ll get it right this time.”

She didn’t. Explosion after explosion, hour after hour, she kept failing. She had spent so much time she didn’t even notice Scorpia leaving the hill to go to sleep in the compound until her friend came back for her.

“You seriously spent all night trying?”

“I’m gonna succeed this time, I swear.” She said weakly, her legs barely holding her up. She went with the motions once again but Scorpia easily picked her up over her shoulders.
Catra was too tired to fight and just let it be.

They had been travelling across the desert for weeks now. They weren't lost, Catra knew that for sure, but the water and food were getting scarcer with each passing day and if that wasn't enough, she had a feeling that something bad was bound to happen, like a sandstorm of something like that.

"How much time until we get to a city, or village? Scorpia always got whiny when she was tired, but Catra was already used to it by now.

"Two days to reach Full Moon Bay. I'm sure you'll get to rest there while I'll shop for some supplies."

At those words her travel companion gasped in surprise at a possible realization. "Full Moon Bay? Are we going to Ba Sing Se?" Catra chuckled and shook her head while she encouraged Melog to walk a little bit faster. If they kept going at that slow pace, they were going to reach their destination in four days instead.

"You mean the city our army has been trying to invade for years? The same place with both fire nation soldiers and earth kingdom soldiers that are looking for me? Not in a million years, Scorpia."

In that moment the brunette squinted her eyes as she saw a building on the distance. It seemed like a topmost spire, meaning that it was probably a building that got covered by sand with the course of the years. She decided to not pay much attention to it and instructed Melog to keep going ahead until a rustling sound got closer and closer.

"Sandbenders!" Scorpia announced excitedly. "I wonder if they'll give us some water and food." Well, it seemed like a good idea. They could buy a few resources from them.

The girls hopped off the polar cat and approached the group that stopped their sand-sailers once they were in front of them.

“Hello, we’re short on water and food! Could we exchange money for that?” Catra stayed quiet, eyeing all them one by one. None of them looked exactly friendly, in fact, their expressions were harsh and severe. She didn’t have a good feeling about it.

“Are you the Fire Nation’s princess?” One of the eight men asked, it was definitely a trap.

“Depends on who’s asking.” The air shifted immediately, becoming increasingly thicker.

“You know, we’re going to make a lot of money if we bring you back to the fire nation.” That was it. Catra pulled out her dual swords, ready to fight. Scorpia knew the procedure, and got on top of Melog, ready to leave if things got too bad. She didn’t like doing this, but that is what Catra ordered her to do as a future Fire Lord and not as her friend, so she had to obey whether she liked it or not.

“Sorry to disappoint but today’s not your lucky day.”

“Little girl, we’re eight against two. You’re clearly outnumbered here.”

Catra was ready to prove them wrong. She could easily take them down, she was sure of it. The woman gripped tightly her weapons and started charging at the leader until five silhouettes appeared in front of her.

“I don’t think so!” The voice didn’t sound familiar to her and since she was facing their backs, she couldn’t quite recognize who these people were.

She didn’t even have time to react before the sandbenders retired and ran away. Catra couldn’t help but feel a little burden inside of her. She had them. No help was needed. Especially not from some strangers who also happened to be benders. Although the action

lasted only a few seconds, she recognized three waterbenders, an airbender, an earthbender and a non-bender using a bow.

It wasn't until they turned around that Catra recognized all of them except for two people, but her eyes immediately caught Adora's. The blonde looked just as stunned as her.

"…Catra?" She asked weakly. But then Mermista chimed in.

"Catra? Nah, her name is Elizabeth." And then Perfuma.

"I think you mean Jessie." And then Frosta.

"Guys, her name is Carrie." *Great, just great*. All her years of travels and alter-egos finally caught up to her in a single moment. It felt like a nightmare. As if that wasn't enough, she found herself tied to a net that came out of one of the boy's arrows in less than a second.

"Fire Nation Princess. We have to bring her to Ba Sing Se! My mom will know what to do to her!" The lousy earthbender shouted in excitement. She definitely was new at the kidnapping thing.

"Glimmer, no! She's cool!" Perfuma vouched for her, but looked at Scorpia the whole time. "They're both cool.
They're just travelers."

Catra shot a death stare at *Glitter* that was quickly reciprocated, then her glaze fell back to Adora, this time she had a harsh expression on her face but her blue eyes showed a conflict happening inside of her.

"Perfuma, her name is Catra. She's the princess of the Fire Nation. Although, I have no idea as to why she's not reclused in the Royal Palace."

"A lot of things change in five years… *princess*." Adora's expression didn't change one bit at being called for her pet name from when they were kids, maybe Catra wasn't relevant anymore -if she ever was in the first place.

The blonde carefully approached her, slowly and steady. Once she touched the net Catra hissed, fearing for her life.

"It's okay. We're not going to hurt you." She reassured and started easing the woman out of the trap. Catra couldn't help but notice how much Adora had grown up since they last saw each other. She was buffer, her hair a little bit longer, but the blue eyes and the dimple on her right cheek were still very much the same. She was also more attractive, but that wasn't the right moment to think such things.

As soon as Catra was freed, she immediately stood back up, holding a pocket knife on her left hand.

"Catra, what are you doing here? Why are you not in the Fire Nation?" The brunette relaxed at the realization that they really weren't going to hurt her.

"I got bored and left. Scorpia came with me." The taller woman waved shyly, getting a bright smile from Perfuma in response.

"That's it?"

"Yeah." Catra shot a look at everyone else and sighed, she owed them an explanation.

"I know you're probably wondering why I didn't tell you my real identity, but to be honest it should be pretty obvious by now. I could've gotten you into some serious trouble if I didn't lie about who I was. I mean, all nations are looking for me."

"Why is why…" Glimmer proceeded to trap Catra in a pile of sand. She was starting to hate this Glitter girl. "We're bringing you over to Ba Sing Se."

"Do you really think it's a good idea? After all we just ran away from the city." A dark-skinned boy chimed in with worry.

"With the information regarding the solar eclipse and the princess of the Fire Nation? Oh Bow, I'm pretty sure my mom will welcome

us with open arms."

"I'm not the princess of the Fire Nation." Catra protested once Mermista tied her hands behind her back, she knew it was useless to fight against them. Scorpia, although in the same condition, found herself talking friendly with Perfuma, she looked *happy*.

"Then why there have been wanted posters of you scattered all throughout the four nations for the past week?"

"Wanted posters? Damn, looks like daddy started to really worry after all this time. It only took him five years."

"You've been away for *five* years?" Adora asked incredulously, she almost looked sad about it. Catra absolutely hated it, she didn't need pity.

"Yeah. I guess I'm pretty useless. You can't get any information out of me. I don't have anything. Let Scorpia and me go, now."

"I don't think so. We are going to find you a purpose, somehow." Glimmer replied bitterly. *Great, just great.*

Two days had passed and Catra refused any sort of aliment or shelter that was offered for her. For being kidnappers all of them were extremely nice, especially Bow, but she could bet all her money that it was just a manipulation tactic.

It was late at night. Scorpia was sleeping inside of Perfuma's tent with the swamp bender reassuring everyone that she'd keep an eye on the "prisoner".
Catra, on the other hand, was tied against a pole made out of sand that Glimmer built. It was solid -*too* solid- for an escape attempt.

It was cold, and she was both thirsty and hungry and watching Adora mindlessly eat some sort of tart in front of her wasn't exactly helping.

"You want some?" The blonde girl offered kindly after noticing the look in Catra's eyes, but she stayed quiet. She was not going to reply.

"It's an egg custard tart." At that Catra's ears twitched in delight. It was her favorite dish from the Earth Kingdom. "You like it?" Still no answer given. She couldn't show any weakness, except... when the food was sat right in front of her mouth, she couldn't help but hurriedly eat it, finishing the whole things with two big bites. Catra didn't want to do it, but her survival instincts forced her to and before she knew it, she had eaten two more and chugged on four whole bottles of water until she choked on it.

"Easy there, I still have more if you want, but you gotta slow down." Her body finally felt satisfied with the treatment, so Catra didn't answer and coughed a couple more times to free her lungs.

"I swear you're so stubborn that you won't even admit you're cold."

"I am fine." Catra replied aggressively, but her body still shook against the cold sand. Adora smiled once again and pulled out of a soft blanket that she wrapped around the brunette's body.

"There you go."

Catra couldn't hold it anymore. She was getting tired of that game. "Stop it." She whispered, it almost sounded like a plead, *almost.*

"Stop what?"

"Stop with this act. Stop acting nice, as if we weren't on opposite sides of war." Before Adora could call her out, she continued.

“Don’t think the Fire Lord doesn’t know about your little plan to dethrone him. He asked for your head after you declined his invitation to come back for the holidays.”

“We aren’t on different sides of war. You’ve escaped.”

“I’m not a traitor to the nation.” She spitted back; the words infectious like venom.

“Catra, the Fire Nation is bad. You don’t understand-”

“I’ve been travelling across the world for five years. You don’t think I already know that? But of course, go ahead and save everyone with your hero complex.”

“I am the Av-”

“You are Adora in the first place. Stop acting like your whole persona is the Avatar.” Adora was angry, Catra could see it. Even after all those years it wasn’t hard to notice her red face and a vein popping out of the tense neck.

“Leave me alone.” She ordered, but Adora scoffed and looked away from her.

“I wish I could, but I’m kinda stuck here making sure you won’t run away. Trust me, I have more interesting things to do than to babysit a brat like you. Tell me Catra, how’s your fire bending going, huh? Because from what I’ve seen you haven’t even tried to use it yet.”

Adora knew what she did, and had all the intentions to hit that particular nerve. Catra made her upset so she had the right to make her upset too, right? She tried being nice with the enemy, but if failed, so there was no other better solution than to treat her as such.

Catra was done with walking while being tied up, it was tiring and made her angrier with each passing moment, especially since Glimmer would tug on the rope to make her walk faster from time to time. The princess of Ba Sing Se was the only mean one, at least she was the only person who didn't put on an act.

And then... she heard heavy steps that she immediately recognized to be Komodo Rhinos. These were Fire Nation Soldiers looking for her.

"We're under attack!" She warned the others, but got shrugged off quickly. Of course, humans didn't have her same hearing. It wasn't until the group was surrounded by the enemy that they finally realized the situation they were in.

"Look at this show. The Earth Princess, the Avatar and Princess Catra all at the same place, what a wonderful sight." Admiral Hordak hopped off his steed with a smug smirk. Catra always hated him, he never showed kindness to anyone.

"And notice how you're tied up. Looks like you need saving."

"How did you find me?" Catra asked aggressively. Fire coming out of her nostrils to show her rage.

"It wasn't that hard to notice that lightning in the middle of the desert at night." That was how Catra knew she fucked up, *bad*. "We thought you'd be wiser than that. But now that we have you you're coming back to the palace and continue your training."

Fifty, there were fifty soldiers surrounding them: no way out.

"No way! She's coming with us to Ba Sing Se!" Glimmer spatted back. She had already dropped the rope on the sandy ground and assumed a fighting stance, ready to fight. Of course the others followed her movements except for the prisoners.

“How about we bring you and the Avatar with us too? I’m sure Fire Lord Prime will appreciate your visit.”

After a brief moment of silence, the action finally started.

Catra and Scorpia shared a knowing look before nodding to each other. While the others were busy fighting, the brunette took a deep breath and concentrated her energy on the fingertips of her left hand to create a fire dagger to burn the rope in an attempt to set her free. It took her multiple tries, but she eventually got it.

Catra then rushed to her friend’s side to help her out too.

“I thought that you-”

“They took away all my weapons, I have no other choice.” She hurriedly finished the sentence as Scorpia was finally freed.

“Know the procedure, get on Melog and be ready to escape.”

“I can help!” Scorpia insisted, but got ignored by the shorter woman, already in battle. They all were in a tight spot; clearly outnumbered. Mermista, Perfuma, Frosta, they were already on the ground while Bow and Glimmer were barely standing.
Even Adora -the Avatar- couldn’t fight anymore, which was weird. *She could simply use the Avatar state and end this in a matter of seconds*, Catra thought as she finally joined the battlefield.

“Hey, I thought you wanted me! Come and get me!” She announced smugly before starting to attack the first fighter, finally distracting the remaining army to pay attention to her.

She might not have been a prodigy fire bender, but she definitely knew how to hold her own against anyone with just her bare hands. Her feet ran quickly to one spot to another, avoiding every punch, every kick, any possible stab.

Catra dodged all the fire blast easily. Movement after movement she slowly disarmed multiple soldiers and

used whatever blade she found on them to use it on the next opponent.

She was strong, agile and fast, even without her bending. All alone she managed to put down a dozen soldiers, but there were still at least ten standing.

Thanks to the training acquired through five years of traveling, she knew how to deflect any possible attack. Her fighting style also evolved throughout the period of time.

The Fire Nation's fighting style was aggressive and very intense, lacking of actual defense moves, which was the Water Tribe's most notable attribute by turning the opponent's own strength against them.

And so Catra fought admirably, it wasn't until her limbs got entangled by multiple ropes restraining her that she saw Scorpia with a knife held against her neck, Hordak right behind her.

"Easy now Catra. One more movement and she's dead." The girl's blood froze immediately in fear and worry for her friend. Scorpia was the only one person who had been a constant key factor in her life.

"Let her go. That's an order." Catra threatened dangerously, still fighting against the net that had her pinned to the ground.

"It's your word against Lord Prime's. He's the Fire Lord. You're just a runaway."

The man slowly backed away to her animal companion; Melog.

"What do you think you're doing?!"

"You decimated my troupes, I need a way out. I know you won't do anything too dangerous if I have your friend right here." Catra looked around, Adora was fighting, barely. She knew she couldn't rely on the Avatar to save their lives even thought she was

supposed to be the most powerful being in the World, she couldn't rely on anyone besides her own self.

"Let her go!" A blast of fire started pouring out of her opened mouth in rage. Catra yelled, screamed, squirmed around the net, but it was useless. Admiral Hordak had already begun his escape on Melog and with a kidnapped Scorpia.

Eventually Catra's cries got louder and more desperate once she couldn't see their figures anymore and the fire pouring her of her became *blue* during the intense and emotional moment.

"Catra, Catra!" Adora came to the rescue too late, freeing her of the net and avoiding the fire thanks to her fast reflexes.

The brunette didn't waste a single moment and stood back up, ready to follow the villain. It didn't matter that her body ached, she had to get her Polar Cat and best friend back.

"Stop it!" Adora ordered, wrapping her strong arms against the petite body but Catra kept squirming and releasing her fire breath uncontrollably until the blonde tried to reason with her.

"We are in no conditions to get back at him right now, we're all too injured. We'll get her back as soon as we can, I promise!"

Catra didn't know if it was because of the promise, or if because her body was too tired up, but she stopped fighting, finally collapsing onto the sand.

"We? There's no '*we*' Adora. You were gonna held her prisoner as well! I am going to get Scorpia back, without you and your useless friends."

"You're being irrational, okay? You can't do this alone. You have no food, no water, no transportation. Your best bet is to stick with us, at least for now. You can help us defeat-!"

"Adora, I don't care about this stupid war and helping you with it! I need my friend back!" Catra stood back up on her feet, her face

dangerously close to Adora's as a sign of challenge.

"And you'll have her back, I promise. We'll help you, I swear."

Catra wanted to argue, wanted to slap her stupid face and tell her she was perfectly capable of doing it on her own, but her vision got blurry and distorted until everything turned black.

The next time Catra woke up was in a soft bed in the Earth Kingdom's Royal Place with Mermista curing her thanks to her healing abilities. The brunette groaned and slowly opened her eyes, recognizing the unfamiliar environment and the same group of teenagers that were on the desert.

"Where am I?" She whispered hoarsely; her voice strained. Her head stung and her shoulder hurt a lot.

"You're safe, in Ba Sing Se." Adora said with a smirk. One thing was for sure: she still hadn't abandoned her cockiness over the years, it made Catra infuriated.

"Ba Sing Se?" She asked as realization finally hit her: she had become a prisoner. "No! Why did you bring me here? Who do you think you are?!" And then she sat up with her face close to Mermista, whom rolled her eyes.

"Uh... I think we're the ones that just save your life."

"Look, I had everything under control." Mermista's amber eyes pierced right through her as she raised her eyebrows, making Catra feel self-conscious about her shape. She was bruised, small, skinny, she would have looked little to anyone who took a quick look at her.

“Not from where I’m standing.”

“Then move downwind.” She tried standing up from the bed, but was met with Glimmer pushing her back down. Catra tried not to groan in pain when her back hit the soft mattress.

“Don’t you dare, Fire Nation Scum. The Queen will be here in a matter of seconds and you’ll tell us everything you know.”

The brunette chuckled and pushed Mermista’s hands away from her body, making the water hit the wooden floor of the regal room. She didn’t know why she was kept in such a cozy environment when she was supposed to be a prisoner.

“Are you deaf or have amnesia? I haven’t set foot in the fire nation in *five* years. I don’t have any information. And even if I knew something, I wouldn’t tell you, I wouldn’t win anything.”

Glimmer straightened her posture up, seeming almost regal. “We’d grant you freedom.”

“And then what? The Fire Nation captures me and I get beheaded for treason. I’m afraid I’ll have to politely decline.”

“Okay then: freedom and security.”

“Hell no. I won’t be surrounded by strangers watching over me, who do you think I am, a baby?” The earthbender groaned in absolute frustration. Maybe capturing the princess of the Fire Nation wasn’t a good idea since she had been useless up till now. Adora seemed to notice her anger and gently led her out of the room where the Earth Queen was already waiting for them.

“So? Any news?” She asked with grace, but her eyes screamed desperation. Their prisoner was of great importance to the war.

“Mom, I hate her, she won’t cooperate!”

“Ehem... what Glimmer is trying to say is that she won’t talk. But I don’t think she’d be of much help anyway she has been gone for

five years so there's nothing she can tell us."

"You know what? Let's use her as a bargain chip. Either the Fire Lord gives up or we kill his beloved daughter."

Adora started to internally panic. Her current best friend just proposed to kill her former childhood best friend. Things had gotten too intense too quickly.

"He won't do that!" Catra screamed from the other room because of course she heard their conversation with her super hearing. The three of them walked back in. Mermista was still taking care of minor injuries, but she was almost done with curing the princess.

"Hello your highness, sorry for not bowing but I'm in no condition to actually do it." The tone was obviously sarcastic, but Queen Angella decided to ignore the snarky comment.

"Hello, princess Catra. I'm sure you must be feeling terribly after recent events. I hope the bed is of your liking."

"Using me as a bargain chip won't come in handy for you, even with that threat. The Fire- My father doesn't care that much about me. His ego is too big to give up the war for his runaway daughter. If anything, he'll destroy this city to avenge me."

"And how is he planning to do that?" Bow asked with fear in his voice. Having the enemy home was frightening enough, but Catra was on another level of intimidating.

"Oh please, most of the fire nation soldiers stay inside to defend. Only a small fraction leaves to conquer."

"And how can you know? You left for years." Glimmer retorted, feeling more and more suspicious over the princess.

"My father made me study military strategies ever since I was a kid. I was actually supposed to lead my first

conquest on Omashu but I left... nice city. The mailing system is pretty fun to travel in."

"Catra, why are you telling us this?" Adora pleaded to have an honest reply with her eyes, and apparently that technique worked, it always did.

"I'm not helping you win, I'm helping you to defend yourselves. The Fire Nation has already caused enough damage already and I'd hate to see more destruction. That's it."

Everyone in the room shared a look, a look that Catra translated as gratefulness. It was nice, being appreciated, but it wouldn't last long.

Mermista was just done with curing her and she looked exhausted to say the least. She had been responsible for healing everyone in the group -including herself- before leaving for Full Moon Bay where they got the tickets to get back to the city.

Catra gave her a sympathetic look and then stood up from the bed, feeling better, but not rested.

"If you'll excuse me, I have to go now."

"Go where?" Frosta inquired. Catra sighed deeply and looked outside the large window in front of her. It was a sunny day, no clouds, no rain... complete opposite to the storm happening inside of her mind. Catra wasn't going to commit the same mistake twice, not after what happened to Entrapta.

"Rescue my friend and my pet. Y'know, they got kidnapped so I'd like to get them back."

At those words Adora grabbed her wrist roughly enough to stop her from making any leaving movement. She wasn't going to let Catra go again, not after getting her back. The brunette's breath hitched at the contact, she had never been a touchy person, and any physical contact that didn't require violence was not normal to her.

“You can’t do it alone and you know it. You don’t even know where they are. Besides, what would happen if they recognize you? Do you really want to go back there and risk it all?”

Gray orbs met blue and yellow ones, all of them filled with fear but also determination. “... I have to.”

“You— You don’t! Stick with us and we’ll help you get them back. You’ll have to wait a little longer, but everything will be okay.”

Catra’s voice came out as a plead of reassurance, like when she was a child and asked like when she was a child and asked for guarantee about not being a completely useless daughter. “You promise?”

“I promise.”

Chapter End Notes

Hello and welcome to this new SPOP AU set in the ATLA universe. I hope you'll like this as much as I enjoy writing it. I have no idea on how long right now but I have the whole plot sorted out already so don't worry: this project won't be abandoned.
If you'd like to know more about this fanfic or ask a few questions about it you can easily follow me on twitter @etheriastribe where you'll also find my curious cat!

Family

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes



Catra settled on the bed that was assigned to her in her own private room. Apparently, she was on the Avatar's side now, traitor to the nation she was supposed to lead someday as the only heir to the throne. If Fire Lord Prime found out about it, he'd have Catra's head on a silver plate without a doubt. It didn't matter if

she was his daughter, she was a *runaway* first and then a *traitor* to the nation.

She sighed while looking at the green ceiling above her whilst thinking about all the possible outcomes for this. Then, the door creaked open, revealing the Adora herself.

"Avatar, to what do I owe this unexpected visit at night?"

The blonde rolled her eyes and closed the door behind her before sitting on a wooden chair next to the king-sized bed where Catra was laid on. "Cut it out, Catra."

"Princess, for you."

"You have no power outside the Fire Nation."

Catra didn't even debate for a second to whether be serious or fluster her with witty remarks since she obviously chose the second option. "Yeah, but you're still one of my citizens, which means you're my subordinate."

"I won't call you princess. What are going to do about it, get me arrested for treason? I guess your father is already busy enough with that."

What a buzzkill, Catra thought as she looked away from Adora. "What do you want?"

"I'm here to make sure you won't try to pull any weird tricks on us."

"There are already guards outside of this room, is this really necessary? And why were *you* sent here specifically, out of all people?"

"Yes, it's very necessary. We don't know you, nor your true intentions. For what we could know all of this could've been an act." *Ouch*, that stung a little. Did Adora really say they didn't know each other, as if they hadn't been best friends for their

entire childhoods? But after all, they had stayed away from each other for five years. They were more mature, different.

"Also, I'm the Avatar, so of course they'd send me here to watch over someone who defeat at least a dozen Fire Nation Soldiers without using her bending."

"You know what? I'll take that as a compliment." At that, Adora flushed, her face turning red. Thankfully for her the brunette didn't notice because of the lack of light.

Catra rolled her eyes and turned her back of her.

"I'm gonna sleep now. You better not snore."

"I won't sleep." Adora replied with a scoff. "And I don't snore!"

"Sure thing. You better get some sleep. After all we're leaving early in the morning."

Right, they had to depart from the city in order to get more allies for the attack the Fire Nation during the solar eclipse. Adora felt a rush of anxiety invading her body as she thought about the actual battle that was supposed to happen in just a few months.

Was she ready? She had fully mastered earth and fire, but water and air were still a bit of a struggle for her. What if Prime was too powerful for her? What if she couldn't awaken the Avatar state in the right moment? What would've happened if she *actually* won? Who would be put in charge of the Fire Nation?
Adora had previously thought about Catra and the kindness she showed when they were children, thinking she remained a good person, but she was apparently wrong.
Her ex-best friend was supposed to colonize new territories for the Fire Nation, she was following Prime's footsteps rigorously until she left. And even after that, she wasn't interested in politics, nor helping. Catra was with them only because she had no other option, not because she actually wanted to.

The next morning, they all left at dawn. Catra was gifted with clothes by queen Angella herself since all of her possessions were stolen by Hordak. The Earth Queen made sure to pack a typical earth kingdom bodysuit and anklets. Surprisingly enough, the gloves and arm wraps were from the Water Tribes. Still, Catra made sure to wear her royal armor for practical purposes.
It was weird, wearing clothing items from more than one nation. Usually, she changed into typical clothes of whatever place she found herself in. Having a mix of them all felt odd, but not in a bad way. It was just... *different*.

They were headed to a certain fortress ruled by General Fong to discuss some war stragies. The road ahead of them was long, at least a week of walking if they were fast and didn't stop. Counting all the stops and nights to sleep in it would've taken them around three weeks.

The road was long, torturous even, at least for Catra.
Everyone would talk, share stories, laugh, but not her. She wasn't part of the group and didn't want to be. Each one of the teenagers tried to have a conversation with her -except Glimmer and Adora- but the brunette would quickly dismiss them with a simple nod or by looking some other way.

She had a mission to accomplish, so they could all keep that friendship *bullshit* to themselves and not talk to her for all that matter.

After two weeks they arrived near a trading port -the Merchant's Pier- and decided to take a day off by staying to a beautiful place close to it. It was surrounded by nature so there was no possibility to be found by a fire nation troupe and there was also a waterfall, perfect for practicing waterbending.

Adora and Frosta played instead of doing actual training, but it was still better than doing nothing. Glimmer and Bow were in the water too, just distant enough to let them
"practice". Mermista would've joined too, but she planned to visit the town and Perfuma came with her, leaving Catra to watch over the supplies alone.

Well, not really *alone*, Adora actually adopted a winged lemur when she was training at the Northern Air Temple and named him Swift Wind. The small animal was energetic and kept bugging Catra by existing near her and taking naps on her shoulders as they were traveling. Bow *almost* called her cute, but one single look was enough to stop him.

Swift Wind was rubbing himself against Catra's crossed legs on the ground, wanting to be petted.

"Can't you give me a break?" She hissed in hopes to be left alone, but the animal jumped on her crotch and curled up, ready to sleep.

"So clingy..." Catra groaned and stared at the creature for a quick second; He appeared to be so little and defenseless in that moment. Also, she could feel the how soft his fur was through the fabric of her clothes. It was *adorable*.

She looked around to see if anyone was paying attention to her, then, she hesitantly touched his head, caressing it. The small animal leaned into the touch, and Catra knew she was doomed from that moment on. Never in her travels had she ever seen a winged lemur, let alone touched it. He almost resembled a stuffed animal by the sensation of comfort he gave her.

Catra eventually eased up and let out a rumble come out of her chest, a purr. "You like that little guy?" She asked with a cheerful whisper as her movements shifted to a spot behind his ear.

Adora was having a good time at reviewing old water bending moves while also having fun, but then her eyes caught a glimpse

of Catra finally being at peace with her winged lemur. The image warmed her heart instantly. Her old friend cuddling her pet with heart eyes and a swishing tail to indicate her happiness? *Yes, please*.

The blonde was so awestruck that she didn't deviate Frosta's attack and got thrown over the shore where Catra was. She landed right next to her, making Swift Wind jump in fear and fly over Catra's shoulder, who raised an eyebrow at Adora in annoyance, flush still clear on her face.

"Good job, Avatar." The magicat said with a teasing smirk on her face, because of course she had to ruin the moment by being a dick.

"You haven't talked for weeks and the first words you say are meant to mock me... Why am I not surprised?"

"Why would you be?"

"A lot of things change in five years." Adora replied, quoting directly Catra, as she used her air bending to dry herself up.

"Making fun of you is never going to be not fun. No matter how many years may pass, you'll always be *dumb*." Dumb, it was so close to dummy, the old nickname she reserved for Adora in their childhoods. Could it be that the choice of words was intentional?

Now it was time for Adora to tease her back, two could play this game. "Same thing goes for you. I saw you petting Swift Wind earlier..."

Catra's facade of confidence fell and then her expression shifted so she could show her fangs, ears pinned to her head in defense.

"... It was *cute*." Adora admitted with the same cockiness. Catra could be intimidating, but not scary -not to her. Ever since they were children, she was the type to hiss, not scratch.

Catra was about to do a clap back but Frosta had to interrupt their conversation.

“Are you coming back or what? We’re still not over!”

“Y-Yeah! I’m coming!” Adora turned to look at Catra one last time.

“Nuts.”

That word threw Catra’s head in total chaos because of course it did. It didn’t make any sense. “What?”

“He likes nuts, in case you want to feed him.” Adora added with a wink before throwing herself in the water again to avoid being burnt to death by the smaller girl. Catra growled a threat but Adora was already long gone in the water.

She observed her stance and compared it to Frosta’s. Adora’s style changed less than expected from someone who had trained across all four nations. She took some elements from earthbenders, like the static stance on the ground, but she mostly used firebending moves and applied them to waterbend, which was an *interesting* choice to say the least.
It would’ve been an advantageous technique to use if she applied it the right way. Mixing multiple fighting moves was a good idea to neutralize possible weaknesses like vulnerable openings, but Adora just used firebending and earthbending moves applied to another element, which brought her to be twice as vulnerable. Earthbending was too attached to the ground and slow while firebending too aggressive and vulnerable, it wasn’t a good mix at all.

Catra’s thoughts got interrupted when Mermista and Perfuma came back from their expedition.

“We got you some of your favorite foods!” The blonde announced excitedly and everyone came out of the water.

“How’d it go?” Frosta asked as she stole some pickled fish from the backpack full of food set on the ground.

“It was fun! We even met some pirates. Mermista wanted to buy a waterbending scroll from them but it was too expensive. Also, you’ll never guess who we found.” Perfuma smirked at a blushing Mermista before saying it. “...*Seahawk*” At that name everyone gasped. Well, everyone but Catra.

“Shut up! Are you two going to get back together again?” Glimmer questioned as he handed Bow one of the two Wagashi desserts and Adora a dumpling that she accepted gladly.

“Ugh, *no*. He’s loud and annoying.”

As the conversation within the group continued, Catra kept on subtly petting Swift Wind’s head until Perfuma sat next to her.

“Hey!” She greeted, earning a confused glare from the brunette. Why was she talking to her? Her question got answered when the blonde showed her a small bag of flaming fire flakes.

“Scorpia mentioned that this was your favorite dish when you refused to eat our giant fly. There were sellers from all nations and I found a Fire Nation market that sold these.”

Catra’s eyes went wide and then the corners of her lips quirked up in a shy smile that was quickly reciprocated.

“I know you feel alienated, like you don’t belong with us, but you’re already part of our *family*.” Family, what a strange word. Catra never understood the meaning of it, especially since she had never had a real one. Her father was more of a dictator and she never had met her mom or even seen a picture of her. All she was ever told about her was that she was just a noble woman. That’s it; nothing more, nothing less. Said that, the term “family” felt odd to hear.

“It’ll take a bit of time with the new group dynamic but I’m sure you’ll get along with everyone, including Glimmer. She might seem

all tough on the exterior but I think you two are pretty much alike."

"Thank you, for the food." Catra replied quickly, bringing a flake to her mouth. It tasted like the ones they did in the Capital City. She couldn't help but let out a low purr, low enough so that nobody could hear it.

"You're welcome, I really hope we'll be friends soon enough." Catra looked into those dark eyes and recognized truth coming out of her mouth. She was really being honestly nice to her... *of course* Scorpia would have a crush on her.

"Perhaps, eventually..." Catra replied whilst looking at the horizon. The sun was setting down, giving the sky a shade of orange. It was nice, peaceful even.
Swift Wind then moved closer to the small bag of food that Catra held and she handed him one.

"Be careful, they're quite spicy."

Catra said, but it was already too late. The animal squeaked and comically flew over the lake to drink some water to calm down the fire in his mouth, making everyone in the group laugh at the scene. It was nice.

Hours later, as night fell in, Catra woke up from her nap by a rustling of leaves caused by steps coming from the distance. She quickly stood up from the ground and held out a dagger, immediately alarming the others, having dinner by the fireplace.

"Catra?" Adora inquired carefully as she approached her. Quiet fell among the teenagers, who shared concerned looks.

“Silence. There’s someone in the woods. They’re approaching us.”

“How many?” Her ears perked up further to hear better. *One*. One person, possibly male. He wasn’t being really careful with his stepping, meaning he had no intentions to surprise them.

“One guy. He isn’t being exactly discreet with his footing.” At that comment Mermista groaned in frustration.

“Seahawk! We know you’re here!”

Right then, a man with a mustache and fancy clothing came out of the bushes with the most disgusting heart eyes someone could ever have. So that was Seahawk, no wonder why Mermista described him as loud and annoying.

“Mermista, my dearest!” Catra looked at Adora for reassurance, and the blonde nodded at her. A silent language; “*He’s harmless*.” She said with that gesture. The princess’ nerves calmed down and she put the weapon away.

“What are you doing here?”

“I came here to gift you this!” The man yelled out whilst showing the same waterbending scroll that she wanted to buy earlier. However, the girl’s face remained unfazed. She didn’t take it, but Frosta sure did.

“Awesome! I can try new moves with this. This is so cool!”

“What’s the catch?”

The man’s confidence suddenly left his face and was replaced with shyness. “See, I might be in a bit of trouble right now. I might or might not be followed by a bunch of angry pirates right now.” Weird, Catra couldn’t hear anything coming from the ground. No steps, no voices, no vibrations, nothing.

“Please don’t tell me you set the ship on fire again.”

“Oh no, I did not do that! But a group of Fire Nation soldiers came by. They were looking for you, all of you.” The man then raised his chest up and rested his fist on the hips before continuing the story. “But I had to protect you, dearest! So, I started a fight with them and now our ship is on fire. So technically: no, I didn’t set the ship on fire, *they* did.”

Catra looked around, starting to get *paranoid*. She couldn’t sense any movements from the woods and for the pirates to come using a boat was not possible, but for the Fire Nation yes.

“These men, how did they look like?” She questioned with aggression in her voice. Adora rested a hand on her shoulder to calm her down, but it was futile.

“Typical boring uniforms with those ugly masks... there was a man though, he was taller than the rest. Red eyes, very white skin, pointy ears...”

“Good evening, princess!” *Hordak*. Hordak and his men. Catra turned towards the sound of the voice and saw her citizens accompanied by other people dressed with Seahawks’ same style on a Fire Nation ship. *Great*, other than the soldiers they had to also defeat the pirates.

The admiral and the rest of the crew landed on the shore. It was time for *revenge*. Catra pulled out her dual swords, quickly followed by Bow grabbing a bow, Seahawk a dagger and the rest of group getting ready to fight with their bending.

“What did you do to Scorpia? I demand of you to tell me.”

“The Fire Lord has to yet decide her fate. She’s a very skilled fighter, but she refuses to cooperate. Until she won’t work with us, she’ll be rotting in prison.” Catra released an involuntary breath of fire, trying to contain her rage. At that, Hordak smirked and took a step forward.

“Such a shame she didn’t meet Entrapta’s same fate.”

“Don’t you dare say her name!” The tension kept on growing more and more. With each step the villains took forward, the heroes took one ahead too.

“She’s happy with us, building new weapons. All you did was deprive her of her true passion. I can’t believe you actually thought running away from the Fire Nation was the best things for them. Admit it, you *ruined* their lives.”

Catra finally snapped and did something she’d never thought she’d do. She dropped her weapons and directed a punch at Hordak in the stomach. Just as when her hand was touched it, she created a *flame* and then thrusted it down into an explosive burst, creating a fire bomb that sent Hordak flying several meters away: the fight had begun. The pirates quickly threw smoke bombs to block their opponent's view.
Catra only saw red in that moment, feelings of guilt and rage bottled up finally came out of her in the form of firebending. She threw fire jabs at everyone who crossed paths with her. The more she fought, the more she deliberately used her rage against the enemy.

Catra was so focused on finding Hordak that she didn’t pay attention to her companions until she heard Seahawks’ scream as he was about to be beheaded on the spot by a fellow pirate. The princess took a deep breath to charge her attack and then delivered a kick that set off a large stream of fire that most probably left permanent burn marks on the pirate’s face. Seahawk immediately ran behind her, but she kept on walking, not acknowledging his presence.

It wasn’t until she was met yet again with Hordak that she exploded with even angrier fury. The man had been chasing her for years and took away from her Scorpia, Entrapta and Melog. And now they were all *suffering*, because of him.

“Come on child, show me what you got.”

Catra smirked devilishly as her hands caught fire with *blue* flames. "With pleasure." She replied before throwing non-stopping fire blasts at him. She didn't want to give him an opening, so she never took a second of pause.
Eventually Hordak stopped defending himself and threw one blast of his own that she easily blocked by slowly rotating her arms in circular motion, making the flames dissolve in the air.

"Who knew you'd become a decent firebender? I have to admit, your father would be proud of you in this moment."

Catra didn't reply and assumed the airbending stance, keeping her feet light on the ground and avoided all the attacks with ease. He was getting angry, and she *enjoyed* it. But enough was enough, so Catra took advantage of an open spot and used a kick to send him to the ground once again. It was over; she had won.

"Beg for your life and I might spare you." She panted out, out of breath because of the fight. The General laughed at her face. He was making fun of her.

"You really think you've won? I think you're missing out a little detail."

"And what would that be?" And then she felt arms restraining her as light punches were thrown at her, immobilizing her limbs and making her fall to the floor.

"I have chi-blockers." Hordak stood up and pointed at the tied group laying on the ground. *Fuck*, Catra didn't even notice her companions falling on the battleground, she was too lost in her thoughts to pay a minimum of attention to them. "Tie her up!"

So there they were minutes later, all tied up but able to stand again. The pirates were making sure that none of them tried to escape while the Fire Nation Soldiers held Seahawk hostage and showed the raiders their precious waterbending scroll.

"Now we'll give you these two and I'll have the children with me, just like according to plan." Hordak ordered, and just as they were about to make the trade, Bow spoke up:

"You're really gonna hand over the Fire Nation Princess, Earth Kingdom Princess, the leaders of the Water Tribes and the Avatar for a stupid piece of parchment and an arson guy?" Hordak flinched, already knowing his tactic.

"Don't listen to him! He's trying to turn us against each other."

But he was ignored by the pirates, who kept on questioning the boy. "Your friends are really princesses and the Avatar?"

"Sure are! And I'll bet they'll fetch a lot more on the black market than that fancy scroll."

"Shut your mouth you Earth Kingdom peasant!" Adora nodded in agreement to Hordak. The situation was already precarious enough. "Yeah, Bow, you really should shut your mouth." She whispered, but he kept on engaging conversation with the enemy.

"I'm just saying, it's bad business sense. Just imagine how much the Fire Lord would pay for all of them and to have his daughter back." Catra almost hissed at that, but contained herself since she knew what he had in mind. It was a smart plan. "You guys would be set for life."

"Keep the boy and the scroll. We can buy thousands with the reward we'll get for all of them."

"You'll regret breaking a deal with me." Hordak growled before throwing flames at the pirates. *Finally*, the second battle began. Catra saw one of her swords on the sand and used its blade to cut

the rope around the wrist. Of course, she had to avoid some fire blast and knives that were thrown around, but she made it out of the situation.

Freedom. She quickly picked up her weapon and helped the others, receiving quick *thank you*'s along the way. "Pick up your stuff and get to the boat, now!" She ordered and then ran to the ship's wheel, ready to sail.

The teens quickly gathered everything and then jumped on board. Mermista and Adora used their waterbending to help the ship get out of the water so that they could get out of there while Frosta build an ice wall to protect them from any attacks. Catra recognized the commands quite easily and set sail pretty fast at full speed since she still remembered how to use them from her training in the Fire Nation. However, this ship model had less flaws compared to the previous ones, it was probably thanks to Entrapta.

Once they were safe, Catra stepped out of the command room and headed to the main deck where everyone was.

"Alright. There should be a berthing compartment somewhere around here arranged in bunk beds. It's not comfortable but it's better than nothing." She announced before turning around to go back inside to set course to General Fong's fortress but she felt two strong arms wrapping around her.

"Thank you so much for saving my life! You are an angel!" Seahwak yelled right into her sensitive ears. Catra hissed in pain and squirmed away from him. "How could I ever repay you?"

"By closing your mouth." The pirate pouted, but respected her wishes.

"I can't believe we lost the scroll. I really wanted to practice those moves." She heard Frosta whine to Glimmer, and knew immediately what to do.

“Hey, kid!” Catra called, gaining her attention. She didn’t say anything else, but did an action that screamed a thousand words. The princess threw the *oh so precious* waterbending scroll that she found abandoned on the sand right next to her sword. The girl squealed in delight and jumped around the whole deck. Her happiness was so contagious that it made Catra chuckle before she quietly disappeared back to the command room.

Daylight was just a couple of hours away, but Catra wasn’t tired, adrenaline was still running through her veins. She really burned a person's face and almost murdered another man after promising herself she wouldn’t do it, not *again*. It didn’t matter if it was one of her worst enemies, it wasn’t the right thing to do.

“Can I come in?” Adora’s voice asked, but she was already inside.

“Suit yourself.”

“What are you doing up here?”

“Conducting this ship.”

Adora, tired of not being directly considered, walked up to the command panel and pointed at a red button. “There’s an auto-pilot mode.”

“I don’t trust technology.” At that, she chuckled, because it was true. Ever since they were children Catra had trouble understanding how new machines worked, but she was secretly fascinated by them, and could spend days figuring out how they worked.

“What are you doing here?” The question shocked Adora. That was the first time in seven years that Catra tried to have an actual

conversation with her.

“Couldn’t sleep. The engine was too loud so I came up here. It’s quiet.”

“You can sleep on the main cabin. There’s no sound in there. I wasn’t going to sleep anyway.”

“That’s... very nice of you, but I think I’m gonna keep you company.” She said as she took a wooden chair and sat next to a standing Catra holding the ship’s wheel.

“Just don’t talk.”

“Fine, I won’t say a single word.” Adora replied with a scoff at her cold behavior, but knew deep down Catra tolerated her company, otherwise she would’ve thrown her overboard.

After a few minutes Adora was tired of watching miles and miles of sea, the silence was unbearable, she had to break it.

“I didn’t know you could firebend that well.”

“Adora...” Catra growled as a warning, but again, the blonde wasn’t afraid.

“I mean it! It was like... like you weren’t holding back. Catra, your fire was *blue*, do you know how powerful do you have to be to produce blue fire?”

“I lost control. I shouldn’t have let that happen. I was untamable, I was so lost in rage that I... I can’t let it happen, not again. Someone might get seriously hurt or worse if I let myself go like that.”

“This is ridiculous.” Catra finally deigned her of a look, but it was a harsh glare.

“Excuse me?”

Adora stood up from the chair, ready to argue and explain why she was right and Catra wrong. “You could be one of the strongest firebenders in *history* and yet decide to not use it to your advantage because of a stupid mental block you have. You shouldn’t let fear stop you from achieving your true potential.”

“It’s not fear!”

“Whatever it is it’s holding you back. How about this: I teach you how to firebend and keep control over yourself?”

Catra's heart rater spiked up at the mere thought of spending more time with Adora, she was *excited* about it, but then suspicion rose up in her mind. “And what do you gain?”

“A strong ally on my side... and I’d like to see you get over your... whatever that is.”

“I’m not your *ally*.” Catra spat back. They were almost eye to eye if it weren’t for Catra’s shortness.

Adora’s eyes darted from her mismatched eyes to examine her face as a whole. The freckles were still there, never fading. Her skin was more tanned than when she last saw her. Living reclused in a palace made her look pale compared to the sun-kissed pigmentation she had now. Her nose was still little and pointy and she caught a small glimpse of a fang sticking out of those plump lips.

It wasn’t like Catra didn’t do the same, but she stared at Adora’s body instead of her dilated pupils, afraid to hold eye-contact. Adora grew at least a foot taller, easily towering over her, and she got significantly curvier compared to when they were pre-teens. Years of intense training as the Avatar showed through the hard muscles that could be easily seen even with the loose clothes on, especially those thighs. Catra wandered why her mouth was suddenly *dry* and what was she so *thirsty* for.

“I know you’re a good person Catra, and good people stick together.” Adora whispered, barely audible, their foreheads almost

touching. “You may not like us but there must be a reason for you to stay with us, right?”

Catra finally looked in her eyes, her voice trembling. “I have to save Scorpia. I am *using* you.” Adora wanted to believe it with all of her soul. Ever since Catra joined them she wanted to give up hope on her, at least it would’ve made it easier to not start having strange emotions towards her that made her feel constantly nervous around her. But after today, she knew the Fire Nation Princess had a *good* heart and a *pure* soul.

“I don’t think so. You saved Seahawk -a stranger- and gave Frosta the waterbending scroll. You *like* my friends.”

“I-” The princess groaned and turned her attention back to the wheel, somehow disappointing Adora. She didn’t know what she expected, but it definitely wasn’t for Catra to turn away from her. “They’re barely tolerable. All of them are almost as annoying as you are.”

The energy in the room shifted, from tense and heavy to light-hearted and teasing.

“I am annoying?”

“A real pain in the ass.”

“Sorry, but you’ll have to deal with me for a long time.”

“Yeah, unfortunately.” Both women chuckled and finally enjoyed the peaceful silence. It felt nice.

“You have to shift your weight through the stances.” Were the words that Catra chose to finally say.

“What?”

“When you waterbend, you are too static, too attached to the ground, you can’t do that if you want to master waterbending. It’ll only bring more difficulties to you if you keep that stance.”

And for the first time in years, Adora actually enjoyed being next to her friend again.

“Thanks.”

Chapter End Notes

Next chapter: Adora in the Avatar state

Avatar State

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes



The group finally reached their destination at General Fong's Fortress. They left the ship a couple of miles south in order to not be attacked by any army.

Everyone was greeted warmly except for Catra. Of course, being the Fire Nation Princess only had its perks inside the Fire Nation.

She had her hands trapped in a block of rock behind her back and two guards right next to her. Even though the whole group insisted on vouching for her, they were ignored and Catra had to play along. It was beyond *humiliating*, being treated like that, but if it was necessary then so be it.

They got escorted to the war room where General Fong had been waiting for them.

"Welcome, Avatar Adora! I am General Fong." The tall man slightly bowed forward as a sign of respect. "And welcome to all of you great heroes: Seahawk, Perfuma, Mermista, Frosta, brave Glimmer and mighty Bow."

"Mighty? I like that." The boy said with a huge smile at being appreciated like that.

"I see you've brought a prisoner with us. Princess Catra, I thought you were dead."

He was now much colder, but that didn't stop her from laughing at his face. "I like to surprise people."

"Sir, uh... she's not a prisoner. She's with us." Adora clarified with a polite smile. Explaining the situation was going to be quite hard.

"You're against the Fire Lord? Your own *father*, and nation?"

"Meh, I wouldn't call him father, just sperm donor. And yes, I'm going against him."

"Why?"

"Isn't it obvious? I want all the power to myself." It was supposed to be a sarcastic reply, but apparently everyone in the room took it seriously. However, Fong found it to be a pretty plausible excuse for her.

"I hope you won't turn out to be a problem just like the rest of your family."

“Sorry man, but I’m already going to have that talk with the Earth Queen.”

“Very well, free her.” Catra felt a fragment of rock bruising her palm and let out a low hiss in hopes to not be heard, but of course Adora had to step in. The blonde turned to the guards with a harsh expression.

“Hey, be careful.” It sounded more authoritative than angry, but it wasn’t hard to notice her inner rage.

“S-Sorry ma’am!” One of them said and Catra finally felt her hands free of the weight of that invasive rock.

General Fong lost no more time and got to the point of their visit. He took a sit on the bureau set in front of them.

“Avatar Adora, we were all amazed to hear about all your achievements in these years. I can’t imagine what it feels like to wield such devastating power. It’s an awesome responsibility.”

“I try not to think about it too much.”

“Avatar, you’re ready to face the Fire Lord *now*.”

Everyone gasped. She wasn’t ready. She had fully mastered only one element. “What?! No, I’m not.”

“Adora still needs to master all four elements.” Glimmer chimed in with more confusion.

“Why? With the kind of power she possesses, power enough to destroy hundreds of battleships in a matter of minutes, she could defeat the Fire Lord now.”

Bow tried a gentler approach instead. “Sir, the thing is, Adora can only do those things when she’s in the Avatar State.”

“See, it’s this special state where-”

"I'm well aware. Your eyes glow, and you're able to summon unbelievable power." The man stood up and pointed at a world map hung to the ceiling. "Without you we'd be slaughtered before we even reach their shores. But with you leading the way, as the ultimate weapon, we could cut a swath right through the heart of the Fire Nation."

"Right, but I don't know how to get in or out of the Avatar State. Much less what to do once I'm there." Adora explained in hopes to be understood. She wasn't ready to defeat Fire Lord Prime, not yet at least. She knew the basic moves for the other elements, but she had to fully master them and without any actual master it was hard to do. She could practice water and earth along Frosta, Mermista, Perfuma and Glimmer but they were amateurs. Besides, there were no airbenders on the team so she had to basically teach herself from the basis that had been given to her by Spinnerella and Netossa.

"So, it's decided, then. I'll help you figure out how to get into the Avatar State, and then you'll face your destiny."

For the first time ever, *Bow* lost his patience. This was a mad man that was going to get his best friend killed "No, nothing is decided. We already have a plan: Adora pursuing *her* destiny *her* way."

"Well, while you take your time learning the elements, the war goes on. May I show you something?" He stepped in front of a window and pointed to a hut with a line of people in front of it. "That's the infirmary. And those soldiers are the lucky ones. They came back. Every day the Fire Nation takes lives."

Catra flinched her head away at the view of men with mutilated limbs and broken bones. Her people did this, she was part of it, she was *responsible* for it.

"People are dying, Adora! You could end it, now. Think about it."

Catra put a pillow over her face to cover the laughs coming from Glimmer and Bow. She hated being trapped in a room with them and the Avatar; the alternative was to sleep in a cell, but she was actually fine with that. Adora had to interfere and insist on letting her keep an eye on her companion, so now she was cornered in a fit of giggles and whispers that stopped once Adora came back from her bathroom break that lasted at least thirty minutes.

"I told the general I'd help him by going into the Avatar State." And with that simple confession, the catgirl walked out to the terrace, followed by Swift Wind, not wanting to hear more of it. She couldn't believe Adora would agree on something so stupid and dangerous, but Catra still expected her to do it. Disappointed, but not surprised.

Adora had always centered her entire personality around being the Avatar. Ever since they were children, she was told that her sole reason for existing was to bring balance. It wasn't a shock for her to turn out to have a hero complex. In her own mind Adora had to save everyone, no matter how much damage she'd receive; As long as everyone was happy then she was okay too.

"Adora, no. This is not the right way." Bow contested inside the room, gaining a confused frown from Glimmer.

"Why not? Remember when she took out the fire navy? She was incredible." She recalled the time the Fire Nation tried to take over the Northern Water Tribe and after Yue's death Adora evoked such power to destroy the fleet in a matter of minutes.

"There's a right way to do this: practice, study and discipline."

"Or just glow it up and stop that Fire Lord."

Bow lost it again. "If you two meatheads want to throw away everything we've worked for: fine. Go ahead and glow it up." He

had no wishes of seeing Adora in such rage again and the fact that Glimmer reinforced that dumb decision made him even angrier, so he just followed Catra out in the open.

“Bow, I’m just being realistic! I don’t have time to do this the right way.” Adora tried to call, but it was futile.

The man found Catra sitting on the edge of the rail, but he didn’t worry about it. She was part cat after all, it was common.

“Have you ever seen her in the Avatar State?” He asked, both looking at the dark horizon in front of them.

“*Once*.” She replied coldly, without any enthusiasm to continue the story. It happened when they were twelve and Adora saw how Catra’s tutor –Shadow Weaver- kept on insulting her. She put up with years of powerlessness for the matter, but one day she just snapped. It happened so fast, but the destruction caused in the castle took months to be repaired. Fire Lord Prime wasn’t angry though: no, he was *fascinated* by such strength. Catra, on the other hand, remained completely traumatized by it.

“How was it?”

“... Scary.” Was the only word she found to describe the episode, because it was.

“Yeah, I know. I just- This is stupid, right? She can’t control it. She’d hurt people close to her because her consciousness is not there. She might hurt herself. I don’t want that to happen.”

“Me neither.” She whispered and immediately regretted letting it out. He looked at her scared eyes and then darted his glance back to the dark sky without saying another word. He wore a relieved smile, finally someone understood his logic.

“You’re a good person.”

“I will rip your eyes out if you say that again.”

“Sure you will.”

The next day was torture for Adora. First, they made her drink a special herbal tea wish increased energy tenfold in soldiers, but it only gave her an energy rush. Then, Seahawk tried to “scare” her into the Avatar State, but it only ended with her breaking his nose with a punch. Thankfully Mermista was there to assist his recovery. At the end of the day, she even participated in a ritual where she wore clothing from all four nations and then bathed in a blend of all four elements, which resulted on her being covered in mud.

In conclusion: the day had been a complete *failure*.

Catra did not attend the events, she just kept on hanging out on the balcony with Swift Wind, which was weird. She would’ve never missed out on a possibility to make fun of Adora. So, when she came back to their room, instead of staying inside, she went up to talk to Catra.

“You can’t even imagine the stuff I had to go through today.”

“Did it work?” Catra asked absently whilst petting the lemur on her shoulder.

“No. I don’t think they have any idea on what to do to help me with it.”

Silence fell upon them, and it wasn’t a comfortable one. Adora waited for Catra to say something, anything, but the other girl looked highly conflicted, almost not wanting to talk. She had always been reserved, so Adora knew she had to push her a little further.

“Catra, do you wanna say something?”

“Do you remember when we were kids and you destroyed almost half of the Royal Palace?” Adora slowly nodded. She didn’t remember what she did, but Catra’s fearful eyes were enough to tell her she was responsible for the damage.

“I saw you get so upset that you weren’t even you anymore. I’m not saying the Avatar State doesn’t have incredible and helpful power. But you have to understand, for the people who—” Catra stopped for a second, not really knowing how to continue the sentence. Care about you? That would’ve made it seem like she still cared about Adora — which was not true, obviously.

“... for your friends, watching you be in that much rage and pain is really scary.”

“I’m glad you told me that.” Adora sighed deeply, taking in the information. Catra was on Bow’s and Perfuma’s side. Maybe they were right?

“But I still need to do this.”

Catra frowned, looking at her in both confusion and frustration. “I don’t understand.”

“No, you don’t. Every day, more and more people die. I have to stop this as soon as possible. Defeating the Fire Lord is the only way to stop this war. I have to try it... Is that why you weren’t by my side today?”

“I can’t watch you do this to yourself!” Catra spat out, letting anger get the best of her for a quick second. “I’m not coming tomorrow either.” She whispered tiredly before signaling for Adora to leave her alone.

“Goodnight?” The blonde asked, receiving a faint *goodnight* in response. At that point she wasn’t sure if they had made progress of worsened their already complicated relationship. What were

they, enemies collaborating because of same goals, strangers, working partners, *friends*?

That night Adora had a nightmare. She dreamt about the siege at the Northern Water Tribe. Memories of Yue's smile flew back to her mind and then... her sacrifice and the chaos that happened shortly afterwards. Adora saw herself in that aquatic monster, her expression was full of rage. She looked scary, terrifying even. She saw all the ships she made sink, all the soldiers that jumped into water and then— she woke up with a loud gasp. Only Glimmer was in the room. Bow was probably still too upset and slept in Perfuma and Frosta's room while she could spot Catra's shadow from the outside.

Adora stood up from the hard mattress and shook Glimmer awake.

"What's up?" She asked, still half- asleep.

"I don't think we should be trying to bring on the Avatar State." She finally admitted with much shame. She had been wrong for agreeing into that mad plan. She'd find another way to awaken the Avatar State and keep it under control without Fong.

"You sure?"

"Yeah."

The tired girl shrugged and yawned before replying. "Okay." She was glad to have Glimmer as her best friend. She could be difficult at times, but always supported her instincts, even though they had been wrong a few times along the years.

"Do you think the general will be mad?"

“What can he say? You’re the Avatar. Who knows better than you?”

“The thing is, I don’t think we’ll ever be able to trigger it on purpose.” Adora explained to General Fong the next morning. It was a hard decision, but it still was the right one. “So, I guess that’s it.”

“You’re sure I can’t change your mind?” Fong asked. He didn’t look angry or disappointed, rather contemplative, which was a good sign, *right*?

“I’m sure. I can only reach the Avatar State when I’m in genuine danger.”

“I see.” He stood up from the seat behind the bureau. “I was afraid you’d say that.” He said before throwing the piece of furniture at her without any warning. The hit was so strong that it made Adora fly out the tower’s window and if it weren’t for her airbending she would’ve broken a few bones when she hit the floor.

The crazy man appeared from behind the broken window and then ordered: “Men, attack the Avatar.”

Adora dodged a rock thrown at the direction of her head thanks to her fast reflexes. Things escalated quickly, too quickly for her mind to process it the right way. Fong took a long jump and landed right in front of the girl.

“What are you doing?”

“I believe we are about to get results.” And then everything clicked. He attacked her and put her in serious danger because he

expected her to enter the Avatar State.

Adora rolled her eyes in annoyance, using her logic. “I’m not your enemy. I won’t fight you.” She assured, but then was attacked by four earth coins thrown at her. She easily avoided the attack through a high jump and landed on top of them.

Her eyes found her friends ready to defend her, but she quickly dismissed them. “I can handle it! No need to worry guys.”

Part of the soldiers were riding ostrich horses to keep up with her speed while the other half kept throwing rocks and earth coins at her, genuinely trying to hurt her.

Adora’s stamina was cut short through the battle. Since she wouldn’t attack them she could only avoid their hits, and that required airbending. Sure, it was a great way to practice, but also a traumatic one.

Then, Adora got trapped between one of the coins’ holed center by the general. “You can’t run forever”

“You can’t fight forever!”

Catra stayed in the shared room all day, not wanting to participate in any futile attempts to evoke the Avatar State, but when she kept on hearing the sound of rocks smashing and the earth beneath her feet tremble, she knew something was wrong.

“I wonder what crazy thing they’re doing right now.” She said to Swift Wind. The lemur never left her side, it almost seemed like he preferred Catra over Adora, which was surprisingly *odd*. The animal purred and nuzzled closer to her side.

The brunette happily pet his soft fur until she heard another loud banging noise.

"Maybe we should just make sure Adora's okay." Swift Wind groaned, almost in a teasing mannerism that she didn't appreciate.

"This is *not* because I like her! She is lousy and annoying. It's just that it would be a shame if she tripped or something and I'm not there to make fun of it." She justified herself to the animal and felt quite stupid about it. He couldn't even understand her.

Catra sighed and finally walked out to the balcony where she witnessed a horde of soldiers attacking Adora in the courtyard. Her eyes darted to the broken wall of the meeting room where the rest of the group was watching the scene.

"What's happening?!"

"The general's gone crazy. He's trying to force Adora into the Avatar State!" Glimmer explained. Catra wondered why the *fuck* weren't they helping her, but it wasn't her main concern at the moment. She quickly ran out to the courtyard were Adora was too busy deflecting attacks to even notice her.

Catra easily knocked out a soldier about to throw a large rock with a harsh karate chop on the back of his neck. It was easy, taking the soldiers by surprise and making them unconscious with just one hit, but the situation was still precarious. It wasn't until Adora regained a second to breathe that her eyes finally acknowledged Catra's presence.

"Catra, get out. Now!" At the desperation of those words Fong turned around and smirked.

"Maybe you can avoid me, but *she* can't."

Soon enough the princess was ringed in the middle of a circle of soldiers ready to attack her. She smiled smugly, not showing any signs of possible vulnerability. "Bring it on." She said, but what she

didn’t expect was for the ground beneath her to be earthbent, making her legs sink into it.

“Don’t hurt her!” Adora ordered, and then proceeded to launch a fire blast that was blocked by him earthending a wall to protect himself before making Catra sink further. Now her waist was also underground.

At Catra’s yelp, Adora’s heart missed a beat. She felt completely powerless and knew that violence would’ve made things worse.

“Stop this! You have to let her go.” She pleaded, grabbing the man’s right arm, but he ignored her.

“You could save her if you were in the avatar State.”

Tears welled up in her eyes at the thought of losing Catra *again*. “I’m trying. I’m trying!”

Catra gasped as half of her torso got covered in more earth. “Let me go, you freak!” She protested, trying to get out of the sinking ground. It was futile, but at least worth a try.

“I don’t see glowing.” Fong explained before Catra was neck-deep under the ground. The two girls shared a look. Even though Catra was the one risking her life, Adora was the scared one. In her eyes there was something that Catra couldn’t quite decipher yet, but it showed *fondness*.

“Dude, cut it out!” She yelled before her mouth sunk down. Adora went back to the useless pleading with tears streaming down her face.

“You don’t need to do this!”

General Fong spared the Avatar of one last look before replying. “Apparently, I do.” And with that, Catra disappeared underground with a terrified -and muffled- scream.

Adora tried to jump in to her rescue but it was useless. It was over, she was gone. Catra, princess of the Fire Nation, her first best friend, the first person to love Adora for who she really was - and not for being the Avatar. Catra, the girl with the golden heart and a life full of joy ahead of her. She was gone.

The desperation in Adora's body left and was replaced with something scarier; *anger*. She tried to control it, but at that point it was useless.

She slowly stood up and turned around towards General Fong with white eyes; She had entered the Avatar State.

"It worked. It worked!" General Fong celebrated his apparent victory for a couple of short seconds before Adora launched an air blade created with the downward movement of her arms. He was able to dodge it by a single millimeter. The strike would've been deadly by how sharp the created blade was.

Bow, Glimmer, Perfuma, Frosta, Mermista and Seahawk ran down to the courtyard and the Earth Princess wasted no time in scolding him harshly.

"What did you do?! She told you it was a bad idea!"

But Fong ignored her in order to try to talk to the lost Adora. "Avatar Adora, can you hear me?" He asked, but she was too out of control.

The blonde raised herself above them all by creating an air sprout, and she looked ready to attack again until he pulled an unconscious Catra out from the underground.

"Your friend is safe. It was just a trick to trigger the Avatar State. And it worked!" The admission failed to comfort Adora, whom destroyed the entire estate by coming down of the vortex and earth bending the ground, ruining all the nearby structures.

Glimmer hurried up and built an earth wall to shelter the group, including Fong.

“How’s Catra?” She asked Mermista, whom was already using her healing abilities on her.

“Just passed out from the lack of air. She’s fine.”

Then, Mara’s soul suddenly appeared to the young firebender, taking a projection of Adora’s soul with her and to her and to her fellow animal companion, the badgermole.

Adora could see her own body as she floated away. She looked scary, even to herself.

“It’s time you learned.” Mara’s soothing voice brought peace in her mind as the animal walked them across a new world full of her predecessors in history.

“The Avatar State is a defense mechanism designed to empower you with the skills and knowledge of all the past Avatars.”

“How do I control it?” Adora questioned desperately, but Mara continued on talking. It had always been like that; Adora asked for answers that were never received, and she hated it.

“The glow is the combination of all your past lives, focusing their energy through your body. In the Avatar State, you are at your most powerful, but also at your most vulnerable.”

“What does that mean?” And finally, a response came.

“If you are killed in the Avatar State, the reincarnation cycle will be broken and the Avatar will *cease* to exist.”

Adora had so many other questions. She demanded advice from the ones that came before her, but her spirit fell back to her body. Once entered the physical world, she left the Avatar State, and fell on her knees. Bow quickly ran up to her and held her in his strong arms.

“I’m sorry, Bow. I hope you never have to see me like that again.” He said nothing, but a comforting smile was enough to make her

feel better.

“Ha! Are you joking? That was almost perfect. We just have to find a way to control you when you’re like that.” Fong yelled excitedly.

Adora stood back up with the help of her friend and approached her own group.

“You’re out of your mind!” Perfuma accused with anger. It took a lot for her to get mad, but the situation created was simply too insane to maintain her usual calmness.

“...I guess we’ll figure it out on the way to the Fire Nation.”

Glimmer had enough and threw a small rock at his head, making him unconscious with just one single move. “Anybody got a problem with that?!” She questioned the soldiers.

Adora then glanced at Catra. She was still unconscious and her breaths were heavy. She had never looked so small and weak in Adora’s eyes. Her nurturing instinct took over as she knelt down. Carefully, she shifted Catra in her arms, slipping one arm behind her knees and the other around the small of her back and then she lifted Catra as gently as she could, wobbling a bit on her numb legs as she stood back up.

Bow and Perfuma were next to her, ready to help in case anything happened, but Adora was too stubborn to let go and gripped her body tighter to her chest.

The next time Catra woke up she was back in the ship, more specifically in the main cabin with her body on top of the soft bed.

Actually, soft was an overstatement, but compared to some places Catra slept in, it was an understatement.

She slowly opened her eyes and immediately saw Adora rush from a wooden chair on the other side of the room to the bed.

“Catra, are you okay?”

The brunette nodded, slowly, and then sat up. “What happened?” She asked. The last thing she remembered vividly is her legs starting to sink into the ground, after that was a huge blackout and a few messy memories involving flashes of Adora fighting. She couldn’t see her face but by the way she showed aggressiveness she was pretty sure Adora had been pissed off.

“That jerk sunk you all the way down. I’m sure he didn’t want to kill you but I bet he wasn’t particularly keen on keeping you *alive* either. I can’t believe he did that because of his pursue of the Avatar State.”

“Well, did it work?” Catra asked casually, and earned a genuine glare from the blonde.

“You can’t be serious.”

“I’m totally serious. So...?”

Adora clenched her jaw in irritation a couple of times and then shifted her attention at the ground. “*Yes*.”

“Great. Next time we’ll need it I’ll just throw myself out of a cliff.”

“Don’t— Don’t joke about this...” The Avatar whispered, she looked back into Catra’s colored irises and the princess noticed the tears starting to prickle at the corners of her eyes.

Only then did she notice her red and puffy eyes. Adora had been crying because of her.

Her first instinct was to hug her, but she figured it was not appropriate for their kind of relationship, so Catra opted for hesitantly resting her hand above Adora's.

"I didn't mean to make you upset, really. I guess I..." She started fidgeting with Adora's fingers. They weren't slender anymore. They became a little bit wider, results of years of training probably. They were still soft though, so Catra eased even more on the touch and squeezed the palm.

"I didn't know you'd get like this. It wasn't my intention."

Adora sighed, knowing this was the closest Catra would get to say sorry. At least it was progress. "I didn't know how unbearable it would've been to lose you until you were underground." She admitted, and Catra's face turned red in response.

"Adora, we didn't see each other for years. You can't—"

"You're my friend. You've *always* been." The blonde moved her hands to each side of Catra's face, holding it. "I'm sorry if I didn't come back for you but it was impossible. I couldn't have set foot into the Fire Nation without being captured immediately. I wanted to do it; you have to believe me."

Catra stayed quiet, examining Adora's facial expression to see if there was any sign of what could've been a lie but she was being truthful to her.

"I've always wondered what could've happened to you a-and then I saw wanted posters of you and Scorpia in a small Earth Kingdom village and- Shit. I hoped I'd find you, and then I did." Adora sobbed as she told the story, feelings of guilt coming back to life all of sudden. She couldn't handle the embarrassment and hid her face in Catra's warm chest.

The princess reluctantly wrapped her slender arms around her trembling body and then started to gently stroke her hair, remembering how it used to soothe her when they were children.

"I... I thought about you too. I was worried for you. Going against the Fire Lord, really?"

"Well, you're pretty much helping us now so you're against him too."

The technique seemed to relieve Adora, who sniffed and wiped the tears away from her face. Catra smiled sympathetically at her and then let out a genuine chuckle.

"Yeah, I guess so. Can't wait until he'll find out the only heir to the throne is on the Avatar's side."

Now it was Adora's turn to comfort Catra. She spotted the tip of the lashing tail and started to pet it with kindness. It all seemed so new, but also so familiar. "Hey, we'll rescue Scorpia and then we'll defeat him. Everything is gonna turn out just fine, I *promise*."

"I just want her to be fine. She's not fit for prison. She likes warm baths and needs to hear a lullaby before bed time."

"Will you two stick around with us?" Adora asked. Although Catra had been with them for less than a month, she was already attached to her. Everyone was, even Glimmer. She appreciated Catra's bluntness and logic, although she didn't exactly show it.

"I think so. I don't have much choice. Scorpia has a crush on Perfuma and I am morally stuck with you guys. I'd hate if something happened to Frosta or Swift Wind." The atmosphere turned lighthearted, almost like old times. They were making jokes and laughing.

"So you're agreeing on babysitting them?" Adora asked with a smirk.

"Since none of you know how to take care of animals and children then yes." And it was true. Adora did try to take care of Swift Wind but she never had time and everybody treated Frosta like a full-grown adult when she was just a child.

“Like you’re so great at it.”

“Definitely better than you all combined.” And it was true. *Totally* true. *Definitely* true, and Adora knew so.

“Come on, you must be tired. You should get some sleep.” Adora suggested with a kind smile and the last squeeze at Catra’s tail. The princess scoffed but reluctantly laid her back on the mattress.

“I really hate being suffocated.”

“I know, I’ll make sure that won’t happen again.”

Adora hesitated for a brief moment, and then proceeded to tuck Catra in the covers, afraid that the skilled warrior who was able to take out on dozens of soldiers alone could get cold in the dark room. “Goodnight.” She whispered.

“Goodnight, Adora.” She heard Catra whisper back before she left the room. When she finally shut the door close all she wanted to do was jump in victory. Catra didn’t reject her when she said they’re friends and told her she was worried about her.

Catra *cared*, and so did Adora.

Chapter End Notes

> Next chapter: the cave of two lovers 🤭
>
> Well folks, we’re finally starting to have some angst. I hope you liked this chapter as much as I enjoyed writing it.
>
> If you want updates on my fics, art and some sneak peeks you can follow me on twitter at @etheriastribe where you’ll also find my CC where you can ask questions anonymously ❤️

Cave of Two Lovers (Omashu)

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes



All of them ran, ran far away from the Fire Nation army.
Since Omashu wasn't located near the coast they had to leave the ship behind in order to reach the city.

Apparently, the motive for going there was for Adora to get King Bumi as her earth bending teacher, which was weird for Catra,

considering that he was very old. It was honestly a miracle he was still *alive*.

They made it inside the cave, but the soldiers were still tracking them.

"Stay behind!" Glimmer shouted before using her earthbending to close the entrance. At least they were safe now.

Bow quickly lit up a torch and made sure that everyone was okay. He then remembered an old story Glimmer would tell him when they were children about a cursed tunnel that lead to Omashu and his blood froze in terror.

"Guys... there's an old story about a secret pass right through the mountains..."

"Is it real or a legend?" Catra asked, examining the hole they were in. It looked too polished to be natural, something or *someone* did it.

"It's a real legend. And it's as old as earth bending itself. It's about two forbidden lovers who came here to meet and made it impossible for everyone else to navigate it."

"Bow, come on now. That was just an old story that my mom used to tell us when we were kids." Glimmer called out with a giggle, still not believing the dangerous situation they were in.

"It's not. I've made some research in my dads' library and it's not a legend. It's *real*."

Adora, not wanting anyone to be scared, clasped her hands together with a wide smile. "Okay then, we'll just have to get through this tunnel."

"Actually, it's not just one tunnel. The lovers didn't want anyone to find out about their love. So they built a whole labyrinth." Catra groaned and almost hit her head on the rock wall on purpose.

“I’m sure we’ll figure it out.” The Avatar tried to cheer up, but Perfuma was already freaking out and annoying the hell out of Mermista.

“Legend says that all you need to do is trust in love, according to the curse.” Glimmer informed, getting Frosta’s attention.

“What exactly is this curse?”

“The curse says that only those that trust in love can make it through the caves. Otherwise, you’ll be trapped in them forever and die.”

Catra took a deep breath and opened her shoulder bag to pull out a sheet of paper and a pencil. “Okay, all we need is a plan. Arrow boy, how long do those torches last and how many do we have?”

“Two hours each. We have ten hours of light.”

“I can use firebending so there’s no need for them.” Adora proposed, lighting her hand on fire, making the Fire Nation Princess roll her eyes in annoyance and jealousy. Annoyance for the show off and jealousy for not being able to do the same thing with such ease.

“I’m gonna make a map to keep track of exactly where we’ve been. Then we should be able to solve it like a maze and get through.”

Three hours passed, and Catra grew more impatient with each passing second .

“Catra, this is the tenth dead end you’ve led us to.” Perfuma pointed out gently, but it still made Catra release fire

from her nostrils in irritation.

“This doesn’t make any sense. We already came through this way!”

“We don’t need a map; we just need love. Isn’t that right, dearest?” Seahawk asked whilst wrapping an arm around Mermista, apparently, they were back together for the fifteenth time. The waterbender sighed. “I mean, yeah, I guess. But I wouldn’t mind knowing where I am.”

Catra examined the map once more. Glimmer told them that this maze was made by earth benders with the purpose to confuse people, but things genuinely didn’t make sense from a logical point of view.

“There’s something strange here. There’s only one explanation: the tunnels are changing.”

Bow shrieked and held onto Glimmer for support. The poor boy was terrified. “It must be the curse! I knew we shouldn’t have come down here!”

“Get a grip over yourself! We’re getting out of here, one way or another.” Catra turned around and started walking, ready to lead the group, but Perfuma kindly rested a hand on her shoulder.

“You look stressed out. How about I take the lead for a while? I’ll draw everything down on the map.” The brunette scoffed and kept on walking, ignoring her.

“It’s called *team* work. You have to trust people if you want to make it out of this tunnel. Just ten minutes, okay?” Catra looked back at Adora, who gave her an encouraging smile. It was over. Still recluntantly, she gave Perfuma the map and pencil.

“Ten. Minutes.”

“Baby steps!” Perfuma gave her a quick hug and then proceeded to walk, leaving Catra stunned for a second. It felt... oddly nice. It

made her feel appreciated, is that what happiness felt like? As if she were light and calm? *Weird*.

The group followed Perfuma and it wasn't long
until Frosta approached Catra.

"Hey!"

The brunette looked down at the child walking next to her. When she first visited the Northern Water Tribe Frosta had been cold and way too formal for two days. The third day she dropped the facade and insisted on spending time with her and Scorpia, highly fascinated by their travels and adventures. Catra recalled the moment of their departure and remembered how Frosta teared up when she left. The experience didn't leave Catra indifferent. She felt guilty about leaving, but it was for everyone's safety. "Hey."

"Thank you for the scroll. And saving us. And trying to help us."

"It was nothing, really. I'm sure you would've gotten out of those situations without my help."

"Yeah, *but* you're awesome when you do it while the rest of us are a hot mess all the time. You seem to have anything under control, how do you do that?" Catra almost smiled at the compliment. She was awesome.

"I have no idea of what I'm doing half of the time. It's just quick thinking. The trick is to not let fear take over you."

"And how exactly do I do that?"

"You start thinking logically. You need to push all strong emotions aside and you'll see things from an entirely different point of view. It takes practice, though."

"You're my hero now." The brunette actually let out a laugh. *Her*, a *hero*? More like a war criminal.

"You literally have the Avatar traveling with you."

“Yeah, but she’s boring!”

“I heard you!” Adora yelled from behind them. She was trying to calm Bow down along with Glimmer, but their attempts were useless. He was terrified.

“Well, thank you Frosta. I really appreciate it.”

“Will you teach me how to throw knives with such precision now?”

“Not even in your dreams. I’m afraid of what you could do with such technique.”

“Defend myself?”

“Kill someone for fun.”

“Touché.”

Catra slowed down her steps until Adora caught up with her, leaving Glimmer with Bow.

“How’s Arrow Boy doing?”

“Having a mental breakdown. He’ll be fine.”

“Cool.” The pair kept on walking in silence until the blonde spoke up again.

“Y’know, Frosta likes you.” The announcement made Catra smile in delight. She was starting to be liked more and more by the whole group, it felt nice.

“You think?”

“I know so. She called you her hero.”

“She’s a cool kid.”

“You should hang out with her more often. She’s looking forward to learn things from you.” Catra rolled her eyes playfully, knowing where Adora was trying to get at.

“I am not teaching her how to throw knifes. It's too dangerous.”

“Aw come one! She won’t get hurt.”

“Oh, I’m not talking about her. I’ve seen how she looks when she gets irritated and I have no doubt that she’d use Seahawk as target practice.”

As the group was walking, Perfuma stepped on a stone that pressed to the ground and soon after the walls around them began crumbling.

“Booby trap!”

Adora saw how the stones above them started falling. She couldn’t let anyone get hurt. With one swift move, she used her airbending to push the rest of the group away from the dangerous zone. Once they were safe, she jumped on Catra to prevent a stone from falling on top of her.

Their bodies were pressed together, hot and sweaty from the action. They stared into each other’s eyes and Catra swore she saw Adora’s looking at her lips for a quick second.

“What are you doing?”

“Keeping rocks from crushing you...?” Adora said, more as a question rather than an actual answer.

“Okay, I’m not crushed. You can get off me now.” Catra’s low and raspy tone sent shivers down her spine. Adora didn’t know why Catra had been making her feel like that ever since she was thirteen, but she liked the feeling, it made her feel fuzzy.

“I’ll take that as a thank you.” She managed to reply with a smug smile. Catra chuckled and the both of them stood up.

“Very well Avatar, can’t you earthbend this?” The princess said with her finger pointed at the newly created wall. Adora looked around, examining the structure, and sighed.

“Too risky. It would only cause more fallout. We’ll have to find another way.”

Catra groaned and squinted her eyes, trying to get a better view of the dark tunnel, but it didn’t work. In order to get a better view, she had to produce fire and use it as a torch, so she opened her right palm and concentrated on the energy inside of her. She took one breath and focused it all on her hand, losing control over the large stream of fire she had produced.

“Woah, easy there!” Adora got closer to Catra and produced fire herself.

“You need to control it.”

“No shit, Sherlock. Let’s go now, we’ll use you as a torch.”

“No,” Adora grabbed Catra’s wrist, stopping her. “Let me teach you. I need you to be able to do this in case something like this happens and I’m not there with you.”

The Avatar grabbed her right hand and opened it kindly. “I know exactly how to help you. You channel your inner rage when firebending, right?”

“Duh, that’s all they’ve taught us.”

“Okay, first of all: that’s a *lot* of rage for such tiny body.” Catra growled as a sign of warning, and Adora listened to her, giving her a nervous smile before proceeding.

“You need to forget all they’ve taught us. Fire is not only destruction, but energy and life, like the sun. You have to stop drawing your bending from rage.”

“Then what else should I use?”

The blonde stood behind her, arms on her shoulders. “Why don’t you try to focus on your determination? You have a lot of it. You want to rescue Scorpia and you are planning to change history with us, right?” Catra slowly nodded, not really knowing where Adora was going with this.

“That’s a lot of desire. Try to use that instead. Anger makes you lose focus and therefore brings chaos. Positive energy helps you manage things a lot easier. Now...”

Adora slowly moved her hands to Catra’s hips and gave a slight squeeze of encouragement, not knowing how *warm* the embrace made the Princess feel.

“Inhale.” Catra took a deep breath.

“Concentrate on positive energy.” And so, she did.

“Exhale.” In that moment Catra remembered Scorpia’s lesson about the two types of energies. Instead of separating them, she focused only on the positive one. It was hard, focusing on something so foreign, but she managed. Concentrating on the few happy memories in her head helped a lot. By the time she opened her eyes, a dim light was coming from her hand. It worked.

“I... I, did it?” Adora started jumping around in excitement and then hugged her tightly.

“You did it! I knew you could. Just wait until I teach you proper firebending. You got over your block!”

Catra scrolled Adora away from her and groaned in frustration. “You’re telling me that I spent thirteen years studying with the best teachers of the Nation for nothing?!”

“Absolutely not! You know a lot of advanced firebending moves -I saw you fight with Hordak- we just need to polish them and then you’ll be good to go. We’re gonna be training buddies, isn’t that awesome?”

Adora kept on rambling about their future training sessions for what felt like hours until they found a round seal. Maybe that was the exit.

“Hey, Avatar, think you can earthbend that?”

“With great pleasure.” Adora cracked her knuckles and proceeded to take a stance with her feet rooted to the ground before opening the seal.

Catra enthusiastically jumped right through it, hoping to finally be out, but it was not the exit.

“It’s a tomb.” Adora said after examining the huge room they had just entered. There was an immense statue in the middle of it with two people kissing, so she went in to examine it.

“It must be the two lovers from the legend. That’s who is buried here.”

Catra touched the monument and then noticed inscriptions on it: they told a story.

“They met on top of the mountain that divided their two villages. The villages were enemies, so they could not be together.”

Adora continued the story. “But their love was strong and they found a way. The two lovers learned earthbending from the badger-moles and became the first earthbenders.”

“They built elaborate tunnels so they could meet secretly. Anyone who tried to follow them would be lost forever in the labyrinth. But one day, the man didn’t come. He died in the war between their two villages. Devastated, the woman unleashed a terrible display of her earthbending power. She could have destroyed them all...” Catra didn’t know why, but the story started to feel like it hit *home* somehow.

“But instead, she declared the war over. Both villages helped her build a new city where they would live together in peace. The

woman’s name was Oma and the man’s name was Shu. The great city was named Omashu as a monument of their love.”

When Adora was done reading, Catra noticed one last inscription. It was bigger than the others, easier to see, easier to read. “Love is brightest in the dark?”

And so, she started thinking. Love is brightest in the dark, and the statue of them kissing. *Could there be a connection between them ?*

Adora suppressed a smile at Catra’s cute frown. Whenever she thought about something her eyebrows would crease and her eyes got lost in a whole different world. It was beautiful, *she* was beautiful.

“Something on your mind?”

Catra snapped out her trance, her face now bright red. “Yeah, but it’s stupid.”

“Spit it out already. I wanna hear it, maybe it could be useful.”

“Promise you won’t judge me?”

“I would never judge you.”

The brunette took a deep breath and spilled her theory out. “The curse says we’ll be trapped in here forever unless we trust in love and here it says ‘love is brightest in the dark’ and has a picture of them kissing.”

Adora started feeling warm inside again for some sort of reason. Yes, she had kissed people along the years, but the idea of kissing Catra made her heart rate double in a couple of seconds. “You think we should...?”

“*Kiss*? Yeah, that’s the stupid part.” Catra dismissed the plan quite quickly with nonchalance, but her red ears couldn’t fool anyone. She was affected by those thoughts too, and Adora noticed it.

"Us, *kissing*." The blonde sighed with dreamy eyes. Okay, maybe she found Catra *attractive*, big deal. Could you blame her? Absolutely no.

"Yeah, I told you, it's crazy. What was I even thinking?"

"Can you imagine that?"

"Yeah, I definitely wouldn't want to kiss *you*." Catra said laughing and then immediately regretted her poor choice of words. *What was she thinking?!*

Adora scoffed and turned her back on Catra, clearly offended. "Oh. Well, I didn't realize it was such a horrible option. Sorry you had to suggest it."

"No, no. I mean... if it was a choice between kissing you and dying..." Catra tried to explain, but that was yet another poor choice in words.

"Oh!"

"What?! I'm saying I would rather *kiss* you than *die*. That's a compliment!" Catra didn't even know why she tried to explain herself, she didn't have to, but felt the need to do so. She felt bad for making Adora think she wasn't good enough to share a kiss.

"Well, I'm not sure which I would rather do. Let's go. I bet the others are already out."

"How are we going to get out of this? Are we going to survive? Are we about to die?" Bow questioned as the group kept on marching, Glimmer giving the lead. They kept on wandering

around the tunnels for hours and only found dead end after dead end.

“Ugh, shut up already!” Frosta complained to him once he clung behind her. It was ridiculous.

“We would be already out if my dearest trusted in love, trusted in *me*.”

“Yeah... no. I’d rather hear Adora complain about Catra again than to trust you.”

“How do you think those two are doing?” Perfuma asked, and Glimmer let out a harsh laugh.

“The legend says to trust in love. Knowing them, they’re probably at each other’s throats by now.” The Earth Princess sighed in boredom, she wasn’t scared of being trapped in the cave, she had her bending after all. The only problem was how unstable the whole structure became after triggering that booby trap, but they were far from the crime scene, so it would’ve been safe to earthbend their way out, right?

Glimmer hushed the group and laid one hand on the wall with closed eyes. Then, took a deep breath and concentrated on possible vibrations signaling instability. It was a trick her father taught her before his... departure.

“We’re clear!” She announced happily after a minute or so of detecting any type of danger, which was none. Glimmer took a wide stance and earthbent the wall to create a new opening for the group.

“We’re getting out of here!”

“I’m tired of walking in circles! We’ve been wandering for hours! What are we going to do?” Catra said once they reached yet another end. Her mind was already going crazy. Adora sighed and stopped her tracks to look at her in the eyes.

“What can *we* do?” Catra’s ear pinned back to her head, already blushing heavily.

“You mean...?” Adora walked up closer to her with a smirk.

“Unless you want to die. But I’ve heard you say you’d rather kiss me than to do that.”

“Moron.”

“So?”

Catra didn’t even have to think about it. “Yes.” She whispered hoarsely.

Catra saw Adora give up the fire in order to rest her hands on her small waist. Their foreheads were touching and
the magicat rose up to her toes in order to get closer to those rosy lips of hers.

Adora took a moment to take in the view of having Catra like that. Her face was flushed and the tip of her nose was deep red, simply mesmerizing.

Catra’s breath got heavier once Adora squeezed her waist and the fire in her hands turned blue.

“Let’s just get this over with. I’m not planning on—” Catra trailed on, but got cut off by Adora’s lips landing on hers. Her hands abandoned the fire in order to lay on the blonde’s shoulders, pulling her slightly closer.

Adora wasn’t aggressive or hungry during a single part of it. She took her time and kissed her softly, slowly. *Catra didn’t like that*, she wanted more. Just as she was about to turn the kiss into an

open-mouthed one, Adora pulled away with a dopey grin on her face.

"Hey, look! It leads to the exit." She pointed at the ceiling, where glowing crystals led the way out.

"Y-Yeah. Let's go." Catra ordered and walked past her, not wanting to talk about her *first* kiss ever.

It had somehow been perfect and disappointing at the same time. Perfect because that's how a first kiss should've gone: slow and steady. Disappointing because Catra craved for more without any valid reason. She wanted for it to be longer, more passionate, intense, something else.

The two women reached the exit, they were finally out in the open. They did it! Both of them jumped excitedly and even shared a hug that was quickly stopped once they realized their proximity and pulled awkwardly away.

"Good job, colleague."

"You're not too bad of a kisser either."

At those teasing words Catra hissed, not wanting to go over the touchy subject. The blonde playfully wiggled her eyebrows at her before turning her smile into a frown after looking at their surrounding.

"Where are the others?"

Right in that moment, part of the mountain crumbled as an exit was created by a motivated Glimmer. Bow teared up and immediately threw himself on the ground with his stomach on the air, savoring the sun kissing his skin again.

"How did you get out?" Frosta inquired. Catra and Adora shared a quick look before moving their eyes elsewhere and blushing.

“Just like the legend says— we let love lead the way.” Catra lowly growled as a warning, earning a chuckle and Adora ruffling her hair. Mermista raised a suspicious eyebrow at the newly –and unexpected- formed couple.

“Really? We let Glimmer lead our way.”

After a quick catching up session, the group started walking towards the city.

“The journey was long and annoying, but now you get to see what it’s really about: the destination.” Glimmer trailed off with smugness that soon became shock.

“I present to you, the Earth Kingdom city of O-” Turned out that it wasn’t Earth Kingdom anymore: it was Fire Nation’s. The huge flag on the wall gave it away pretty quickly.

Glimmer quickly trapped Catra in a pile of solid earth, immobilizing her.

“What did *you* do?!” She asked in pure madness. Before replying, the princess exhaled fire out of her nostrils.

“I did nothing!”

“Quit playing! I remembered you having to conquer Omashu and then mentioning their efficient mailing system. I’m gonna ask this one more time: *what did you do*?”

The air became thicker as the two of them had a stare down. Everyone felt betrayed by their newest ally. Adora however, believed Catra when she answered the first time. She didn’t lie, and told the truth. Adora could read it in the eyes.

“I’m gonna reply this one more time: *nothing*. I was supposed to conquer it but I left before I could do anything. And yes, I visited it through one of my travels as a *nomad*, not as a colonizer.”

Glimmer got closer to her, their foreheads almost touching. She searched for any slip ups, flinching ear, fearful eyes, anything. But Catra stayed still, her head still high. She was being truthful.

"Fine, you didn't do it." Catra was free again and everyone looked relieved, joyful even. "But I still hold you accountable for it. Your father did it, and he wants you back to follow his footsteps. For all that matters, this is also your fault."

"I didn't do shit and there's a reason why I don't want to go back."

"Right, until *we* defeat your daddy and do the job for you. Then you'll be very happy to go back home and have all the power to yourself."

Catra almost gripped her dagger in outrage, but decided not to, after all she was trying to prove them, she was a good person, so she opted for a single scoff.

"This is horrible, but we need to move on." Bow suggested a devastated Adora, but she was too stubborn to let go.

"No. I'm going in to find Bumi."

"Adora, stop. We don't even know if he's still..."

"What? If he's still what?"

Bow sighed uncomfortably before replying. "*Around.*"

"Why can't you just let it go? You've pretty much mastered earthbending." Adora knew that the group was trying to help, but all she needed was a simple lecture, a few more words from her old teacher.

"Not yet, he told me I still had one more lesson to learn before becoming a true master. He said I had to wait until I was ready, and I am. I know I am." Adora didn't waste any time and opened her airbender staff before flying to the city.

“Adora, no!” Bow called out, but it was already too late.

“Great, how are we going to get inside the city now?”

“I know a secret passage.” Catra suggested.

“I hate sewers, I hate sewer’s water, and I hate you for having this stupid idea.” Mermista groaned as she kept everyone dry with the help of Perfuma and Frosta. The group got out of the gross location by coming out of a manhole that was placed near a building under construction.

“Now we just need to find Adora.”

“How are we going to find her? The city is huge!” Immediately after Bow’s words, loud yells could be heard from the construction site. Not only was Adora fighting against Fire Nation soldiers, but the city’s resistance was backing her up in battle.

Catra saw in this an opportunity to free the citizens of this city. Although the fight seemed to be evened out it was only a matter of time before more Fire Nation soldiers showed up as backup units.

“Bow, Seahawk and Perfuma: gather as many citizens as you can and lead them out of the city’s gates.” The three of them nodded and left in a hurry.

“Glimmer, Mermista and Frosta: defend Adora and let her talk with king Bumi, I’ll be helping you. Come on, we don’t have much time!”

They sprinted towards the top of the undone statue that was being built as a tribute for Fire Lord Prime. On their way up they

had to fight a few soldiers, but it was an easy task.

Once they reached the destination, Adora's face lit up in happiness as she kept on fighting. King Bumi in the meanwhile was trapped in a metal coffin at the end of a broken chain that Adora had already split previously.

"You came!"

"Couldn't let you do this all by yourself, I want some of the glory." Catra replied, pulling out her dual swords and starting to fight along the other two women.

Adora saw an opening and approached the ruler of the city.

"King Bumi, are you okay? Why did the Fire Nation conquer Omashu, how did that happen?" She asked, knowing her friends would back her up in case anyone tried to approach her.

"Oh, I surrendered." He stated with a laugh. Adora couldn't understand his logic. He had always been crazy but also wise in his own ways. He knew what was truly the right thing to do, but surrendering to the Fire Nation had been something extremely stupid to do.

"Listen to me Adora. There are options in fighting called jing. It's a choice of how you direct your energy."

"I know! There's positive jing when you're attacking and negative jing when you're retreating."

"And neutral jing: when you do nothing." Well, that was new. Bumi always told her about positive and negative, but never neutral.

"There are *three* jings?"

"Well, technically there are eighty-five. But let's just focus on the third. Neutral jing is the key to earthbending. It involves listening and waiting for the right moment to strike."

Realization hit Adora. Bumi did the right thing, although she still didn't know exactly why. "That's why you surrendered, isn't it?"

"Yes, and it's why I can't leave now." She sighed, *who was going to teach her the third type?*

"I guess I need to find someone else to teach me neutral jing."

"You already have two valid candidates." The king looked at Catra and Glimmer's direction, but it didn't make sense for Adora, Catra wasn't even an earthbender to begin with.

"Goodbye Adora, I'll see you when the time is right."

"Goodbye, Bumi."

In the meanwhile, the three women fought along the resistance and managed to overthrow the Fire Nation soldiers. But once the fight was over, they noticed the daughter of the Fire Lord and wasted no time in trapping her in a cage made out of rock.

"Fire Nation princess! You'll be coming with us and answer for justice!" The leader of the resistance said, but Glimmer rolled her eyes in annoyance and disassembled the cage with ease.

"I know it's hard to believe, but she's actually on the good side now. She's free to go."

The man tried to contest the decision, but he could do nothing compared to the princess' authority.

Catra smirked teasingly and stuck out her tongue at them as she made her way over her group.

"Let's go." Adora ordered. They did not complain, and followed the Avatar outside the gates. There, Bow, Seahawk and Perfuma were already waiting for them, the city's inhabitants were in the background; they evacuated the city.

“So, what did Bumi tell you? Are you already a master?” Bow asked with a smile that was not reciprocated by her.

“Told me I had to master neutral jing.” She then pointed at Catra and Glimmer. “He said you two are valid candidates to teach me.”

The two girls shared a confused look. They didn’t even know what that meant.

“Neutral jing is when you do nothing. People who use it usually know when and exactly how to strike.”

At that Glimmer wondered. Her dad told her about not making the first move, but react to the environment surrounding her. He always walked barefoot in order to feel the “vibrations” better. Being an infant, Glimmer didn’t understand his words until now.

“I- I think I know what he meant. My father used neutral jing.”

At those words, Adora smiled. Progress.

Chapter End Notes

Well folks, what can I say? The Catradora kiss happened, yes, but that doesn't mean they'll be endgame soon... right? Let me know of your thoughts about this chapter in the comments! I'll be reading and replying :D

Bonding

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes



The team reached a quarry on their way back to Ba Sing Se. It was filled with sheer cliffs, multi-tiered terraces, and arches made out of solid rocks and boulders; perfect location for some earthbending training.

That was their last day spent together as a group. The morning after Frosta, Mermista and Perfuma were all going back to their respective kingdoms in order to prepare better for the day of the

solar eclipse, ready to strike. Seahawk offered to chaperone Frosta on her way home –after all she was a child- and then reach Mermista at the Southern Water Tribe.

Everyone was excited for the war to finally end and high spirits had been gathered from everywhere among the rebels of all three nations.

Well, not exactly everyone; Adora was terrified to say the least. The Fire Lord was the best firebender of the Nation, not to mention how much protection and guards he had around him at all times. What if she couldn't land the final streak before the eclipse was over? What if she couldn't kill him because of her good nature?

A lot of pressure was on Adora's shoulders. The faith of the World depended on her. She was supposed to bring balance back, no matter what.

"Okay vibrations! Kick in!" Glimmer yelled in frustration. The both of them had been standing still for half an hour, trying to understand the "neutral jing" that King Bumi told them about.

The rest of the group watched amused as they kept failing and Catra even let out an hysterical laughter.

"How about you cooperate instead? King Bumi said you should be teaching Adora too."

At Glimmer's words she let out another chuckle. "That old man doesn't know what he's talking about. I'm not even an earthbender to begin with."

"I need all the help I can get with this. After mastering the neutral jing I'll be a true earthbending master." Adora trailed off with a playful glare to her old friend. "What I do not need is your bratty butt laughing at us. At least Glimmer is trying to help."

The brunette scoffed and jumped off the rock where she was sitting on.

“Alright alright. Okay, I’m pretty sure that if you want the vibrations you need to be in direct contact with the ground. That means no shoes. Take them out.”

“Is that why you don’t wear any? Because of the vibrations?” Adora asked, already barefoot.

“More or less...? I like to feel the earth under my feet so it doesn’t shift or make any noise. I’m pretty sure it’ll help you two with this ‘jing’ thing. Now, can I go back to minding my business?”

“Your business consists on making fun of us.”

“Exactly, Sparkles!”

Glimmer rolled her eyes, but quickly went back with their training. The two women had to predict which movement they were going to do by trying to feel the vibrations, but each time they failed to and dodged the attacks at the last moment.

Catra scoffed in annoyance, earning angry stares from the two women, but she didn’t mind.

“Okay, I’m no genius, but I think you’ll have to stop relying on your eyesight if you truly want to feel what’s really happening. Use some damn blindfolds.”

“I thought you had no idea on how to help us.”

“Trust me princess, I have no idea on what I’m doing either, but what you two are doing is totally wrong. You purely rely on your sights. That’s tricky.”

“How do you know all this?”

The heir of the throne couldn’t believe how naive Adora had been all this time. Was she really not aware on how much developed her senses were compared to hers?

“I try to use as many senses as possible; my hearing and smell abilities have helped me a lot in battle. Not to mention the shifts I can feel with my feet. Since you’re not like me I’d advise you to close your eyes and rely on your touch.”

“That’s... actually very smart Catra. You really are a genius!” Glimmer beamed with enthusiasm. This was definitely a start of a new friendship.

The two earthbenders went back to practice and got hurt, a lot. The first attempts were absolutely painful and they failed, but after hours and hours they were able to tell where their opponent was located and did their best to strike each other with hits that occasionally landed.

Glimmer found it easier to do since she was somehow trained in it. Adora, on the other hand, refused to stop trying until a rock was thrown at her and landed on her right shoulder, causing great pain.

Mermista hurried up and began the healing process, but it took all of Catra’s willpower not to lash out at Glimmer for hurting Adora. Instead, she just watched the scene on the distance.

Glimmer apologized and did everything she could to assist but Adora insisted on being fine, infuriating the feline even more.

Catra kept watching over Adora -from a hundred feet away, no way she’d get close to her- until the Earth Princess sat next to her on the ground.

“This seat taken?”

“Yeah, by you.” Glimmer chuckled, but Catra kept her gaze on the blonde. She made a grimace when Mermista focused on a particular area of the injury, alarming Catra on the instant.

“Don’t worry, she’s a wimp. Mermista is the best healer of the Southern Water Tribe. Adora will be just fine.”

“Next time you should go easier on each other.” Catra replied coldly. The irrational part of her brain was stuck on thinking it was her fault for telling them to use blindfolds, but, at the end of the day, it was the right thing to do.

“We will. I did get a bit excited and let things get out of hands, but I’ll be more gentle next time.”

“Good.”

Glimmer tried to touch Catra’s shoulder to show solidarity, but figured they weren’t that close... yet.

“Hey, uh... I wanted to apologize.”

“For what?”

“Everything.” Now Catra turned her attention to Glimmer, looking at her right in the eyes.

“Treating you as a prisoner, trapping you, accusing you of doing war crimes and blaming you for what your father has done.”

Catra almost flinched at the word “father”. How they were related it was a mystery for her. She most definitely took the looks from her mother, whoever that woman had been.

“Yeah well,” I don’t blame you; I’d blame myself too. “it’s fine.”

“I hope we can be friends.” What was it with everyone trying to become her friend? Why were they even trying? It didn’t make any sense from a logical point of view.

“One step at a time.”

“Sure. I uh...” Glimmer struggled to continue. It was hard for her to apologize since she had always been stubborn all her life, but Bow had to beg her to try make amends with Catra.

So far so good, she didn't get clawed and they weren't even at each other's throats. The hard part however, was admitting she had been wrong the whole time.

"I thought King Bumi was crazy for saying you had something to teach us, but I was wrong. You really are a strong asset with your knowledge and abilities. You've helped us a lot this far so... thank you for helping us."

The two women stared at each other in an awkward silence that eventually became a shy chuckle. Neither of them could believe it. Both so different and yet so similar at the same time.

Then, Adora approached them, her shoulder already healed by Mermista.

"Catra, Catra! Let's train!" She proposed with puppy eyes. *Disgusting*. Catra didn't have the time to reply before she was dragged away from the group to an isolated area of the quarry.

"Okay, master Avatar, what do you want to teach me?" Catra asked with boredom in her tone. She really wasn't looking forward her training in firebending.

"I want you to just produce a flame, like last time. Can you do that?"

The princess rolled her eyes and grunted before opening her palm. Out of it came out a large stream of fire, too much. Catra immediately closed her hand, stopping the motion.

"Positive energy. Remember what I taught you, pupil Catra."

"Shut up."

"You started it."

With Adora being annoying, finding what she was looking for was quite difficult, but like last time, she focused on the few happy memories she had and recalled those emotions out.

This time, when she opened her hand, a moderated flame came out. It was also easier to control too.

“That’s it! It’s easier now, right?” Catra slowly nodded, trying to maintain her calm and not show too much enthusiasm.

“Now try to intensify it.”

The brunette obeyed orders for once and focused a little bit more energy on the palm, just enough to make the flame grow a bit wider.

“I knew you had it in you. Everyone was wrong about you and I knew it!” Catra smiled at her direction, and then let the flame vanish in an instant only to try –and succeed- the same move on the other one, leaving Adora more awestruck.

“You finally got over your block.”

“Can we fight now?” Adora took a few steps back and chuckled.

“I don’t think so. It’d be unfair.”

“Aw, you’re right. I’d be afraid too if I were fighting against someone like me.”

At those words Adora dropped the playful attitude while Catra still continued to challenge her. “What’s that supposed to mean?”

“It means: I can take you down with two simple moves.”

Adora couldn’t handle being insulted like that. She was the Avatar, Catra was only being too cocky.

“Fine, but I’ll only use fire against you.” Catra didn’t object, but she did threw all of her weapons to the ground. In a matter of seconds a pile was made. It contained daggers, swords, a couple of fans, arrow-like stilettos, a large variety of knives and even a boomerang.

“Just to make it even. I don’t like having much advantage over my opponent.”

“Oh, you’re so on.”

Adora slightly bent her legs and rooted her feet to the ground, ready to fight.

Catra analyzed her stance and recognized it as the earthbending one. She wasted no time and ran towards Adora, whom tried to strike a punch on her face. However, Catra was too smart and waited for the last moment before lowering herself and performing a fire kick at her calfs, making Adora fall to the ground without giving her a chance to react.

“Told ya.”

Adora was too impressed to even say anything.

The team was having fun at the bonfire at night. They were talking, laughing, enjoying each other’s company. Seahawk had just told a hilarious story involving fire and everyone laughed only to be interrupted by Perfuma shushing them and pointing at Frosta’s tent, where the pre-teen was sleeping peacefully.

“Okay, now it’s time for Catra to tell some stories!” Glimmer suggested and everybody cheered.

The brunette scoffed and looked away reluctantly.

“No way. I don’t know what to talk about.”

“You travelled a lot, right? Talk about your adventures.” Mermista groaned at Bow, earning a glare from the boy.

“Honestly: no. I’ve heard all of her adventures already. When she came to my village, she kept on telling the children her life story - omitting coming from *royalty*.”

“Yeah, Scorpia did tell me all of your crazy stories for days and days. No offense, but I don’t want to listen to *all* of that again.”

“Okay then; we ask you a question and you answer.”

“Sparkles: no.”

“We don’t know you. All I know from you is that you’re moody and kind of an emo. It’s only fair.”

Catra looked around, everyone was ready to pamper her with questions, so there wasn’t anything she could do at that point.

“Best part about being the only heir to the throne of the Fire Nation.” Mermista ordered and the princess thought about it for a second. Why not drop two truth bombshells in one?

“I’m not the only heir. I am first in line though. I liked the way everyone’s jaw fell to the ground after learning that I am in fact Prime’s biological child.”

“Wait, who’s the second in line?!” Seahawk shrieked.

“Do you remember that pale and tall guy, admiral Hordak?” everyone nodded and Adora smirked, knowing what was about to happen.

“That’s my uncle.” They gasped, and she continued.

“Long story short, he’s always been jealous of his brother and was considered as a weakling and Prime doesn’t want him on the throne if he passes away. Probably why the Fire Lord wants me back home.”

“What about your mom?” Perfuma asked with sympathy written all over her face. Catra didn’t understand why though. She could not miss someone she had never met in the first place.

“Father told me she was a noble woman. She died shortly after giving birth to me.”

“I’m so sorry.” The brunette shrugged casually and ate the last piece of meat in her plate.

“It’s fine. I don’t even remember how she looked or sounded like. Can’t really miss her if I don’t even remember her existence.”

“On lighter topics...!” Glimmer announced, trying to ease the atmosphere.

“First kiss. When, where, who, how?”

Oh no. Catra was screwed. Her heart rate quickened its pace in a matter of a few seconds. No way she was going to embarrass herself by admitting that Adora was her first kiss.

“Better not lie. My dad taught me how to spot a liar through earthbending.” Well, crap. Now she was screwed.

“All right all right. When: about a week ago.” All of them cheered except for Adora, she almost looked saddened by it.

“You kissed someone at Omashu? We were there for like an hour! You are a true heartbreaker.” Seahawk admitted and Catra felt almost flattered if that would’ve been the truth.

“I can’t believe you had you first kiss this recently.”

“Yeah, well, y’know Arrow Boy, I didn’t have time to meet new people with all of my travels.”

“This means you kissed one of us! And I’m gonna find out who!” Mermista announced and Adora finally realized the truth.

“I was your first kiss?!”

“Adora was your first kiss?!” Everyone repeated after her. Cheers erupted in a matter of seconds until Frosta yelled at them to shut up.

“It’s not a big deal. We were trapped in that cave and that was the last solution.”

“Was it good?” Bow asked teasingly, and Catra blushed. She didn’t reply, but the ears pinned at the back of her head and her deep red nose gave it away immediately.

“Oh my gosh, you enjoyed it!”

“Shut up Sparkles. I didn’t enjoy it, it was... meh.” But Glimmer’s smirk didn’t fade, in fact, it grew wider. Right, she knew if Catra was telling the truth.

“Thank you very much for the compliment.” Adora added sarcastically and then continued. “But since you have no one else to compare me to you better shut up.”

“You are the worst kiss I’ve ever had.”

“I’m also the best.”

That was it. An utterly embarrassed Catra left the bonfire to go hide in her sleeping bag. She wasn’t tired enough to sleep, but she didn’t move either, refusing to interact. She didn’t feel humiliated, rather exposed, which was worse. Glimmer knew she liked the kiss.

Adora looked at Catra with heart eyes as she stepped away from them. Being someone’s first kiss made her feel special and by judging Glimmer’s wide grin, Catra lied about the kiss being just ‘meh’. Needless to say, cockiness invaded her mind pretty quickly and remained there for the rest of the night.

With the passing of hours, the laughter and chatting eventually died down, leaving Adora as the last standing among her friends. Everyone had already retired back to their tents but she enjoyed to watch the stars by herself every once in a while, it brought her peace of mind. The stars were so beautiful, etherial even. Ever since she was a kid she was fascinated by them. They lit up the dark sky along with the moon. She memorized every existing constellation with ease and enjoyed the beautiful art created by those celestial bodies.

Adora's sightseeing got interrupted by the sound of rustling that came from Catra's sleeping bag. She didn't even hesitate for a moment before approaching her friend.

"You awake?"

What a stupid question, Catra thought. Instead of using bitterness, she used sarcasm to reply. "No, I'm sleeping. Can't you see that my eyes are open? That means I'm dreaming already."

Adora chuckled and rolled her eyes playfully at her.

"Very funny. Can I ask you a question?" Adora's eyes demonstrated hope and the trembling lips showed uncertainty.

"You just did."

"Catra."

"Just spit it out already. I'm tired."

The blonde whistled and then started shivering.

"It's kinda cold out here, isn't it?"

"Get to the point."

“Do you wanna -I don’t know- sleep in my tent? There’s plenty of space for you to fit in.”

Catra sat up with a frown. “Are you inviting me to a sleepover?”

Adora smiled widely with closed eyes and her head cocked to the side. She looked adorable. “Sure.”

And then came the obvious question. “Why?”

It wasn’t accusatory or suspicious, just curious.

“I see you shiver every night. In the Earth Kingdom winter is coming and it’s very cold. I’m not letting you suffer.”

“Are you sure this isn’t because you have a big fat crush on me?”

Old, naughty Catra, always ready to tease Adora. If she had only known that her question made the Avatar’s heart flutter maybe she would’ve kept her mouth shut for once.

“I- I don’t-! Ugh. It’s cozy in there. I know you like warmth so I thought you’d enjoy it. Do you want to spend another night in the cold?”

Catra rolled her eyes with fake annoyance and waved her hand at Adora’s face casually.

“Whatever. I’m going in just because I’m tired of bugs crawling over me at night.” She stood up with the sleeping bag and headed to the big yellow tent.

“This is not because I like you.” She remarked, but Adora only raised her left eyebrow teasingly, knowing she was lying. She did like her, maybe not like that, but they were still friends after all. At the very least Catra tolerated her presence enough to spend the night together.

"Do you like it?" Adora asked in the silence that fell upon them once they got inside. Catra wasted no time on turning her back on her and closed her eyes.

"It's fine." The princess muttered under breath, but it wasn't enough to reassure Adora.

"Is it warm enough?"

"Just peachy."

"Are you comfortable?"

Catra groaned and turned around, looking at the blonde right in the eyes. "Adora, I'm trying to sleep."

"Right. Sorry sorry."

The Avatar didn't say anything else and focused on Catra closing her eyes again. She looked so peaceful whenever she slept, it was one of the few moments when she'd just stay still and relax for real. Not like when she faked being calm whenever she was around her father or Shadow Weaver.

Adora caught a glimpse of movement from her claws and drew in a sharp breath, careful enough to not wake her up. Once they retracted back, she still did not move. No way she was going to ruin the moment by-

"Stop being so stiff. Dude, relax." Yeah, being herself.

"Sorry. I didn't mean to wake you up." Catra slowly opened her eyes back up. She wasn't pissed, rather concerned.

"You still have trouble sleeping?"

Adora gulped and slowly nodded, ready to be made fun of, but Catra moved closer to her, nuzzling her head just under her chin.

“Catra, what are you doing?”

No response was heard, but a low purr filled the air. The vibrations immediately calmed Adora down, although she was bursting of happiness on the inside.

Catra used to do this for her when they were children to ease her whenever she felt anxious or stressed. Catra *remembered* and Catra *cared*, even after all those years.

The blonde smiled and then lovingly wrapped her arms around her tiny body, pulling her closer.

“Thanks. I think it’s working.”

“No problem. Can we get back to sleep?”

She wanted to say yes, but Adora made everything she could to make this moment last.

“So... I was your first kiss, huh?”

“Don’t you dare tease me about it.” Catra’s tone was harsh, but the rumbling of her chest got louder once she hid her face deeper in Adora’s golden hair.

“I wasn’t going to. I just thought that - I don’t know- you and Scorpia looked pretty close.”

The princess didn’t like the statement. Scorpia did have a crush on her in the past, but Catra made sure to let her know they were going to be only friends, best friends.

“Just friends.” She mumbled and moved her soft cheek to rub under Adora’s jawline, marking her as to prove a point.

“That’s cool, I get it. Just friends.” Adora sounded relieved by the confession, and this sparked Catra’s attention. After a few seconds of silence, she asked her about her first kiss.

“It happened a few years ago, probably before you met Frosta. Well, she had an older sister...”

“Princess Yue.”

“You know about her?”

“Kinda had to, father forced me to study all the monarchs from across the nations. If I didn't remember a single name or some stupid fact about the history I'd get punished. Father said it's important to know your enemy in order to defeat them.”

“Yue was my first kiss.”

Catra’s ears pinned back to her head. She fucked up. Maybe talking about your dead lover wasn’t the best idea ever.

“Look who’s nervous now.”

“I didn’t mean to.”

“It’s fine, you didn’t know.” Adora replied, although there was a hint of sadness in her voice.

“We kissed and then I found out she was already betrothed to someone else. We tried being friends but we couldn’t keep our hands off each other. Then the Fire Nation came and... they did what they do best: destroy.”

Adora was almost on the verge of tears, but Catra did something unexpected. She hugged her tightly and drew lazy circles on her back to soothe her back to calm.

“Yue had to sacrifice herself to save everyone. I wasn’t strong enough to stop it. I could’ve done more.”

“I’m sure you did your best. Stop bringing yourself down like that. You are amazing.”

“I’m the Avatar. I’m supposed to bring peace and balance and so far, I’ve been failing.”

“You’re Adora. You’re human, and like all humans, you are bound to make mistakes. But you’re not alone in this, we’re all with you.”

The tall woman squeezed her friend tighter, showing all the affection she felt in that moment. “Thank you, that really helped.”

“You’re welcome.”

But Adora couldn’t let go of the topic.

“How was the kiss?” She asked, faking nonchalance. The Avatar panicked on the inside. What if she traumatized Catra with a terrible kiss? Yes, Glimmer told her Catra was lying about how she really felt, but maybe Glimmer was wrong.

“Seriously Adora?!” The blonde chuckled and then proceeded to reply teasingly:

“Come on! I need to know if I have to work on my kissing skills.”

Catra reluctantly looked up at her with a deep red blush that extended all the way to her neck. “It was good. Happy now?”

“Did you like it?”

“I just told you it was good.”

“Doesn’t mean you necessarily liked it.”

Catra bit the inside of her cheek, trying to hide a shy smile trying to get out. Adora sure was a dumb idiot.

“I uh- I guess so. I don’t know.” This made Adora worry immediately. What did she mean by that?!

"I-I mean it's like... I expected it to be different. You were so slow and steady while all I wanted to do was..." *More*. Catra couldn't say that and scare her like that. She didn't even know what she meant by 'more'.

"I understand. You are a ferocious little beast who loves action and passion." Catra let out a guttural growl, warning Adora of her poor choice of words, but then nodded in agreement.

"I guess, it's something like that."

And then Adora did the unthinkable: "Let me make it up to you."

Catra's breath hitched as her eyes relocated north again.

"This is not funny, Adora."

"I'm not joking. I was your first kiss. I should've made sure you enjoyed yourself as best as you could." Adora said, her face serious. It sent shivers down Catra's spine, but she played it cool.

"Of course, you always aspire to be the best."

"Obviously I do. It's you I'm talking about. You deserve the best." Catra's ears were pinned back to her head at Adora's low and raspy voice. We're they really going to kiss again?

The blonde's hand moved to rest against Catra's cheek and she quickly eased on the touch, rubbing her face on the soft palm.

"Yes, you may redeem yourself for you terrible kiss." Catra whispered with a hint of playfulness that was quickly reciprocated when Adora's lips met hers once again. It started the same way, slow and steady, but when the kisses became longer, the eagerness grew among the two women.

Not having ever done this, Catra didn't dare to make the first move, but she didn't have to. Adora took the lead and their lips started performing open-mouthed kisses. They were much more

passionate and close to what Catra originally wanted, but still not enough.

"Let go. It's just us."

The barrier broke. Catra moved her hands on Adora's shoulders, trying to pull her closer. She eagerly reciprocated the kisses with more passion and speed.

Once the kisses got too sloppy and involved too much teeth, Adora tugged at the base of Catra's tail, making her break them apart to release a soft whine.

Ever since they were children Catra had been sensitive when it came to her tail and ears, she showed discomfort. But now, now she seemed delighted, as if she were enjoying the pain.

Adora took advantage of the situation to take control back. She gently inserted her tongue inside of Catra's mouth.

Yes, she did say she wanted something more lust-driven, but nobody liked to have a tongue shoved down their throats without any warning. Catra gasped loudly at the beginning, not expecting the intrusion, but then she eased in again, and experimentally moved her tongue against Adora's. In a matter of a few seconds, they were fighting for dominance again in an endless battle that seemed to last centuries for them.

The princess felt so satisfied, fulfilled even. She had never felt this alive in years. Enclosed in Adora's muscular and warm arms and surrounded by her curvy body; she had never found herself this excited and yet relaxed. As the kiss kept going, Catra got too comfortable and a low rumble started forming from her chest, making Adora giggle and ruining the moment. It tickled.

"Was this better?"

"Not... not not— not bad." Catra whispered, looking away from her face. But then, a question invaded her mind.

“Was I good?”

Adora smiled down at her.

“Just perfect.”

Chapter End Notes

Yes, they’ve kissed, no, they will not be dating yet SUE ME.
About Catra’s family: it’s definitely fucked up.

Unexpected Guest

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes



Home sweet home!" Glimmer announced proudly once the smaller group reached their destination at Ba Sing Se.

The goodbyes were left as short and quick but still a bit emotional. They were aware they'd be seeing each other soon but parting ways in the middle of a war meant not really knowing if the others were going to potentially *die* or stay *alive*.

They all hugged, including Catra. Well, she didn't exactly reciprocate the hugs -except to Frosta- but she didn't pull away either. The princess silently thanked Mermista for not embracing her with a quick nod. They liked each other, sure, that didn't mean they were comfortable with physical contact. In fact, Mermista was in Catra's same situation, being forced into cuddling -so, they understood one another.

Adora sighed in delight at being back at the Royal Palace. She was tired of traveling all the time. *Peace, at last.*

The Queen met them at the entrance with a wide smile and greeted them with a formal bow. *Of course*, royal protocol.

"Mom! You can't believe the things we've seen! First of all, General Fong is crazy, then we went to the secret love cave, it's not a legend! It so—"

"I can't wait to hear your report, really. But you must be so tired after such long travel. How about you all settle down in your rooms until dinner? I have delightful news for you."

Glimmer wanted to know right there and then, but the Queen kindly dismissed the group. Catra still didn't know where the chamber was supposed to be, so, the only option consisted on asking the guards following -*only*- her. They weren't very subtle about it, but they didn't care either. The future Fire Lord figured out it'd be like that, trust couldn't be built in a matter of a few weeks, especially when it came to the enemy.

Once she reached the chamber, she closed herself in it, finally alone. Well, kind of, the guards were still outside, ready to take action in case anything happened. Catra walked around the large room. It somehow resembled one of the royal chambers at the Royal Palace back at the Fire Nation, but it expressed comfort instead of anguish.

Back at her old room, everything was red coded in different shades, but they were all dark. Catra never felt at ease in her own room, but she couldn't get out of there either. Being the Princess meant being watched over and protected at all hours.

But here, the tones were gentle, the bed was soft and there was even a waterfall. The walls were covered in shiny crystals. Everything looked so perfect, *too* perfect.

The vanity's mirror reflected her and this was the first time in years she had the opportunity to take a good look at herself.

Her hair looked decent, but the shine that once was there is gone, product of many years without the proper care.

The face was sun-kissed and the freckles on her face doubled since she was a fourteen. Her skin, although basically flawless, was covered in dirt.

After analyzing herself for a few minutes Catra decided to take a shower and *oh boy* was she glad to have made that decision. The water was piping hot, almost resembling lava's temperature; therefore, it was just fine for her.

The winter was coming and the temperature was dropping drastically with each passing day, she didn't like it. That was one of the reasons why she looked forward the siege and coming back to the Fire Nation. In her own state it was always hot, so she had never suffered the cold until she ran away.

Aside from guards following her at all times, Catra wasn't being treated like a prisoner at all.

After settling in, Adora, Bow and Glimmer all reunited in the Earth Princess' room. They couldn't spend a single moment without one another.

"We're finally back. I've missed my own bed so much!" Glimmer sighed in relief, and Adora couldn't help but wonder how Catra was adapting.

Her bed at the Fire Nation was soft, yes, but the Earth Kingdom's beds were absolute *fluff*. The first night spent in her new room Adora literally sunk into the mattress. What if Catra sunk in too? What if she was suffocating and calling her name and-?

“Adora, you okay?” Bow asked with worry, but she smiled nervously.

“We should check up on Catra, don’t you think? Help her settle in and all that stuff.”

Glimmer sighed dramatically and looked up from the paper scroll where she was writing her report. “Hey Adora, do you think I should include your *kiss* with Catra in the cave? You know how my mom demands *all* the details.”

Adora blushed intensely at the memory. Catra liked but also hated that kiss while Adora absolutely treasured it. But it was nothing compared to the second one. It was passionate, intense, and most importantly: Catra enjoyed and participated more.

Adora loved how she squirmed beneath her touch, how she gasped whenever their lips parted and the little sounds of delight that came out of her mouth every now and then, encouraging Adora to keep going.

“Whatever, I-I don’t care.” She replied with red cheeks.

“I still can't believe you were her first kiss. That’s so *cute*.” Bow said with dreamy eyes. He was a sucker for romance stories.

“I expected her to be kind of a player. She does have a pretty flirty personality. Not gonna lie, when she calls me Sparkles there’s always a sultry tone behind it. If I didn’t know any better, I’d even say she has a crush on me.” Glimmer said with a chuckle, but the comment made Adora’s heart clench for some sort of reason.

“Don’t be ridiculous. She’s always been sassy, but she isn’t flirty. Trust me, romance is not one of her best suits.
Remember Scorpia?” The other two nodded with curiosity, ready to hear the story.

“When we were kids she had this massive crush on Catra. She was totally head over heels for her, and Catra didn’t even know! I

had to point it out at her to notice it."

"Wait, so you're telling me they aren't a couple?"

"They never were. I thought that over the years they got together. I mean, they were travelling and Catra is so protective of her, but they're just friends."

"Shocking."

"I know, right?"

Glimmer looked in amusement at the two of them and then snickered.

"Okay, not to be *that* person, but have you guys noticed how Catra has been looking at Adora in these past days?" The blonde's interest sparked up all of the sudden, *what'd she mean?*

"Oh my gosh. You're just as oblivious as she is! Adora, she's been literally undressing you with her eyes."

"What?!" Bow and Adora shrieked in pure surprise. That couldn't be possible. After the second kiss Catra even pushed Adora away, being a bit colder with each interaction they shared. Catra couldn't even look at her in the eyes anymore.

When Catra came out of the shower with clean mane and fresh clothes she witnessed a sight she'd hoped to not see ever again. In the middle of her bedroom stood a tall figure with long black hair and a face covered by a veil: Shadow Weaver.

Not having her beloved weapons, she was forced to produce a flame with her right hand as a threat, but the woman didn't move. Her green eyes looked as dull as ever, she wasn't frightened, that was for sure.

"Ah, I see. You've been practicing with your firebending. I'm sure Lord Prime will be delighted to know his only daughter isn't a complete failure after all."

"How'd you get in here? What are you doing?" Catra asked, her face showed anger, but her voice was squeaky and weak. So many bad memories were brought back.

"Catra, don't forget that I could get inside because of my abilities. After all I am an earthbender-"

"A *deflected* and corrupted Dai Lee. You were banished by the Earth Queen."

"That's beside the point. I have a message from your father." Shadow Weaver stood proud in front of Catra, showing her superiority. The princess didn't lower her guard, but her fears kept growing the more she kept looking at the former mentor.

"If you come back to the Fire Nation, we'll
free Scorpia and Entrapta from the Boling Rock." The Boiling Rock was the most secure and deadly prison in the Fire Nation. That's were the most important prisoners were held. That meant they had been tortured *at least* once or brain-washed, all because of Catra.

"They've been asking about you, how you're doing. They really care about you. These people don't." Shadow Weaver took a step closer, causing Catra's flame to become blue in an instant because of the intense fear and anger inside of her. The enemy seemed fascinated by it, for a moment she almost looked proud, thinking Catra could do it only thanks to *her* teachings.

"Think about it, you've known them for a couple of months at most. The guards outside were definitely not watching over you

because you're a guest. You're a prisoner. Come with me, you'll be finally happy. Your friends will be safe."

Catra didn't move, but the fire in her hand ceased. Shadow Weaver was right. She was a prisoner; they didn't care about her. But then why did her mind keep coming back to all the memories she had already shared with everyone? Perfuma's little encouragements, Glimmer's apology, Bow's conversation at the Fortress, Frosta sharing her admiration towards her, Mermista's sarcastic remarks, Seahawk's constant bugging and then... Adora. Every memory with Adora was unique, intense, fuzzy.

"Very well, I see you're still a weakling. How about I give you time to think about the deal?"

"How... how much?"

"Until our next encounter."

Catra already had tears prickled at the corners of her mismatched eyes. The situation was so fucked up. The most obvious choice was to go with Shadow Weaver; she'd be safe, her friends would be fine, and yet there was something tying her to stay in that current path.

"When will that be?" She asked, voice just above a mere whisper.

"I don't know. It could be tomorrow, it could be in a few weeks, perhaps even *years*." She turned her back on Catra, ready to earthbend her way out of the palace and then Nation.

"But don't worry. I'll make sure to let Scorpia and Entrapta know what a bad friend you are. Until next time, your highness."

At that sentence Catra's fear was replaced with pure fury. She released a large stream of fire through a kick that didn't land on the target. The old woman hurried up and used her earthbending to disappear underground. It was too late.

Catra set off on flames the Earth Kingdom banner attached to the wall. Everything was useless, *she* was useless. Before she could even realize it, everything was set on fire because of her impulsive nature. She just kept of producing new flames in hopes to somehow hit Shadow Weaver, even if she was already gone.

The three friends went to pick Catra up from her bedroom so they could all meet at the dining room with Queen Angella. They expected her to be sleeping, after all she was exhausted, but their worries appeared when they first saw the unconscious guards in front of her room laying on the ground. Bad sign, *very* bad sign.

When they opened the door Catra was curled in a ball in one of the room's corners. Everything was on fire and Catra looked completely terrified.

Adora quickly extinguished the flames while her friends approached Catra. As soon as Glimmer touched her, she flinched and hissed at her. Her breath was quick and heavy at the same time while her body kept trembling.

"Catra, are you okay?" Bow asked with a kind smile, knowing already how to deal with the situation. He had always been great at calming people down during a panic attack, and Catra looked like she could use some help from him.

Instead of using actual words, the brunette shook her head to say no. She then buried her face in her hands, claws trying to dig into her head as if to take all the triggering memories away. She dug and dug but nothing came out, not even the pain caused could distract her.

Adora carefully crouched next to her with clear concern drawn all over her face.

“Catra, what-” Right in that moment the Queen walked in the room with rush.

“What happened?!”

Even hours later Catra still couldn’t get a single word out, and the Queen grew more impatient with each passing second, thinking that it was some sort of manipulation game.

“Catra, we need to know why your guards passed out on the floor and why you set the room on fire.”

The fur covering Catra’s body was still prickled up and the tail kept lashing left and right in pure panic. She couldn’t look at anyone in the eyes. It was barely a miracle that she’d made it to the hall where she sat in a chair. Everyone was waiting for her to give an answer.

“It’s clear that this was a scam! She set fire to the room and then attacked my guards. She was trying to run away!”

“Mom no!” Glimmer said quickly. “Catra’s not... she wouldn’t. She’s cool. I know this is a big misunderstanding.”

“Hey, Catra.” Adora said softly as she moved her hand above the girl’s chin in order to make her look in the eyes. As soon as she started the touch Catra flinched away, but Adora didn’t let go, forcing her out of her trance.

"It's cool. It's just *me*, okay? Whatever happened is over now." Adora then knelt down at her height, still not breaking eye contact. To say Catra was terrified was understatement.

"But we need to understand what caused you to lash out like this. We want to help you."

And finally, words came out of Catra's mouth. "Why?" Was all she said. It wasn't accusatory, rather surprised.

"You're our friend. We care about you... *I* care about you."

For the first time in hours, Catra finally regained some of her conscience. She was finally back.

"Sh... Shadow Weaver. She she she— she was here. She knocked out those guys and then talked to me."

The queen wasted no time and organized a search party in a matter of minutes, but it was already too late.

"I-I tried to fight her, but she was already gone. I lost control again. It wasn't my intention to. You have to believe me."

The desperation in her voice was unbearable, so truthful, too *raw*.

Bow wasted no time and held Catra's hands in his. "Of course. We believe you. Right, Glimmer?"

"Yes, totally. Apparently there have been multiple seething of her while we were gone here at the Royal Palace."

Although she was herself again, Adora knew how agitated Catra still was. She definitely needed to unwind.

"Hey, you hungry?"

Catra shook her head in denial.

“How about I take you to my room and you can sleep there for tonight? I’ll keep you company. Come on.” She helped Catra stand up and noticed immediately guards behind them. Instead of confronting them, Adora casually approached the Queen.

“Your majesty, can I ask you to not have Catra followed around? She’s not a threat to us.”

Angella wasn’t mad or angry anymore, in fact, she was almost sympathetic regarding the whole situation. “I understand Adora, but if not to keep an eye on her, then she’ll need them for protection.”

“Okay, no offense, but Catra could easily take them down with her *bare hands*. Also, I’m the Avatar, I’m prefect for this kind of job. I’ll keep her safe, I promise.”

Angella stayed quiet for a few seconds, then shot Catra a look. She was standing behind Adora, almost hiding. She looked so small, so fragile.

“Very well. Tonight, you may share the room. I’ll have servants bring a second bed. Tomorrow we’ll find a new accommodation for our guest.”

Adora wasted no time in holding Catra’s hand and gently guided her to her own room (after thanking the Queen, obviously).

Reached destination, Catra looked around the room. It was pretty similar to hers, if not wider.

The princess slowly approached the bed and sat on it. The mattress was soft, too soft. She slowly started to sink, eliciting a small laugh from Adora.

“Yeah, they’re quite different in here. It takes a while to get used to them.”

“I’ve been sleeping on hard ground for years; this is a dream become true. Where were these beds the first time I came here?” Catra asked with a faint smile, starting to feel finally better.

Adora smiled and sat right next to her with a dopey grin on her face.

“They put you in a prison bed, but I bet they were still more comfortable than your bed at the Fire Nation. “

“You’re not wrong.” There was a brief silence. Catra knew what questions were going through Adora’s head.

“Catra-”

“She told me that if I came back then they’d
free Scorpia and Entrapta. She said I’d have time to think about it until our next encounter. I-I don’t wanna see her again.”

Adora scooted closer, wrapping an arm around Catra’s shoulder.

“I’m sorry I wasn’t there.”

“Not your fault. She just appeared out of nowhere. I wasn’t expecting it.” Catra’s words didn’t matter, Adora still felt guilty about leaving her friend alone.

“How are you feeling?”

“I’m kinda nervous. It brought back a lot of memories.”

“I know I know. What can I do to help you?” Catra didn’t answer, too busy thinking. She hated depending on people, especially on Adora. The Avatar had a hero complex that needed to be solved. But Catra was too *vulnerable*, she needed support.

Catra laid her back on the mattress, sinking even further. It really was comfortable.

“How about we share a room from now on?” Adora asked, basically reading Catra’s mind.

“We used to have a few sleepovers back in the Fire Nation and we always had fun. Now that we won’t have any surveillance, we’ll be free to do whatever we want and talk openly about things. What do you think?”

Catra thought about it for a second. Adora had always had trouble sleeping alone, but she wasn’t the only one. Adora’s presence calmed Catra down in an instant from all the stress and anxiety of the day. The arrangement would’ve been beneficial for the *both* of them.

The brunette slowly nodded and Adora showed her a small but genuine smile: she was happy.

Adora watched as Catra slowly fell asleep in the bed. She was finally at peace, and Adora was finally allowed to watch her. Catra resembled an angel whenever she was asleep, finally relaxed of all the suffered drama. Then, a soft knock could be heard. Catra’s ears only twitched slightly, but she didn’t wake up. Adora sighed in relief and slowly stood up to open the door. The servants brought in a second bed and tried to be as quiet as possible upon Adora’s request, but Angella was also there.

The Queen informed Adora that Light Hope would come in a few days in order to help her control the Avatar State. The woman was one of Mara’s friends so she knew what to do regards to training the Avatar.

Adora was happy to say the least. The Avatar State granted her of power and knowledge of all the past Avatars, if she could control it then she would’ve been *invincible*.

Once all the guests left the room Adora went to sit on the mattress, but Catra’s raspy voice stopped her.

“Don’t be stupid, the bed is huge.” Catra said, her voice raw and very low. Adora smiled in delight and accepted the offer. The

blonde carefully laid down on the mattress and looked at Catra, blue and gold eyes meeting hers.

"I missed you." Adora breathed out. Catra drew in a sharp breath, but then she confessed her feelings too.

"Missed you too." She mumbled. Catra's ears were pinned back and Adora could hear her tail thudding against the sheets in nervousness. Adora carefully scooted closer, making sure not to scare Catra away. Then, she hesitantly pulled their bodies together.

Catra didn't say anything, but low *purrs* filled the silence of the room.

Even with the passing of days and having a new room Catra kept on sleeping on Adora's bed with her. It made both of them fall asleep faster and it felt natural. They didn't cuddle to help the other fall asleep, but casual touches were shared every now and then in bed. Sometimes brief hugs would happen and other times Adora would move a lock of hair out of Catra's face, causing her to nuzzle into the crook of Adora's neck in order to hide her blush. One night their faces were barely an inch apart, and they almost kissed, *almost*. Adora moved her head up and kissed Catra's forehead instead, provoking great distress on the both of them.

But nevertheless, their old friendship was rekindled. After Adora and Glimmer's training they'd practice on their firebending alone (Catra didn't enjoy an audience, it brought back bad memories).

Over the course of four days her moves got a lot better, the problem was the proper *control*. Catra restrained her true potential by using just a small fraction of her full power, and Adora hated it. In terms of fighting style, techniques and stances Catra totally had the upper hand, but she lacked the bravery of unleashing the beast inside her.

It was infuriating.

"More power!" Adora demanded after Catra threw a weak fire-jab at her.

"That's the best I can do!" The princess spat back with annoyance as she evaded a punch that was thrown at her. Their duel had been going on for hours and no progress was made.

Adora didn't know what else to do. She knew Catra's true potential, but it only seemed to come out in moments of intense emotions.

It usually happened with anger, so she had to make Catra angry, *right?*

"You're not going to save your friends with that miserable strength. You need to use more!"

"I am!" Catra replied and released a flame with a roundhouse kick. It was a bit stronger, but not enough.

"Come on. Picture I'm Hordak or Shadow Weaver, I am holding Scorpia and Entrapta captive."

The brunette's eyes widened in terror and rage at the same time. *Perfect*. Adora didn't throw another physical attack, but she sent more emotional ones.

"I am torturing them. I am *hurting* them. Don't you want to rescue them?! Show me you are a worthy opponent!"

“Adora...” Catra said warningly, she knew what Adora was doing, and she didn’t look forward falling for it.

“They must be asking themselves why you haven’t come back yet to save them. How do you plan on explaining them you’re too weak to do anything about it?!”

And that was it. Catra snapped once again.

The princess’ nostrils released fire in fury, but she didn’t take a step further. Instead, she pressurized a large amount of fire into a ball and kept it mid-air to charge for a split second before shooting it towards the enemy in form of a comet. Adora didn’t have time to react before she found herself face to face with one of the most advanced and strongest attacks in firebending. The Avatar quickly sheltered herself by enclosing her own body in an earth shelter made out of rock. Even inside the shield she could feel how hot Catra’s fire was becoming.

Well, the plan seemed to work. Catra kept charging at her with more fire streams and with each one a peace of the armor crumbled. Needless to say, Adora was scared for her life. The power that Catra held was beyond anything she had ever witnessed in her entire life.

No firebending master had this strength, not even Adora herself.

When the attacks ceased, Adora carefully got rid of the shelter and showed herself at a worked up Catra. Judging by how pumped up she looked there was no way they were done yet. They walked around the courtyard in circles. Adora using airbending stance while Catra the firebending one, indicating she was going to attack soon.

Catra still looked a bit angry, but it seemed as if she recognized it was Adora in front of her and not a true enemy. However, her mind was in combat mode. The brunette didn’t run towards Adora in order to attack her. What she did was to conjure huge amounts of flames under her feet to propel herself at high speeds on the

grounds in the Avatar's direction. Once she was close enough, she launched more fire streams at her. The more attacks Catra threw, the more her flames would change shade.

The fire went from bright red to a darker tone, then assumed a color that resembled purple and then they turned fully blue.

Adora used air and sometimes earth moves mixed with firebending ones in order to even stand a chance against Catra.

For being someone referred as *undisciplined*, Catra sure had a lot of techniques under her sleeves.

Adora wanted to counterattack, she had to, for her own sake. The blonde launched fire streams at Catra, but the princess did something unexpected for Adora; She changed her stance in a split second and used a fluid motion of her arms to redirect the flames back at Adora.

It was a waterbending move, *truly fascinating.*

Once tired up of the training the two of them laid on the hard ground of the courtyard, breathing heavily whilst looking towards the dark sky.

"I can't believe it." Catra gasped after a while.

"I knew you had it in you." Adora replied as she scooted closer to her friend.

“Why do I...? How is this possible? Years of training did nothing to me and now? Now I can do all of that. I didn’t know I could do half of those things.”

“Their teaching methods were wrong. You only needed a nudge on a different direction.” Adora corrected, turning her face to Catra, whom was still looking at the stars.

“Besides, you’ve also learned other fighting styles during these years. The knowledge and abilities acquired definitely helped you become a better warrior. You just had a block you had to get over.”

“I don’t wanna rely on *anger* to achieve all this strength.” Catra admitted, she sounded small, almost afraid.

“You don’t have to.” The two women finally looked at each other in the eyes.

“It seems your source comes from the desire of saving Scorpia and Entrapta, not anger. You were controlled during this fight. You had full consciousness the whole time.”

“You think so?”

“I know so. Your firebending comes from desire. Desire of rescuing your friends, desire to see Hordak and Shadow Weaver pay for everything they’ve done...”

“Desire of vengeance.” Catra confessed. Her expression now hard and serious.

“It sounds weird, but I want revenge, I need justice.”

Adora gave her an understanding smile. Without thinking it twice she intertwined her fingers with Catra’s, holding her hand in reassurance.

“We’ll get justice.” Adora promised. Catra didn’t reply, but she did seem a bit soothed by it.

They didn’t say anything else. Their breaths filled the silence of the night as their eyes were still interlocked.

Adora’s heart was pounding for some sort of reason. She was feeling fuzzy all over again. Catra had this weird power over her of making her feel weak, poisoned.

Adora’s eyes lingered down to Catra’s plump lips and a different form of desire filled her body. It was lust and affection she had to show somehow.

Well, she knew how, but wasn’t sure if Catra would be okay with it.

But Catra was thinking about the same thing. She had never experienced such loving contact from someone before Adora, and she needed more of that intoxicating feeling. Slowly, she moved her hand to cup Adora’s cheek, her eyes didn’t dare to look at her friend in the eyes. She hoped the touch would be enough of a beg, but it wasn’t. Not for Adora.

“Catra, what are *we* doing?” She asked, barely above a whisper.

“I-I... I’m giving you another chance at redeeming you for the last kiss.”

Adora chuckled, but she didn’t pull away, in fact, their heads started gravitating together.

“Was it because I tugged at your tail? Sorry if I hurt you.”

“You didn’t hurt me.” Catra said truthfully, and then continued. “It just... it makes me feel tingly, that’s all.”

“Tingly?”

“It’s weird, I don’t wanna talk about it.”

Catra felt the ghost of Adora’s other hand trailing down her spine, stopping once it reached the lower back.

Bastard.

"So, do you want me to tug on it or not?"

"I mean, yeah. But don't—" Too late. Adora tugged at the very base of it, the most sensitive part.

Catra wasted no time and connected her lips to Adora's in order to muffle the embarrassing sounds that threatened to come out of her mouth. The sensation of them kissing and Adora's fingers on her tail were enough to make Catra lose control of her conscience.

She didn't know why she felt like this whenever they kissed, but the feeling remained also when they were just hanging out without even touching. Adora made her feel giddy, weird and a whole bunch of other emotions that Catra couldn't quite understand yet.

Their lips moved in perfect sync this time. Whenever one of them tried to speed things up, the other slowed them down and they met at the perfect rhythm. Adora's hand eventually left Catra's tail, making the magicat release a sigh of relief once Adora moved on top of her, moving her lips away from hers.

"A-Adora?"

"Let me try something. If you don't like it then just stop me, okay?" Catra nodded, and the blonde smiled sheepishly before lowering her face to leave soft pecks on her neck.

Catra gasped in delight and the new feeling and moved her hands to tug on Adora's hair, trying to pull her closer to her body. She was asking for *more*. However, Adora had different ideas. She grunted before taking both of Catra's wrist with one hand and pinning them on the ground before resuming her work. Her quick pecks slowly became kisses that then morphed into gentle *bites* and occasional licks.

Catra was aching to touch her, gain some of the control back, but she couldn’t. She was defenseless against Adora, and she enjoyed it. Obviously, she wasn’t going to show how she really felt, so she opted to repress all the embarrassing sounds by biting on her lower lip with one of her fangs. After a few minutes of exploring Adora went back to Catra’s lips.

They kissed for what felt like hours until Glimmer’s voice interrupted them.

“Girls, where are you?”

The both of them pulled apart in panic, but Adora was still pinning Catra on the ground.

“What are you doing?” Bow questioned once they’d found them still on that compromising position.

Having her hands still pinned to the ground, Catra had no other option but to use her head to smash against Adora’s. The other woman groaned in pain and finally released her from their embrace.

They couldn’t blow their cover up. They had been training so they were sweaty, besides, their breaths were still heavy from the makeout session, but Glimmer and Bow didn’t have to know that.

“We were training.” Catra said casually while Adora held onto her nose for dear life. Catra really hurt her with that head-butt.

Glimmer eyed them suspiciously, but whatever thoughts she had in her mind were kept there.

“Come on, Light Hope has arrived!”

Chapter End Notes

Well well well... I'd say we're almost halfway trough the story but I honestly feel like it's only 1/3 of it. There are so many

things I'd like to explore and other things I keep adding because I'm a sucker for character development.
Let me know your thoughts about this chapter and if you want more updates then you should follow me on Twitter @etheriastribe where you'll also find my CC in case you want to send anonymous questions.

Deal

Chapter Notes

> TW: smut.
> There'll be a sex scene at the end of the chapter after Adora and Catra get to bed.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora carefully slipped away from the mattress, making sure to be as light on her feet as possible in order to not wake Catra up. The training to access the Avatar State through opening all of her seven chakras had begun, but it was too intense for Adora. Light Hope gave her a little insight on what and how the chakras worked, and even though they had just started the process, the Avatar hated it. The first step was to open the earth chakra. It dealt with survival but was blocked by fear. Adora seemed to meditate in the dark room with the guru for what felt like hours, but she couldn't connect at all. It was hard to concentrate when a stranger was watching every move she made.

It was the middle of the night, and even though she wasn't a night owl, she wanted to do this alone. Adora made her way to the main courtyard and sat under a tree in front of a little pond and then assumed one of the many meditating positions.

What are you most afraid of?

Let your fears become clear to you.

Light Hope kept repeating those words every single day, and they kept on replaying on Adora's mind. The Avatar closed her eyes and finally managed to meditate. Her mind wandered to her failing to save the world. It was her duty to bring balance. What was bound to happen if she couldn't do it? Would everyone hate her?

Her brain pictured a scenario like that. Everything was in flames, people screamed, cried, and Adora was just paralyzed.
Then, Firelord Prime showed up with all of his glory, a devilish smirk on his face. He slowly raised his hand up and-

Adora gasped for fresh hair. Her forehead was soaked in cold sweat.

You'll see a vision; it won't be real.

"You are concerned for your survival, but you must surrender those fears. Let them flow down the creek." Adora repeated Light Hope's words to herself, and resumed her old position, not giving up on the mission.

The terrible dream eventually faded away, leaving her finally at peace.

"Congratulations, you have opened your earth chakra."

Adora jumped in fear at the voice behind her surprising her. What was that woman doing awake at that time?! The sunrise was still hours away.

"I- uh... thanks?"

"Tomorrow we'll go ahead with the water chakra. Good job, Avatar."

And just like that, Light Hope disappeared back in the palace.

Creepy.

Glimmer, Bow and Catra all saw how the opening of chakras affected Adora's mood. Whenever she took too many days to

open one, she'd become grumpy and snappy while whenever she unlocked another, she'd get happy and relaxed. That behavior also reflected on her bending, becoming more aggressive or calmer depending on the type of day she had.

Bow and Glimmer –much to Catra's dismay- decided to have a slumber party all together. Catra only wanted to have a peaceful night spent sleeping, but she had to agree. Adora really was in a miserable state at times.

"I can't wait until Adora finds all of us here. What do you think her reaction will be to our surprise?" Bow asked excitedly once inside the room. It was already late in the evening and him and Glimmer occupied Catra's spot on the bed, forcing her to sit on the right side, but she didn't mind. Adora's scent was stronger from there; it smelled like cinnamon and strawberry.

"Well, if you keep yelling like that it won't be a surprise anymore." The brunette replied with sarcasm, but there was no bitterness behind it.

Then, three knocks were heard at the door.

"Come in!" Glimmer said, and four guards appeared.

"The Queen requests your presence." One of them said whilst pointing at Catra, whom groaned. What could possibly she want from her? She had behaved perfectly fine until then and didn't cause any disturbance.

"Now."

The three teenagers shared a questioning look, but then Catra put on her Royal Armor and followed the four men to the throne room where the Queen was elegantly seated.

"You requested my presence?" She asked directly and got a quick glare in response from the monarch. It should've caused Catra to be afraid, but she almost *laughed* at her face. Years spent with

her father and Shadow Weaver showed her how a real glare looked.

“Kneel before your majesty!” The tallest of the guards ordered, and the magicat hissed in response, causing the man to take a few steps back.

Queen Angella vaguely dismissed all her subordinates except for a man. He wore normal clothes and rested his hand on one column.

“The eclipse will happen in a few months; I need to know where you stand exactly.”

Adora sighed as she made her way over her own shared room. Another day, another failure. She had to unlock the air chakra but couldn’t get over the feeling of grief. It was simply too hard to let go.

When Adora opened the door, she was met with Glimmer and Bow sitting on her bed.

The sight of her best friends immediately brought up a smile to her face as she was met with a group hug.

“We’re having a sleepover. Isn’t it exciting?!”

Adora nodded at her short friend and threw herself on the soft mattress.

“How did today go?” Bow asked.

“Don’t want to talk about.”

“That Light Hope must be really tiring you up.”

“Ugh. It’s a literal roller coaster of emotions. I don’t like sitting and meditating, let alone take time for myself and analyze my inner feelings. Sometimes I just want to ditch her and go punch something instead.”

“Why am I not surprised?” Glimmer said with sarcasm, earning a pillow thrown at her face.

“My daughter believes you can help us. Glimmer has vouched for you despite your background. And because I greatly love my daughter, I’m willing to give you a chance.”

“I won’t disappoint.” Catra still looked at the Queen right in the eyes, showing no sign of insecurity.

Angella stood up from the throne and slowly approached Catra, walking in circles around her.

“Your father might get killed. Are you sure you want this to happen?”

“I don’t care what happens to him. For all I know you can kidnap him, torture him or send him to prison and I still wouldn’t want to see him.”

“You will pledge to stand with us against your own Nation?”

“As long as I get to have my friends back, then: yes.” Angella looked at the mysterious man and he just only nodded in return and then everything clicked. He could tell if Catra was telling the truth.

“Very well. We’ll help you get your friends back and you’ll collaborate with us to end the war. Tomorrow there will be a war

meeting at dawn. I want you to be there."

Catra didn't reply. She slightly bowed before walking out of the room.

A war meeting? Was she really allowed to participate actively in possible strategies to dethrone Fire Lord Prime? Awesome.

Once she reached the shared chamber, she found Adora, Bow and Glimmer throwing cushions at each other.It was like they were fighting with pillows instead of punches.

Weak.

In the middle of the chaos a pillow was thrown at Catra but she easily caught it with her hands.

The three of them looked at her with wide smiles, expecting something from her. Catra frowned and carbonized it, not really knowing what to do with it.

"Okay, I don't know why you're fighting, but aren't you supposed to use words to communicate and solve the situation? I mean, if you're gonna duel, do it using something more efficient, that's all I'm saying."

Glimmer and Bow frowned at her while Adora remembered Catra had never had a pillow fight before.

"We aren't actually fighting. It's just a pillow fight!"

"You should try it!" Adora walked up to her and handed Catra a cushion.

"I don't get it. What's the point of this training?"

"Training? This is just for fun!"

"You're telling me you've never done this before?!" Bow asked in pure shock. Catra, still confused, replied to him.

“Sorry, I didn’t really have the time to do these types of things when I was too busy training to lead an entire Nation.”

“Okay, well, now you’re trying it.” Glimmer ordered and Adora patted Catra’s back.

“Come on, try it! Hit me.”

Catra looked back and forth between the pillow and Adora for a few times, then, just as she was about to hit her friend, Glimmer threw one at her instead.

Catra growled and slowly made her way towards the Earth Princess. Her look was intimidating, but Glimmer laughed at her until her own face was hit as well.

Catra chuckled and then turned to Adora.

“Hey Adora, you were right. This is fun!”

And so, the fight went on between the four of them. Catra found the activity to be enjoyable after all. Eventually feathers started flying and she found herself to be hypnotized by all the plumage levitating around the room. Then, one of them fell on her nose, causing a tingling sensation to happen.

Catra sneezed and everything stopped and they all stared at her in awe.

Bow was the first one to break the silence with a loud gasp.

“That’s your sneeze?”

“What?”

“It’s just so... *cute*!”

Catra grunted, showing her fangs to assert dominance. “It’s a normal sneeze.”

“I can’t believe the whole time you were trying to play the bad guy you had the cutest sneeze of all time.”

“I am *not* cute!”

“The angrier you get the cuter you are.”

Catra groaned and sat on the bed, right next to a laughing Adora.

“I am not cute...” She mumbled with a pout, but the blonde ignored the comment and started petting her ears.

“But... you’re the cutest.”

“Fine, if you say so. Whatever, I don’t care.” Her voice just above a whisper and face red. Adora would totally make fun of her for it later.

“By the way, what did my mom tell you?”

“Queen Angella called you?” Catra shrugged, trying to play nonchalant.

“I’m participating in tomorrow’s war meeting.” She said casually, but everyone around her cheered loudly. Maybe it was a big deal after all.

“That’s awesome! I know you’re the most qualified person to help us.”

“Oh Glimmer, you have no idea! She studied everything regarding military actions and war-related things when we were kids! She’d spend entire days ignoring me in order to learn all that stuff. She’s awesome.”

Catra huffed and threw a pillow at Adora’s face. It was true, she was amazing, but there was no need to say it out loud.

Adora sat under that tree once again as she tried to meditate in the middle of the night. Having that slumber party definitely helped her get her mind off her responsibilities for a while, but her brain went back on working mode.

The Avatar groaned in frustration when she failed another attempt to open the Air Chakra. So far that had been the most challenging one, there was too much pain behind it.

"Are you seriously going to try that every night at these unholy hours?" A familiar voice coming from up the tree asked.

Catra.

Adora rolled her eyes but could not help the blush from appearing upon seeing the Fire Princess observing her.

"You knew?"

"Duh. You're not exactly light on your feet for being an airbender, I mean, I literally saw you fly ten feet after sneezing."

"What are you doing here?" Now it was Catra's time to blush. The brunette moved her face up again and stared at the moon intensely, debating on telling Adora the truth.

"Sparkles and Arrow Boy — their smell... It doesn't feel *safe*." She half-admitted, alluding to her acute smelling sense that assisted her on survival.

"Well, that's only because you have to get used to it and spend more time with them." Adora then crooked a smug smile, the same one she had back in the day whenever she wanted to tease.

"And that doesn't explain why you're here of all places, with me. Do *you* feel safe around *me*?"

Catra's ears pinned back to her head as a sign of fear for being caught, so she hissed back in response.

"You wish. I only came here because if I wandered alone then people would've gotten pretty suspicious. I'm staying with you just because I want people to get off my back."

Adora shrugged casually and went back to her meditation pose. "Sure, whatever."

Her mind wandered back to the mission, but knowing Catra was right above her, watching her, made her feel uneasy.

"What chakra are you trying to open right now?"

"Air." Adora replied shortly, still trying to focus.

Catra grunted and jumped off the high tree to land right next to her friend.

"What does it deal with?"

"Love."

"Lame. Why is it blocked?"

"Grief." This time Adora's voice sounded strained, pained. Catra stayed quiet for a solid second. Taking in all the pain Adora went through and didn't know about.

"Did Light Hope give you any directions?"

"Just that love is a form of energy that swirls around all people."

"What does it mean?"

Catra sounded like a curious child, and it was cute, there was no denying that. But Adora had to concentrate.

"I don't know. That's why it's so hard for me. Also, you bugging me with questions isn't helping either."

Catra ignored her.

“Who do you grief?”

“All the victims... Yue.” Adora thought about them. Remembered all the raids and battles where people sacrificed themselves for that war. And then, Yue’s face came in first plan. It wasn’t calm and relaxed, it was sad, pained. Her sacrifice helped her people, but until the war wasn’t over it had been practically useless.

How would they all have felt about the Avatar failing this miserably? Adora roughly mastered two elements and one of them was the one that brought all those deaths...

Catra watched as Adora’s face became wet with all the tears streaming down those closed eyes. She wanted to hug her, but figured out it wasn’t the best option. Adora was meditating, and weird things could happen if touched. At least that’s what Bow told her.

What would Scorpia say? Catra thought. Her best friend always had the best advice and knew the right thing to do.
Hopefully Catra got a handle on some of her teachings and logic.

“You have indeed felt a great loss. Let the pain flow away.” Catra started off, trying to help Adora through the hurt.

“Yue’s love for you has not left this world. It is still inside of your heart. Perhaps in a form of *new* love?”

Adora’s face was still stained with falling tears, but a smile slowly crept up.

Beautiful, Catra thought in her head.

And then Adora opened those blue eyes of hers. There was a different light in them, making her look more youthful somehow.

“What happened?”

“I I I... I think I opened it.”

“Seriously? That’s great!” Adora chuckled at Catra’s enthusiasm. She looked cute.

“How did you get over your grief though?”

Adora didn’t reply, instead she looked fondly at the moon and then leaned in to give Catra a kiss. It wasn’t burning with desire and passion like the other ones they had shared in the past. This was delicate, kind, suave.

Adora meant it to show her true feelings to Catra without actually saying the words, hoping she’d understand.

Catra didn’t.

Even though she did kiss back, there was some sort of shyness behind it. She was holding back, or maybe she was uncomfortable. Either way, it was enough of a reason for Adora to pull away and hug the brunette tightly. Tiredness invaded the Avatar’s system as she hid her face in the crook of Catra’s neck.

“What was that for?”

“I just... I felt like it. I’m sorry if you didn’t like it.” Adora mumbled, her voice muffled by Catra’s shoulder.

“It’s not that I didn’t like it, it just caught me by surprise.”

Adora slightly nodded in acknowledgement and Catra started running her claws through her blonde and silky hair.

“Are you feeling okay?”

“I’m really tired.” Adora whimpered as she clutched to Catra’s clothes, almost as if she were her only anchor keeping her alive.

"I'm *exhausted* Catra." She finally admitted. Catra's arms tightened around her as she placed a kiss on Adora's forehead. It was quick, but meaningful, at least for Adora.

"I should get you back to our room. You'll get some sleep."

When Adora felt the bare minimum shift of Catra's body her grip became ten times stronger, stopping every movement.

"No. I wanna stay here. Like this. I don't want to move."

But Catra shifted again. This time Adora chocked out a sob.

"*Please*." She asked, and Catra finally gave in. Blue and golden irises landed on her face, examining it. Catra looked worried, but all Adora could think about was having her by her side, hugging her.

"Okay dork. We'll stay here until you'll feel better and then we'll go back to our room where your other friends are."

"I just wanna stay with you."

Catra's face showed anger for a brief second only to switch to fondness the next one. She had been mad Adora for so long for abandoning her to pursue a destiny that was thrown at her. But all that anger was gone in that moment. Adora was in her arms, pleading her for the two of them to stay alone together.

Whatever happened while opening the Air Chakra sure managed to make Adora have a full one-eighty.

Catra didn't even realize how lost she was in her own thoughts until Adora mumbled something against her chest.

"Kitty go purrr..." She whispered, and Catra almost gasped in realization. She was purring unconsciously.

"Shut up dummy. I'm not—!"

“So cute.”

“Whatever.”

The next morning Adora woke up in her bed next to Glimmer and Bow, no trace of Catra whatsoever.

She felt better, way better, but also felt worried. Kissing Catra like that probably ruined their friendship. *What was she thinking?* Just because her mind pictured Catra’s face as the form of new love didn’t mean she actually felt like that.

It was reckless, stupid, incautious and absolutely *thrilling*.

“Adora, hurry up! We’re gonna be late!” Glimmer ordered as she dragged her out of her room and led her to the meeting room where all the other princesses and Queen Angella already were.

But Adora’s eyes immediately caught Catra’s. She wore ceremonial royalty clothes from the Fire Nation, including the golden headpiece shaped like a flame.

She looked regal.

Adora could tell Catra was on business mode by the straight posture she had and the erect ears. Her eyes were distant, unreadable.

The meeting began and everyone kept on rambling about possible plans to invade the Fire Nation without actually coming to a conclusion. Hours passed and most of them kept on arguing with each other.

Then, Catra stood up from her chair and examined the map with careful eyes. Angella saw this as a sign of disrespect and was ready to call her out on it until-

"We need to have two steps for the invasion: a naval stage and then a land stage." She raised the piece of paper and pointed at it, showing all of them how things were going to go.

"To gain sea access to the Fire Nation Capital we have to get past the first major obstacle here." Her claws moved to indicate the very entrance to the nation.

"The Great Gates of Prime. Next, the army will hit the land and they must fight past their battlements and secure the Plaza Tower."

Catra looked again at the map, wondering about the best decision to make in order to win the war.

"Once they'll do that it's up to the Royal Palace. At that point, the eclipse will begin."

"Wait a minute." Frosta called out, signing a time out.

"Isn't the point to invade during the eclipse, when the firebenders are powerless?"

Catra opened her mouth, but Bow replied instead.

"What Catra said is actually smart. The eclipse lasts only eight minutes. That's not enough time for the whole invasion. Also, the Royal Palace is heavily guarded by firebenders."

"So that's when we'll need the eclipse advantage. We must aim for the bigger fish." Glimmer concluded, and Catra nodded in response.

"When all of this is finished the Avatar will have defeated the Fire Lord. You will have control of the Fire Nation Capital and the war will be over."

Adora took in a deep breath to process all the information. If everything went according to plan then things were going to turn out perfectly fine. The war was going to end. Everyone would've been avenged.

With the passing of weeks Catra got more distant and colder with everyone.

Her knowledge in battle and strategy was highly awarded by the Queen, whom put her in charge of the whole operation. Organizing the attack was no easy task. There were so many inconvenients and challenges that made her want to drown herself, but she couldn't give up. At least Catra received help from Glimmer for battle tactics and Bow landed his aid regarding new technologies and machines that they could use. But it was still difficult. It wasn't like old times where she had to plan sieges on simple villages, this was the Fire Nation Capital. Being under all that pressure forced her to turn off her emotions and focus on all the work.

Adora didn't like that.

She observed as her friend kept on writing letters and taking notes on the wooden desk. It was painful to see Catra on that state again. She barely ate and drank enough to keep her on her feet, but sleeping was definitely not an option.

"Hey, it's late. You should sleep."

"Yeah, maybe later." Adora grunted when Catra didn't even look at her, not gaining the slightest reaction from her.

The Avatar stood up from the bed and approached her friend doing a very complex drawing... a project perhaps.

“What’s that?”

“Hot air balloon. Bow and I are working together on this. It’s almost done but there are a few measurements wrong.”

“Well, I’m sure you can figure this stuff out tomorrow.”

For the first time in weeks Catra finally looked at her and acknowledged her presence. She tried looking angry, but the bags under her eyes only made the princess look miserable instead.

“Adora, the day of the Black Sun keeps getting closer and we are behind with the plans. Everything has to be perfect.”

And finally, Adora decided to counter attack for once. She snatched the pen from Catra’s hands and broke it before her own eyes.

“Take it from me: if you overwork yourself this much it’ll all be useless in the end. If you allowed other people to assist you instead of practically doing all the work alone then I’m sure we’ll get better and more results in shorter times!”

The brunette released a breath of fire and stood up on her feet, her face incredibly close to Adora’s, daring her to say another word.

“I get it, you want to save your friends. I know that feeling, I am the Avatar. You feel like everyone is depending on you —and they probably are.”

Adora took another step forward and held Catra’s hands in hers, rubbing slow circles to soothe her —clear— state of distress.

“But you’re not alone. Not anymore. Nobody sees you as the enemy, not even the queen. You’re part of the resistance as well. You can rely on other people to help you.”

Adora’s hands slowly travelled to Catra’s cheeks and wiped the tears away with care and a sympathetic smile.

Catra hated it.

She hated when Adora was right. She hated herself for not being strong enough and already burnout. Everything in her mind told her to push the Avatar away, hurt her, but her body only eased at the mere touch of those fingertips on her stained cheeks, making Catra lean it at the contact and release a soft purr of relief.

"I miss you, Catra. I don't know if the kiss I gave you three weeks ago has anything to do with you being so distant; but I'm sorry if it made you uncomfortable."

Dummy, she thought. Because of course Adora would feel insecure about it, like she ruined their entire friendship.

"Just, please, stop exploiting yourself like that so you can avoid me. I'll stay away from you. I'll do whatever you want. I beg of you..." The blonde sighed and hid her face in the crook of Catra's neck, managing to give goosebumps to the other girl.

"Adora..." Catra gasped as she wrapped her toned arms around her waist, pulling in for a hug.

"Let's go to bed." She whispered in her ear. Those words were enough to spread a smile across Adora's face.

She swiftly swept Catra off her feet –literally- and set her on the soft mattress. They stared at each other in the darkness, the silence too loud to let Catra think about the right words to say.

"I like kissing you very much." She finally admitted with a mumble.

"You do?"

"Of course, dummy. I just... it caught me by surprise I guess... Why'd you do it?"

Adora chuckled and scooted closer. Catra could see the smirk on her face and knew that cocky Adora was back once again.

“I don’t know, I guess I like kissing you too.”

“Can we...” Catra trailed off and then stopped, trying to find the most appropriate sentences to express her feelings without actually confessing them.

“We could -y’know- do it more often.”

“You really want me to redeem myself that many times?”

“No, no no no. I think what I’m trying to say is... I like kissing you and you like kissing me.”

“I thought that was settled.”

Not for you, apparently. Use your brain!

“I want you to kiss me, okay?! I’m tired of using excuses to do that. I want it to happen more and more. It’s like... I feel warmer when we do it and when we are apart I-I feel...” Too much, she had said too much.

“Cold.” Catra concluded, looking in Adora’s eyes with determination. Hopefully she understood what she said because, quite frankly, not even Catra understood her own feelings, let alone knowing how to vocalize them.

Adora’s eyes were wide in shock. Her mouth opened and closed multiple times, probably trying to say something, for a minute that felt like eternity.

“...Like a girlfriend?”

“Like a what?” Catra asked, now totally confused. She had never heard of that term before since she had never been introduced to the concept of romantic relationships to begin with. All she knew about it was centered about politics. She was supposed to marry a

noble Fire Nation citizen and have a political marriage with them, that was all it was taught to her regarding "relationships".

Over her years of travels, she discovered the sexual version of it where people would go and do indecencies together just because they felt like it.

Then she came across Mermista and Seahawk.

Those two had a weird relationship. They behaved like friends and kissed, like her and Adora do, but they'd do it in public. They shared that type of affection in front of other people, which Catra considered highly repulsive. Those type of things are meant to be kept as a secret, not shared with the world. Showing affection was for the weaklings, let alone share it to a public.

"Uh... never mind. I don't know where that came from." Adora chocked out once she remembered how much of a novice Catra is regarding the romantic sphere.

She then rested her forehead against Catra's and cupped that beautiful face of hers with one of her hands. Catra shuddered at the contact and her breath was cut short when she saw Adora's lips dangerously near to hers. They were so close. It would've taken a fraction of second for the princess to lock their mouths together in a tangly dance again, but the Adora took the first step and did it instead.

Catra could swear her heart stopped beating when it happened. She missed Adora's soft lips and gentle tongue in her. If felt so natural, magical even.

Soon their breaths became heavier and more hurried as the kiss went from careful and kind to passionate and full of tension. Both of them were fighting for dominance, but Adora managed to get the upper hand by rolling on top of the other woman.

She pulled away and wasted no time to move her lips to Catra's neck, leaving lingering kisses.

Catra gasped audibly in surprise. She felt something more than simple warmth... it was intoxicating, *infuriating*. Her body craved for something so incredibly filthy that the mere thought of it sent pressure between her legs. Her claws came out involuntary and went to grip Adora's skull, undoing the hair tie that held together that ponytail with that stupid hair poof as she pressed her head to be closer to her neck.

It was an open request for more and Adora obliged, starting to suck near a vein with the right pressure to not leave any marks and to make Catra go crazy.

Something in Catra's mind told her she needed to be closer to Adora. Those clothes were in the way of that, so, she pushed Adora away and freed herself from her own armor. For the first time in years, Catra regretted wearing so many layers of clothes. In order to get naked, she had to get off her robe, the green garment, belt, gloves, anklets and the strips of white cloth wrapped around the waist, arms and hips.

It was simply *too much.*

Catra grunted and shoved Adora away before starting to undress without a hint of shame. She couldn't even remember the last time the felt horny before meeting Adora again and there she was, stripping in front of her childhood friend because she couldn't handle the fabric putting distance between their bodies.

Just as she unfastened the belt, Adora gripped Catra's hand and stopped her.

"Catra, are you sure about this?" She asked with a reassuring smile that only made Catra more frustrated. How was she supposed to reply when her lips were right in front of hers?

"I-I have no idea what I want to do. I
just..." Catra rambled furiously. She slapped Adora's hands away and continued the nudity show.

"Fuck! I want you *close*, okay? Hugs and kisses aren't enough."

Adora nodded and helped Catra slip free of her green clothes. She was left with only those wraps.

The blonde slipped her arms under Catra's thighs and helped her sit on her lap.

She was frustrated, craving for loving contact -it wasn't that hard to notice. Before they could back to locking their lips together Adora took her time and admired Catra's body.

Within the last months she gained muscle mass and became less boney, probably product of the balanced diet she received compared to the lack of food when she travelled with Scorpia.

Adora's hands slowly wandered to touch those toned abs of hers and traced every line she could find.

"Adora." Catra whimpered as she leaned in, but Adora still refused to kiss her.

"I you ever feel uncomfortable with something I do or say tell me right away, okay? I want you to enjoy this."

"I will. Just— please..."

The Avatar chuckled at how wanton Catra was at the moment. She had never begged for something ever before. And yet there she was, reduced as a mess by mere kisses. Adora's lips met hers and this time Catra wasn't shy to reciprocate the passion. The magicat wrapped an arm around her shoulders to pull her closer to her. Adora smirked into the kiss and added the tongue.

Catra was already a *wreck*.

She wriggled her body and flinched whenever Adora's hands would move to another part of her abdomen until one reached the lower back and the other the base of her chest. Once Adora tugged at the tail all rational thoughts were left

aside. Catra begged for Adora to undress, and she obliged happily until the both of them were finally naked.

The princess pushed Adora back on the mattress and climbed on top of her, kissing her. The excitement made her tail wiggle left and right while a soft purr was released. Adora happily observed the wonderful person worshipping her in any way she felt comfortable with, even if it was a bit messy. Catra's movements became more frantic and sloppier the more she explored Adora's curves.

Not that the Avatar didn't appreciate the enthusiasm, but it was clear Catra had no idea on what to do and it was already stressing her partner out already, so she cupped the woman's face lovingly.

"How about I take the lead?"

"I I I... I want to touch you too." Catra looked visibly disappointed. Those mismatched sad eyes pained Adora's soul.

Crap.

"And we'll get there —just not tonight, 'kay? Let me take care of you this time."

The brunette scoffed, but eventually agreed once Adora used one of her charming smiles on her. Once Catra was above her Adora latched her lips on Catra's collarbone and sucked on it while her thigh carefully put pressure between the magicat's legs. Catra released the filthiest moan Adora had ever heard as she shamelessly grinded her hips in search of friction that the Avatar was glad to offer with her finger.

Entering those velvety walls could've been considered the easiest mission ever by how much slick came out of Catra.

"Look at you, princess. You act so tough around everyone and yet, when you're with me, you keep pleading me for more."

Adora whispered with a nibble on Catra's ear as she pushed a finger in while tracing lazy circles on the clit with her thumb.

"F-Fuck Adora."

"Tell me what you need." She pretended with a deep thrust that almost made her counterpart yell in pleasure.

"*Words* Catra. Use your words."

"Bastard." She chocked out in between sobs and moans that stopped once Adora ceased her own movements, earning a hard glare.

"Fine! I don't know, okay? Just make me... release." She mumbled the last words as if they were meant to be an insult of some kind.

Adora smiled and kissed Catra's forehead before lowering her head and started leaving soft pecks across her whole body. She traveled from the jawline, then neck, collarbone, in between those perky breasts until she reached Catra's lower abs and then inner thighs. Feeling Adora's hot breath against her own warmth felt like torture, especially after being denied pleasure when she was so close to achieving it. Adora didn't move or did anything else to please her. She just stared between her legs in pure awe. She had to take in the beauty of the paradise she was about to open the gates to.

"A-Adora, please." Catra begged, finally pulling her out of her trance. The Avatar leaped in and gave Catra a solid and slow lick between those folds.

Catra lost any logical thought at that very moment.

Never in her whole life had she ever felt something like that. It was steady with just the right amount of pressure to make her go crazy and the wetness totally helped amplify the satisfaction.

The pair kept going for what felt like hours, with Adora pulling away just as Catra was about to come and then coming back with a chuckle as soon as she saw how Catra was worked up for her until the brunette's finally came undone with a loud gasp and limp body.

Catra could've sworn her soul left the body and went on an astral travel that brought her piece of mind.

Adora held her tight and helped her through the aftershocks with reassuring caressed and countless little pecks left where she'd see a freckle.

Eventually Catra calmed down and nuzzled into Adora's chest with a low rumble of her chest that filled the silence between them.

"Did you like it?" Adora asked once she could tell that Catra's conscience was fully back.

"I wanna do this every night."

"Only if you stop overloading yourself with work."

"Now that I have you to help me with it?" Catra raised her face up so that she could see Adora's nervous stare. She really was concerned for her health.

"Consider it a deal."


@etheriastribe

Chapter End Notes

Sorry for the delay but it was finals week!
I reaaaalllyyyy hope you liked this chapter because it was hell to write.
I'm no expert on writing smut but i like to think I'm not a complete failure 🤳
N e ways if you want updates on the writing process and art you can follow me on twitter @etheriastribe where you'll find my CC where you can send anonymous questions.

South Pole

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra take one step forward and four steps back .

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes


@etheriastribe

Catra and Adora had never been closer, literally.

They had always been touchy, but not *romantically* touchy. It was a new experience, and they enjoyed it. Their emotional bond became much stronger because of the countless nights spent together without them even noticing it.

The formula they created was always the same: Catra giving an open invitation, Adora starting the contact, Catra trying to take control and failing at it, Adora giving her what she craved and then Catra helping her get off the edge as well.

When Adora first let Catra touch her it was embarrassing. The princess went too rough too fast, hurting Adora. Thankfully she had enough patience to explain exactly how she enjoyed it. It took multiple tries and many nights, but Catra eventually got it down and now she was the fucking queen of making Adora come undone in a matter of seconds.

Catra kept her promise from that infamous first night.

She managed to balance work, training and personal life. Her accomplishments with the plans allowed her to get her own personal training room and they even offered her a new bedroom, which she declined for obvious reasons. Adora, on the other hand, only had to worry about perfecting her mastery of the elements and the Avatar State... easy, right?

No.

She was making progress, but only slowly. Light Hope told her to not worry about it, that she was even faster than Avatar Mara, but it wasn't enough to calm her nervous spirit. With each passing day she'd get more and more stressed out and the temporary relief she felt at night with Catra wasn't enough anymore.

But it was still something.

Whenever she'd see Catra, her stomach did flips and her breath was stuck in her throat. The more she looked at her the more she

realized how beautiful she was. Sometimes she even asked herself why it took her so long to see Catra with different eyes. She was still pretty when they were younger, but she only started having those strong feelings after their first kiss. From feeling lightheaded near her, Adora started to hear every beat of her heart by how heavy it pounded whenever they were around each other.

It was intoxicating, and Adora craved for more.

The blonde dodged a rock thrown at her by Glimmer and redirected it towards her opponent with ease.

"I think we can call it a day." The earthbender said with a huff.

The both of them took the blindfolds off and bowed in sign of respect. With all the months spent perfecting the neutral jing Adora was confident to finally call herself a master of the element. Although Glimmer was much better than her at the art. The girl could detect the minimum shift of the ground under her and determine the cause of it.

"I think it's safe to say we're great at this." Glimmer admitted with a fist bump. Adora nodded and quickly put on her coat. They were in the middle of winter and after growing up in the Fire Nation Adora was freezing.

"Do you know where Catra is? I haven't seen her all day." She asked trying to sound as casual as possible, but Glimmer could see right through her.

"Your *girlfriend* must be at another meeting or training. Who knows?" Adora's face became as red as a pepper in that moment. Why did Glimmer use that term?!

"She is not my girlfriend!"

"Oh yeah? Care to explain why not only do you share a room, but sleep together?" Okay, maybe she was a right. They were a bit suspicious.

“I’ve noticed the way you look at each other; you give her bedroom eyes and she literally melts on the spot. Do we need to talk about the kiss or...?” Okay, forget that, they were *totally* suspicious.

“I-I swear it’s not... not like that.”

“Listen, I get it. You don’t want people to know you’re dating the enemy, but you could’ve at least told me and Bow.” Glimmer said with a roll of her eyes. She looked a bit hurt, too.

“Glimmer, no. I couldn’t have said anything to you two because Catra and I are not together.”

“What do you mean?”

“We tried talking about our relationship, but...” Adora shrugged, not really knowing how to continue.

“She told you she doesn’t want you? Oh, it’s on.” Glimmer said as she rolled her sleeves up. Adora chuckled in amusement and stopped her friend from committing a homicide.

“I asked her if she wanted me to be her girlfriend.”

“Well, what’d she say?” Adora’s smile fell and she shook her left and right still in disbelief.

“She doesn’t know the definition of that word.”

“Well, did you tell her what it meant?”

Adora didn’t reply, feeling suddenly ashamed.

“Oh, my spirits! The both of you are literally so useless!” Glimmer started off, pacing back and forth through the courtyard.

“So, what, you’re stuck in this limbo where you don’t know how to act around her in public because you don’t know if you’re allowed to touch her like you do when you’re alone?”

Adora groaned in total frustration. Catra brought her peace of heart, but also gave her a headache with all the mixed signals. "I don't know what to do. I don't want to pressure her, but I need answers!"

Glimmer's expression softened once she understood the situation Adora was in.

"How about we get Bow to help you? Maybe he can have a talk with Catra. After all they're pretty close friends now."

"Do you think that'll work?"

"It'll give you another perspective at the very least. Now go find her and just... don't overthink it."

Who did Glimmer think she was talking to? Of course Adora was going to overthink!

Catra launched a long stream of red fire in the air as she trained. With the passing of months, she got *annoyingly* good at firebending, at least that's what Adora told her. She even went to the extent of calling Catra a better master than her.

Needless to say, she felt like a child awarded for their good grade at school and blushed profusely right in front of Adora, gaining weeks of teasing and constant casual praises.

But the princess had to stay focused, she couldn't let herself get distracted by the random memories shared with Adora in these past months. But her mind wandered somewhere else instead.

She remembered one of the last nights she should've spent with Scorpia instead of trying lightning generation. She had been so

stuck up on observing the movements instead of focusing on inner peace that all of her pent up rage forbid her from trying her attack. But she was in a better mental state now, right?

Well, one way to try.

Catra closed her eyes and took a deep breath, concentrating on the energy flowing inside of her.

To perform this technique, it requires peace of mind.

Separate the energies.

Scorpia's words ran through her head again and again as she started doing circular motions with her arms. Sparks happened, and then Catra woke up in her bed. Adora was by her side, curing her wounds.

Okay, maybe it didn't work this time either.

Catra slowly raised those heavy eyelids of hers and almost regretted that decision. Adora was glaring at her like a scolding mother. Her eyebrows furrowed in rage and pursed lips. Well, it was a bit funny. She looked constipated.

"Hey Adora." Catra said simply with a pained smile.

The blonde scoffed and shifted the healing water to her collarbone, where a deep cut was. Catra flinched away in pain but the other woman was stubborn, applying more pressure to the wound.

"Really? After making explode an entire room and nearly blowing yourself up that's all you got to say?! You're unbelievable."

The princess twitched her ear in annoyance but chose to ignore Adora's comment. She knew she was just worried and her anger would fade in a matter of days at most.

“I was trying a new move. That’s all.” She admitted shyly. Adora stared at her for a solid minute and then sighed, her muscles relaxing a little bit.

“Which one? Maybe I can help you with it. Even though I doubt it, you’re far better than me now.”

Catra painfully sat up and noticed all the cuts and wounds on her torso and arms. Adora already healed and bonded the abdominal area, but aside from that, Catra was butt naked and full of bruises in front of her.

“Do you know how to lightningbend?” She asked in a small voice. Asking for help will forever be a struggle for her, but she was getting slightly better at it. Catra felt ashamed. Letting Adora know she risked her own life for a very advanced move that almost no one could do meant admitting her stupidity for ever thinking she could achieve such power.

“No. It’s super difficult to me. Is that what you were trying to do?” She slowly nodded in response, and Adora scoffed.

“Well, I definitely know that in order to do it you must know how to separate the positive energy from the negative one.”

Catra got defensive over Adora’s attitude. She was being treated like a child too stubborn to admit their mistakes.

“No shit Sherlock.”

Adora snorted a laugh and went back to look at her in the eyes with a fond smile that expressed all of her affection.

“How about you meditate with me on my free days? Maybe it can help you with it.”

“You think so?” Catra asked hopefully.

“I know so.”

“Whatever, I’m not doing this just so I can spend more time with you.” Catra retorted in a snarky remark, ruining the perfect moment.

“Yeah sure. So you’re gonna act like you don’t seem to get enough of me at night?” Adora replied with a smirk as she resumed her work.

Catra remained speechless at how forward that comment was.

“*Closer, I want you closer. I need more of you. Oh Adora, yes!*” The Avatar mimicked in a playful manner that made Catra finally shut up. She was so embarrassed that even the tips of her pointy ears were fully red. Adora giggled to herself until she saw a scar on Catra’s collarbone that she didn’t notice before.

“How’d you get this?” She asked. Catra looked down at where the old wound was and sighed in sadness.

“I got it about three years ago in Kyoshi Island. Dear uncle Hordak found me and uh... yeah. I barely made it out of there.” She recalled quickly but still sadly. That was the day Entrapta got captured and Catra still felt guilty about it for not doing enough to save her.

“You really went through hell out there, huh?” Adora asked with resentment at herself. She knew about Catra’s disappearance all along but didn’t do anything to go and find her. The more time passed the more she convinced herself that Catra’s life was probably over.

“Yeah, totally. But hey, here I am now, with you. We’ll defeat my father and then things will be fine. We are gonna be fine.” Catra explained, almost reading her mind. Adora didn’t reply. She limited the ability to communicate to the suave kisses she left on Catra’s scar.

No reaction, so Adora kept of leaving lingering pecks on every spot of her exposed skin. Any single freckle, mark, scar, nothing could escape her lips. Although apparently calm, Catra’s

breath was ragged and irregular. The way Adora worshipped her always made her feel special, like she was the *only* one she'd ever want to come undone under those strong hands of hers. And then Catra couldn't contain herself anymore and pushed Adora's lips against hers in a hot kiss that sent heat through both of their bodies.

They kissed for what seemed like ages, not stopping.

Catra's hands wandered around her body while Adora kept her hands to herself, not wanting to hurt her. The princess, although wounded, felt more alive than ever in that moment. She tugged at Adora's shirt, her silent request for a step further, but something in Adora snapped.

She abruptly pulled away from her and awkwardly cleared her throat before resuming her business back to healing the wounds, leaving the girl confused.

"Did I do something wrong?"

"No, no! But we can't do this when you're like this."

Weak.

"Injured, I mean. You need some rest -which is the exact opposite of what you want right now."

"I can perfectly-"

"You just woke up after nearly blowing yourself up. Trust me, you do not have enough strength."

"You could just sit on my face." Catra replied snarly, expecting Adora to get flustered, but she just laughed at her face.

"I appreciate the offer, but I would *crush* you."

Adora, Glimmer, Catra and Bow were on a ship led by Seahawk on their way to the Southern Water Tribe for the Glacier Spirt Festival. Catra was on the main deck with Swift Wind on her shoulder, watching as the waves moved back and forth in an endless dance that could hypnotize anyone with their sound.

Then, she felt steps approaching her. She didn't even have to turn around to know it was Bow.

Even though he was a muscular man, his walk was almost feather-like. So light it could go unnoticed by anyone that didn't possess her hearing. He greeted her with a yawn, after all the sun had just shown itself to the sky. Catra had always been a night-owl, but the movements of the boat prevented her to get even a decent nap. Everything felt too nauseating for her.

"Hey, why up so early?" The archer asked her with a sleepy tone.

"Couldn't sleep." She didn't have to ask that question back, Bow was an early riser. She learned it the hard way when he barged in her room at five in the morning for the first time.

"Are the others still sleeping?"

"Glimmer is snoring and you know that Seahawk never sleeps." Catra chuckled softly. It was true, that man had an infinite amount of energy.

"What about Adora?" She asked casually, not wanting to sound *too* interested in her.

"She had a bit of trouble falling asleep without you by her side, but I gave her a bit of calming tea and now she's sleeping like a baby."

Tea. Scorpia loved making tea, and Catra learnt to love it with the passing of time. Eventually they shared their love for jasmine tea for the strong aroma and alluring smell that delighted them.

"I know it's not my place, but I have to ask." Catra already knew what he was going to question. It wasn't that hard to notice the looks he'd give her whenever something related to Adora came up. He knew something was up between them.

"You and Adora are both my friends and I worry about you."

"Just spill it out already." She ordered, still looking at the horizon.

"Will you answer?"

"Maybe."

Bow sighed and turned to look at her.

She didn't.

"Are you and Adora a couple?" At that Catra frowned. She didn't understand the meaning of the question at all.

"Like girlfriends, I mean."

Finally, she reacted.

The princess grunted and arched a brow at him, finally looking at his sharp face.

"I literally don't know the meaning of that word. I keep hearing it around but I'm sure if I ask for the definition people will laugh at my face."

Bow's expression went from shocked to giggly in a matter of second. *How could a princess trained to kill be that innocent?*

"It's like what Mermista and Seahawk are."

"Disgusting. I don't do PDA."

“Well, it also means that you two are exclusive and don’t fool around with anyone else.”

Catra’s instinct told her it was a bad idea to continue the conversation and her body responded according to it. Claws came out and dug on the metal railing while her tail ruffled up. But despite her mind ordering her to run away, she finally seeked help.

“You become a couple through a mutual verbal agreement or proposal. Usually people who have deep feelings for one another agree to it. You spend time together and it’s like all the problems in the world disappear. Even this stupid war.” Bow explained calmly like a teacher should. There was no teasing in his tone, he understood where Catra was coming from and didn’t dare to judge.

“Do you like Adora?” He questioned lowly. Catra sighed and shrugged, not really knowing how to answer.

“I guess so? I mean, yeah. She’s— How can you *not* like her? But... I don’t see this ‘couple thing’ happening anytime soon. We’re...” Catra stuttered with every word that came out of her mouth. She felt dirty talking about feelings. It was a very common thing among all nations, but she wasn’t raised to act upon emotions; she had to shut them down. Prime said they were a weakness, and Catra agreed with him for once.

“This is just a *distraction*, okay? Nothing less, nothing more.” It pained her to say those words, but they were the factual truth. Adora didn’t seem interested in her in a *romantic* way, just a physical one.

“We’re both too busy with... this. And even after it’ll be over there’s no way we’d be together. I’ll have the responsibility of leading the Fire Nation and she’ll be off doing Avatar stuff.”

“Do you really think so?”

“I know so.” She cut short defensively and regretted it immediately. Bow was just acting like the good friend he was, worrying for the people he cared about.

But it was none of his business. Except it was, he tried to help the people he cared about.

“Hey, uh... do you have some jasmine leaves? I know a killer recipe for a tea.”

Catra asked shyly and with a hint of excitement that was reciprocated by the man.

“Sure.”

When they arrived, the festival had already started. People from both Water Tribes were reunited and having fun together. Seahawk wasted no time and immediately recognized his girlfriend among the crowd of folks and ran up to her. The group wasted no time and spotted Perfuma and Frosta hanging out together at one of the food stands.

Adora couldn’t even pay attention to the conversation they were having because of how ridiculous Catra looked wearing three fur coats since she suffered the cold.

“*Not a word*.” Catra ordered, putting emphasis on every syllable, but nobody could contain themselves and laughed at how little she looked wearing those items.

“I thought you could control your breath of fire.”

“And I can. It’s just really fucking cold in here, okay?”

Adora giggled and took off her own scarf in order to wrap it around Catra's neck. At that point neither of them knew of their blushes were caused by the low temperatures or the contact, but they didn't dare to question it further.

The whole group had fun at the amusement booths and kept on winning so many prices that they could no longer hold them. So Catra stuffed them under her multiple layers of clothes. At the end of the day she was rounder than a ball, but at least it was warm.

Catra observed at any given chance all the waterbending shows and how the old masters moved. They were slow, sure, but it was a better way for her to observe their movements. She couldn't quite place why, but she felt hypnotized by how fluid and harmonious each movement was.

It was breathtaking.

At night she shared an igloo with Adora, but they just cuddled. It was far too cold to take off their clothes, but they were both fine with it.

On the third day of the festival Catra managed to go around with only one coat without freezing. Walking became much easier without all the extra weight.

As they were wandering around the booths Adora took in a deep breath before acting out on her first move. She wanted to hold Catra's hand in hers to warm it up, even if they both wore gloves.

Quick and painless, she kept repeating to herself. What was the worst that could've happened? A simple no. Adora had handled no's in the past just fine. She slowly moved her hand closer to the brunette's, their fingertips almost touching.

They were so close, just a *bit* closer and-

“Kamare.”

A very old woman asked Catra in disbelief and took a few steps forward. Weirded out, the princess stepped back instead, looking at Mermista.

“She’s Razz. She’s a little weird but completely harmless if there are no brooms in sight.” The chief whispered.

The elderly finally approached Catra, touching her face. In a normal situation with a normal stranger, their hands would’ve gone to flames. But Catra saw agony in her eyes and decided to spare her.

“Oh dearie. It’s been so long.”

“Care to explain who is this Kamare?” Glimmer asked curiously and a bit amused at the scene.

“Kamare was one of Razz’s wards. She’s probably the best waterbender this tribe has ever had.”

“What happened to her?”

“The Fire Nation attacked and captured her. She’s probably gone by now.” Mermista recalled sadly. She had never met that woman, but the best warrior of the tribe deserved a better ending than being killed by Fire Nation soldiers.

“Okay, but why is she mistaking Catra for her?” Adora asked, a little bit irritated. She was so close to hold that tiny hand in hers only to be interrupted.

“She was a magicat. We haven’t seen one of them around here since... ever.”

“You look exactly like her.” Madame Razz recalled, looking at Catra’s blue eye first.

“One eye filled with love and compassion.” She then paid attention to the golden one.

“But the other is full of rage and resentment. The look of the enemy, so scary and damned.”

Suddenly Razz’s nostalgic tone was replaced by a cheerful one instead, confusing the poor girl even more.

“But don’t worry dearie, you’ll be free of your pain *very soon*.” She then moved her hand to scratch a spot under Catra’s jawline, right where the vein was. She figured if it made wonders with Kamare then it’d have the same effect on Catra.

Instead of getting rejection Razz received an unconscious purr in return. The princess almost died in mortification. Purrs were supposed to be reserved to a group of very few people, not a total stranger. The worst thing was that she couldn’t stop it even if she tried her best.

“That woman was really weird, huh?” Adora asked once they were back to their igloo. Catra had been silent ever since the encounter, absent from all interactions. She looked like she was deep in thought, upset about something.

“Huh? Yeah, I guess.” Catra mumbled as she sat on the mattress of their bed, ready to go sleep.

Adora worried about her general absence and kneeled on the floor before gently cupping her face, forcing eye contact.

“Stop thinking so loud and spill the beans already.” She ordered, mimicking the way Catra used to say the same words when they were younger. It worked, she let out a chuckle.

“I uh... that woman trained that girl, Kamare. She was the most powerful warrior of both tribes.”

“Where are you getting at?”

“I’m thinking about *staying*.” Catra finally blurted out.

The world stopped spinning, time stopped ticking and oxygen didn’t enter Adora’s lungs anymore.

“Not for long, anyway. Just a couple of months. I could learn something from her.” Catra started fidgeting her hands in nervousness after noticing the Avatar’s gloomy silence. It seemed as she was already mourning her.

“You said Bow and Glimmer are reliable. The plan is already sorted out, it’s just little details that need to be clarified. If there are any problems you can send a scroll and I’ll reply right away, I swear. A-and maybe you could st-”

Adora interrupted her with a passionate kiss. If they were going to part ways then she had to enjoy the last bits of Catra she had for the moment. Catra wasted no time and kissed her back with just as much fervor. Adora stood up and pushed her counterpart so that she could lay on the mattress as she took off her own fur coat in a hurry.

“Adora-”

“If you’re really going to stay, I need you beneath me one last time. I want you to remember how my body feels around yours.” The Avatar started off, never distancing her lips from Catra’s neck.

“I want you to not forget how I feel *inside* of you.”

I could never, Catra thought, but didn’t say it out loud. Showing vulnerability right before a goodbye was the perfect formula for disaster. So, she let out a moan instead. At that point neither of them cared if they were in freezing temperatures, they

were firebenders for fucks sake, they would've been able to warm themselves one way or another. Clothes were scattered around the room with no cares. Their main concern was to pleasure each other. Whether that'd be with fingers, tongues or restless grinding didn't matter. They just desired.

And so, their whole night was spent moving under the heavy covers made out of furs, touching, tasting, enjoying, craving.

When the sun rose, they both had their eyes closed, but didn't sleep. Catra was too euphoric at the idea of training with Razz. Water and fire were total opposites, sure, but she could still learn something new by studying the art in a more in-depth way.

Adora in the meantime imagined how the next torturous months were going to be without Catra by her side. At that point she was basically the only thing keeping her mentally stable from all the pressure on her shoulders. Not to mention how much Catra meant for her at that point, they were so close to being a couple, just a few more days and Adora would've made the suggestion of making their *relationship* official.

It was unfair. Now that things were starting to look up in a positive way, the fate had to separate them once again.

"You could stay with me." Catra suggested out of the blue after sensing Adora's worry.

"I can't. You know I can't." Adora responded as if it were the most obvious thing in the world, not daring to open her eyes. She sounded angry, and she was, just not at Catra. But of course, she didn't know that.

The princess didn't dare to say another word. She just made her way out of the bed and put all of her clothes back on.

Feeling guilty, Adora sighed and looked at her future past lover.

"Catra, you know it's not-"

“I get it. The war, Avatar duties, blah blah blah. Whatever, it’s not like I even care.” Catra interrupted dryly, approaching the front door so she could get out of there. How could she be so stupid? Of course Adora was going to say no.

It’s not like I even care.

It’s not like I even care.

It’s not like I even care.

Adora replayed those words in her head time and time again, not knowing what to make out of it until her anger did direct towards Catra.

“Fine.”

“Double fine.”

Slam.

They were both alone now.

Chapter End Notes

Don't worry, things will one get worse from the next chapter :)

Capture

Chapter Summary

Catra gets hurt, Adora goes apeshit.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes


@etheriastribe

Adora found herself to be a complete mess without Catra for the first month apart.

She couldn't even sleep at night or get up in the morning. She felt the weight of the World on her shoulders again. Everyone kept asking her for advice regarding the attack, and quite frankly, she had no idea on what she was doing. She wasn't the one who studied battle tactics to lead an entire army, she was just another soldier.

The second month was spent recovering from Catra's loss. Adora was slowly accepting the fact that she had to take matters in her own hands and went back to training harder than ever. She even unlocked the sixth chakra with Light Hope's help. Bow and Glimmer learnt how to manage the organizing of the attack by themselves.

By the beginning of the third month things were starting to finally look up; the Rebellion was at its best phase with a large number of volunteers for the invasion and a meticulously organized plan.

But it meant lying if they didn't admit they had received help from Catra.

Although in the South Pole, she was able to write them letters regarding the attack. She'd send Bow drafts and further improvements of the machines they managed to create together with their genius minds and wrote letters to Glimmer about military strategy. Even if miles apart, the two women managed to still fight. Whether it'd be for her return date or the positioning of troupes, the heated discussions didn't vanish

Catra didn't write to Adora.

And Adora didn't write to Catra.

After their infamous night things became too awkward between them. They didn't even look at each other in the eyes when they

said goodbye. It all felt too real -the pain, the *resentment*.

Adora sighed as she closed her eyes, ready to unlock the last chakra with Light Hope's guidance.

"Once you open this chakra, you will be able to go in and out of the Avatar State at will and when you are in the Avatar State, you will have complete control and awareness of all your actions."

"I am ready."

"The thought chakra is located at the crown of the head. It deals with pure cosmic energy and is blocked by earthly attachments. Meditate on what attaches you to the world."

Adora though about Bow, Glimmer, all her friends, Catra — especially her. Even if she wanted to not have affection for her, she *still* did.

"Now, let all those attachments go. Let them flow down the river. Forgotten."

Adora's eyes popped open in surprise. Now *that* was going to be the most difficult chakra. The situation took in a totally unexpected turn.

"What?! Why would I let go of... I-I *love* my... attachments." But Light Hope's expression remained still as Adora protested loudly.

"Learn to let them go, or you cannot let the pure cosmic energy flow in from the universe."

"Why is it a bad thing that I feel attachments? Three chakras ago that was a good thing!"

"You must learn to let go."

No, she thought. So, everything she had learnt up till that point was apparently useless? Why did she have to go through so much

pain and past trauma if it was all meant to be discarded in the end?

"Adora, to master the Avatar State, you must open all the chakras. Surrender yourself."

Just as she was about to give up, a huge tremor happened, startling the both of them. Adora immediately stood up and used her seismic sense to understand what was happening.

It wasn't any good.

There was a huge machine near the outer wall and at least a thousand men behind it accompanied by metal tanks. It wasn't hard to put two and two together and figure out it was the Fire Nation's doing. Adora wasted no time and used her glider to fly the air and went near the source of disturbance.

She saw Glimmer, Bow and Queen Angella on top of a turret and quickly flew down to them.

"Your majesty, what's the situation?"

The Queen didn't reply and instead pointed at the huge tendril dangerously close to the city followed by dozens of tanks.

"Even if we call for help, it'll take three days at the very least to come. We are destined to fail."

And then everything stopped. Out of the large machine came out Hordak and pointed directly at them.

"Hello, your majesty!" He greeted *happily*. Right next to him appeared Shadow Weaver.

"We just want to negotiate." She started.

"You will give up Ba Sing Se by hook or by crook."

"And why would I ever do that?" The Earth Queen retorted and immediately regretted it.

The old woman signaled to a group of men to bring out something —correction: someone.

King Micah.

He looked tired and dirty. His long beard and messy hair made him look like anything but a king.

Everyone gasped in surprise. He was supposed to be already dead.

"It'd be a pity to make this family reunion last less than desired, wouldn't it?" Hordak asked as one of the soldiers pointed a knife at the neck of the prisoner. It was clear he wanted to fight back, but with tied limbs covered in multiple layers of cloths it was impossible.

Angella and Glimmer were about to resign, it was obvious. They looked so scared and shocked as the apparent willingness to give up rose among them.

But Adora stopped them.

"Not yet. They're playing mind games."

Shadow Weaver laughed at the comment and did the exact same gesture to another group of men. "Oh, really? Bring her in then."

And then Adora's heart stopped beating as a feeling of anguish invaded her body.

Catra was all tied up and thrown to the ground, her mouth covered with fabric. As soon as she started to release fire from her nostrils, a soldier used a stung baton and electrocuted her mercilessly for what felt like hours. A loud scream filled the gloomy silence and Adora almost felt like throwing up because of how powerless she felt at the moment. That had to be the

most horrific sound anyone could've ever heard. All the spectators could feel the pain and fear in that excruciating yell.

When Catra was freed from her torture, she was hit by a chi-blocker before falling unconscious on the ground. Hordak carelessly grabbed her by the scruff and showed the senseless body to the public.

Adora was going to kill him and she'd enjoy every single second of his torturous death.

Catra joyfully walked her way through the Earth Kingdom in order to come back after her departure from the Water Tribe.

It turned out that she learnt more than just something from Razz. The old woman taught her everything she had to know. Together they even figured out a new way to use firebending. Razz used the same principles of waterbenders' ability to heal and applied them to the opposite element. Catra learned how to use heat to find any sources of pain in a body, whether that would've been physical of spiritual.

Talking about spirituality, Razz trained the princess on the art of meditating, making her absorb all those teachings in a matter of three months.

Catra didn't plan to stay that long initially, but as time went on, she figured it'd be best for everyone if she pursued her new training. During that period of time, she changed and grew up. She wasn't a totally new person, but Catra set herself free of the mentality and behaviors she hated so much about herself. After she was finally done, Seahawk gave her a ride on his boat and significantly reduced her traveling times up to a couple of weeks at most after dropping her off following the Serpent's Pass.

Catra hurriedly made her way to Ba Sing Se, happy to reunite with everyone.

Even Adora.

She was conscious their relationship was left wrecked after her departure and felt optimistic on having a conversation with her and hopefully fix it all up.

But then everything went wrong.

Just as the city could be seen at the horizon, she got ambushed by none other than Hordak's chi-blockers. Not having any weapon ready to use, she was forced to use bending for self-defense, but it was useless. She was put out of combat in less than a minute. It was stupid of Catra to let herself get captured this stupidly again, and she felt angry about it. Once completely unable to move her limbs, Catra got thrown into one of the many rooms inside the huge tendril as the machine started moving again towards the capital.

Her legs and arms were tied to the wall, but her face was free. So, when Shadow Weaver explained to Catra how she was going to be used as bate she wasted no time in spitting a huge stream of red fire to the old woman.

She only saved herself because Hordak got in the way of it and then muzzled her, as if the princess was a fucking animal.

With the passing of days, Catra's rebellious attitude didn't calm down and got rewarded in exchange of it. Catra got beat up and tortured multiple times by Shadow Weaver and her large arsenal of punishments. It got to the point where she was refused any water and food for two days.

So, when she was pulled out of the machine and saw Ba Sing Se's walls, she just wanted to yell sorry and beg the Rebellion for forgiveness, but couldn't get any sound out her dry throat until she felt electricity run through her body. It was painful and she convulsed at the waves of shock received all of the sudden. It felt

like thousands of needles poked through the skin, nerves, muscles —hell, even bones.

In just a matter of seconds her fragile physique was scattered on the floor and then picked up again by the back of her neck. Catra felt and heard everything, but was too weakened to react, so she just let it be, even though all she wanted to do was to fight back.

Adora didn't hesitate before jumping in front of Hordak and snatching Catra away from his dirty hands and carrying her on her shoulder.

It wasn't hard to get her back. Hordak was too excited about having captured her that he didn't even pay attention to his surroundings, leading to the general's slow reflexes failing to understand what had happened until it was too late.

"I will never forgive you for this!" Adora's voice was pained, but it sounded angrier than ever before. The low tone and threatening growl were enough to scare half of the army.

"Get her back and start drilling!" Hordak ordered his men.

As the Avatar charged towards him, soldiers got in the way and she had to fight them all off while keeping Catra safe from any harm.

It was hard, *too* hard.

But Glimmer, Bow and the Ba Sing Se's army came to her rescue.

Soon the outside walls were home of a sanguinary fight with thousands of deaths within minutes. As the battle unraveled in favor of the Fire Nation for long hours, the tendril got dangerously close to the city, making every hope of Earth Kingdom survive crumble once the pointy tip made contact with the rock.

But then the rest of the resistance was there. Mermista, Frosta, Perfuma and part of their armies joined the battle. They were supposed to have a war meeting that day and the respective leaders were always chaperoned by highly trained guards.

Mermista and Frosta used ice to stop the engine of the machine and Perfuma lifted it using her plantbending abilities.

But Adora was still the center of attention. She destroyed everyone who tried to touch Catra, even if fatigue got to her. That was until a lightning was launched at her and sent her and Catra flying several feet away.

Still confused by the attack, Adora noticed it was Scorpia who had released it.

The same Scorpia who was supposed to be in prison. The same one that was supposed to be on the good side.

Adora noticed the usual glim in her eyes gone and figured out something happened to her or got brainwashed.

Either way, she had to get Catra back. She quickly looked over the whole battlefield and localized her body lying on the rocky ground. Once she tried to get to it before anyone else could, another lightning forced her to retreat temporarily.

Even without the tendril to use and most of the rebellion united, the Fire Nation seemed to be winning. In the middle of all the action, Catra finally found enough strength to get back up on her feet. It wasn’t long enough when military troupes charged at her. Her whole body ached, pleading for water and rest, but it was a wish that couldn’t get granted in that moment. All alone, she was forced to fight in her weakened state, but she still managed to defeat many units of the enemy's army.

Just when she was about to hit another soldier, she spotted Scorpia about to send a lightning at Adora and didn’t hesitate to get in the middle.

“Scorpia, stop!” She ordered, and her friend seemed to listen.

“Catra.” Adora called, but got ignored. The princess approached her best friend slowly and cautiously. Scorpia didn’t look her usual self, there was something off about her.

“You don’t have to do this. You could join us. We’ll protect you.”

“You never protected me. I got captured because of *you*.” She deadpanned, pointing a claw at Catra’s forehead, ready to fire.

“I know, but we were going to rescue you. Scorpia, I need you. Please, come back.” Catra’s voice was utterly pained as tears fell on the floor.

That seemed to move Scorpia, even for a split second. So, instead of blowing Catra up, she just hit her on the stomach. Catra fell on her knees and the Avatar raised a sand storm in order to cover them as she assisted her.

“Catra, it’s okay. I’m here.” Adora tried to move Catra’s hands away from her abdomen but it was useless. It seemed the pressure she applied was almost vital to her.

“Let me help you.” She begged desperately, but Catra’s sobs got interrupted by her coughing blood.

That was the last straw for Adora. Anger blinded her as her eyes started glowing; she had had enough.

Adora raised herself several feet up in the air with a wind vortex and totalled the machine that tried getting through those walls with an air blade. The Fire Nation slowly saw their hopes of conquering the capital vanishing the more Adora got to destroy and take out soldiers and their tanks. The Avatar lost any sense of self control and attacked whoever crossed her path of rage.

She crushed, maimed, demolished it all in the name of revenge until Shadow Weaver ordered action.

Scorpia attacked Adora with a lightning at the top of her back, right below the neck, making her fall unconscious to the ground, giving the advantage to the Fire Nation once again.

Mermista immediately rushed to her side to aid her while the rest of the group fought anyone who tried to get close to Adora, protecting her.

Catra ran over Mermista, took one of her necklaces off and handed it to her. Frosta gifted it to her before her first departure from the Northern Tribe.

"Use this. Inside the vial there's water from the Spirit Oasis, hurry!" She ordered desperately and saw how precarious the situation was.

Adora lied lifeless on the ground and the army kept going. Even if they weren't going to conquer the city, they pretty much had all the most influential people of the nations at their feet.

If they weren't going to act quickly, they were done for.

So, Catra concentrated all of her leftover strength and used it to create a wall of blue flames around them. No firebender with minimal knowledge regarding that kind of inferno would've tried to go through it. Only true masters could do such move, let alone perform it with a fire that was higher on temperature.

"Mermista?!" Catra called out desperately after taking a quick peek behind her to see what was happening.
The waterbender was trying her very best to heal Adora, but everyone else seemed to be already mourning her.

"Just a sec— She's breathing. She's breathing!" Everyone seemed to be back to life too with the news. It gave the group motivation to keep going.

"I—I can't hold out any longer!" Catra cried out. Her stamina was already drained out. It seemed there was no way out of for all of them.

But maybe most?

Catra looked back at their scared faces one last time,
remembering all the memories shared with them.

Perfuma and her kindness.

Mermista and her determination.

Seahawk and his sense of humor.

Frosta and her enthusiasm.

Bow and his bright mind.

Glimmer and her stubbornness.

And then Adora.

Adora and that hero complex of hers. Adora and her tender heart. It had always been easy being herself around Adora. She was beautiful, and perfect and—

Catra was in love with her.

She had to sacrifice herself in order to save the others,
so she made the flames disappear and raised her hands up as she approached Hordak.

"What are you doing?!" Glimmer called out, but got ignored.

"I give up. I'll willingly return to the Fire Nation." She announced to the public.

"Catra, no!"

Hordak smirked and took one step closer to her.

"Round 'em up! We're all going home!"

The soldiers started approaching the group but Catra raised the flames in front of her friends, building the wall once again.

"You are not touching any of them." The princess commanded calmly, as if her health state was perfectly fine.

"Winning like this was never the way my father intended for the victory to happen and it'd be very dishonorable for the greatest Nation in the world to obtain it like this, wouldn't it?" She asked directly at her uncle, knowing how important honor was for him after being taken out of the line of succession at the throne.

"The Avatar is dead." She lied, none of them heard Mermista before and Adora was still unconscious, that was their best bet.

"This is already enough of a victory for the Fire Nation for today."

Shadow Weaver didn't look convinced, but she still ordered for retreat regardless.

Catra entered one of the tanks with her, Hordak and King Micah and looked one last time at her friends.

That was the end of her.

"Catra, no!"

"Dad, come back!" Forsta and Glimmer called out once the battle was done and most of the troupes gone.

The city was still intact. But at what cost if all hope had seemed to disappear from their lives with an injured Adora and without Catra.

Bow sighed and noticed a scroll laying on the rocky ground. He picked it up and immediately recognized the handwriting.

If you are reading this, it means that I have failed and for some sort of reason had to leave you behind.

It that is the case, then don't notify Adora on why it had to be done. Tell her I was never a good person and used my alliance with the Rebellion to get information out of you to broadcast it to the Fire Nation.

The reasoning behind this is pretty easy: her last chakra requires letting go of all earthly attachments. What we have, what we shared, is too profound. It is not hard to notice it, but she cannot let me hold her back.

Perhaps if she'll hate me, then she'll be able to let go and finally you'll win the war.

Sorry for the inconvenience, but it has to be done.

-Catra.

The Queen felt sick to the stomach as she read it over and over again. They couldn't manipulate Adora like that.

"We may not like it..." Mermista started.

"We're *lying* to her!" Perfuma interrupted.

"But it might be the only way." She finished. The whole group debated on it for what felt like eternity when only a couple of days had passed.

"Mermista might be right." Bow confirmed.

“Our chances keep getting slimmer and without Catra on our side anymore... we have to take every opportunity we might have. I don’t like lying to Adora, and the fact that this is the only way doesn’t make it right but... we have to.”

“There is no other way.” Frosta whispered and a dead silence fell upon them.

It was true, that was their opening, and they had to take it.

But at what cost?

Catra walked with her head held high to the throne room once she entered it.

The Fire Lord looked down at her with his usual hint of smile, the red flames surrounding him growing significantly taller once his eyes landed upon the beloved daughter.

“Hello, Catra. Long time no see.” He greeted with his warm and yet distant voice.

Catra took a big gulp before bowing to him.

“Hello, *father*.” She replied coldly.

“Look at you, all grown up. How long has it been? Three years?”

“Five. It’s been five years.” Five years in which she gained freedom and learnt what true happiness was. Five years of infinite adventures gone.

“Shadow Weaver told me you’ve improved with your firebending.” Catra wasn’t surprised by it. She knew that woman would take

any opportunity to make it seem as if Catra's talent was her own doing.

"I have made a bit of progress, yes."

"Very well, you'll show it to me tomorrow, at the Agni Kai."

Catra's blood froze in that very second. She expected torture, prison, even death, but an Agni Kai?

"Wh- What Agni Kai?"

"Since the usual procedure for traitors is exile, I figured it'd be senseless to follow it because of your long years of travels. And after hearing your mentor's praises about you on the battlefield, I got highly intrigued." The smile got wider the more he rambled, making Catra's tail flick in annoyance at how much he talked.

"So, I've decided that I will give you one last chance to prove your worth. You will fight for your freedom with a duel to the death."

"Against *you*?" Catra asked with a trembling voice. If she were to fight against her father, she knew she'd loose. He was simply too strong for anyone.

"Oh no, child. I do not waste energy for such barbaric activities. You'll fight against my little brother: Hordak."

The general showed no sign of emotion but Catra could smell the fear coming out from every pore of his skin.

"A fight to see who will succeed me and my glorious empire after me. Isn't that exciting?"

Neither of them replied, and the Fire Lord genuinely laughed as he dismissed them.

"Very well, Uzuni, take Catra back to her old room. I'm sure she's exhausted after such travel."

Catra's old caretaker walked in the room and the princess immediately felt better. That woman was the only adult that treated her with true respect and admiration, not like the others did in their own nonchalant way. Uzuni was the one who taught Catra how to take care of her fur and hair and how to retract her claws at will because of their shared race. Catra thought that was the only reason Fire Lord Prime hired her to take care of her. Magicats were extremely rare to find, so maybe he wanted his daughter to have a figure to look up to.

Perhaps, or maybe it was just a very weird coincidence.

The woman looked like she was going to burst with happiness, but still maintained her composure as she bowed before the future Fire Lord.

"Welcome home, princess Catra. Allow me to guide you to your chamber."

And right then Catra noticed something about her that Razz always mentioned whenever she'd talk about Kamare, or well, her.

"Where are your tufts? Did you cut them off?" Razz asked Catra as she tried to meditate in the cold snow. She would always ask and say so many random things that at that point the princess got used to it. But that threw her off; she did have gray hair tufts behind her years that Prime always made her cut.

"Yeah, they always got in my face."

"B-But they were so white and fluffy!" Razz whined and then pulled on her right ear, making Catra yelp in pain.

"And what about the earring I gave you to match mine?!"

The old woman always wore only one purple earring on the left ear. The same exact model that Uzuni wore in that moment. Could it be that she and Kamare were the same person?

Chapter End Notes

I told y'all things would get worse :D
Anyway, lmk what you think in the comments and I PROMISE things will get better from now on, well, sort of... okay maybe not from the next chapter but the chapter after that.

The Day of Black Sun

Chapter Summary

Get ready for family drama, angst and yearning from our favorite lesbians.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes



Adora threw a kick at the punching bag in front of her for what felt like the millionth time in pure madness. It didn't matter if Catra wasn't with them anymore, they still had to defeat the Fire

Lord and prevent her ex.... *something* from ascending the throne.

Catra was a liar, she betrayed everyone and broke her heart. Adora would never forget the morning she woke up after the fight, still weakened by the lightning received.

"Catra lied to us." Glimmer blurted out with hate in her voice and tears of hurt in her eyes.

Adora's eyes almost jumped out of their sockets in shock. She looked among all the people surrounding her in the room. Everyone looked extremely saddened, almost mourning the death of a loved one.

"She faked everything. She got closer to us just go get information for the next attacks and then report them to the Fire Nation."

No no no. Adora couldn't believe it. It was impossible. Catra couldn't have possibly done that. If that were true, then all their fights wouldn't have happened.

Catra wasn't capable of such low blows, Adora knew it.

"H- How? She spent the last months apart from us in the Southern Water Tribe."

"She only stayed for about a week, then she left. I assume she came back home to tell everything to daddy." Mermista deadpanned, looking at the ground. She couldn't look at Adora in the eyes.

"She got attacked by her own people! We all saw how she got electrocuted out there! Her own soldiers attacked her!"

"Adora, it was all staging. As soon as you passed out, she attacked us."

"No, no. It can't be! She, she-"

"She is a liar and traitor. The only reason why they retreated is because they thought you were dead. Apparently, that was enough of a victory for them." The Earth Queen explained with authoritative tone.

Everything crumbled.

And so, another kick landed, tearing apart the punching bag and letting all of its sand slowly fall to the ground. Adora was going to end this war, it didn't matter who she had to get rid of in order to do it.

Catra knelt to the ground of the huge platform with her back turned to Hordak's, ready to fight. Not only did her father set her up to duel against her uncle in her weakened state, but she had to do it in front of a large crowd. In the front seats she could see faces she remembered to belong to the most important members of the Fire Nation nobility, followed by high-ranking people in the military.

The back was filled with peasants eager to watch the return of the Lost Princess - that was how the folk had referred to her in the last years. Among the paysans Catra noticed Uzuni's face. She looked totally terrified.

Of course, she didn't know how much she had improved in the last five years. Catra stood up, letting the shoulder garment fall to the ground, and then turned around to face her opponent. Hordak was tense, it wasn't hard to notice, but he still played it cocky.

“You have no weapons to defend yourself now, princess.”

“And you don’t have your beloved chi-blockers. I think we both know who’s destined to win.”

The man cringed in denial and threw a sudden fire stream at her in anger. Catra waited until the last moment and used her waterbending knowledge to redirect the flames back at him with ease.

Catra could take Hordak effortlessly, she knew that. But she had to avoid showing her true potential in front of everyone, especially the Fire Lord. The last thing she desired was for him to make her fight to conquer cities because of her strength.

Hordak dodged the attack and followed it by performing multiple blazing rings and arcs, so that Catra couldn’t avoid them.

But she could still *protect* herself.

The princess wasted no time and planted her feet to the ground before performing a fire shield that covered her whole body. But Hordak was determined to win; he kept throwing attack after attack, not getting tired.

Catra’s stamina, on the other hand, was already down. Perhaps she forgot to take in count she wasn’t in the best physical state ever before planning for victory.

She had to act, and she needed to do it quickly.

The young woman conjured a large amount of flames and propelled herself at great heights in the air, shocking everyone. In mid-air, she prepared herself to perform a fire kick that was supposed to land right on his head. Unfortunately for her, he avoided it at the last second.

Great , Catra thought to herself. She knew her life was at stake if she lost, and apparently Hordak’s reflexes were superior to her agility and power at the time being. Her initial plan was to tire him

up and then land the last blow, but she had to change it. So, she took the offensive and used all of her leftover energy to attack him with charged blows of fire that got repeated again and again. Some of the hits landed, some others didn't.
And Hordak got to share his arsenal of attacks to her as well.

Towards the end, they were both weak and tired, but neither of them gave up. *They couldn't.*

"Is that all you've got?" Hordak questioned with a faint smirk.

"That's pathetic. Oh well, I shouldn't have had high expectations for a runaway in the first place."

Catra huffed in annoyance, but still didn't make a move on him. She knew his mind games.

"You cause nothing but destruction and disappointment. Scorpia and Entrapta are imprisoned because of you." At that the woman frowned, starting to feel angry. It was true, Hordak wasn't lying. If she hadn't convinced them to follow her then they'd be fine instead of rotting in a cell.

"You betrayed your friends at Ba Sing Se, such a low blow."

"I didn't betray them!"

"You abandoned them! And do we need to talk about Avatar Adora?"

The man grinned and assumed a defensive stance, thinking he knew what was about to happen. Catra stilled her movements, daring him to continue to talk.

"Don't you dare talk about her."

"You two looked pretty close. But look at what happened; she got hurt because of *you* ."

The princess contained the tears that threatened to come out of her eyes. Sure, Adora was alive, but Catra didn't know if she was actually fine or if she received permanent damage that not even Mermista could heal. It was all a big mystery to her.

And it really was Catra's fault. She should've done more instead of playing the damsel in the distress.

Catra almost got Adora killed.

The realization hit her like a truck. She felt sick to her stomach. A deep rage within her woke up again and she finally let it out.

"And now... now you will never be together again—"

Catra wasted no time and intended to launch a fire stream at her opponent, but before releasing it, she pressurized the flames so that they could cover more area.

Blinded by rage, Catra had no form of self-control.

Her fire turned blue in less than a second and loud gasps could be heard across the room. The attack landed perfectly and Catra didn't stop. She ran closer to Hordak and punched him right in the stomach, making him fall on his knees.

But she wasn't done *yet* .

Before the punch landed, she concentrated a small amount of fire on her fist and when it hit, Catra thrusted it down in a huge explosive burst that sent him flying out of the ring and ruined half of the platform.

It was done. Catra had won.

No sound could be heard for a split second. Then, the crowd cheered. But Catra didn't care about them. She looked up to the balcony where the Fire Lord was observing the battle.

He smiled at her.

Catra observed her reflection on the mirror with disgust. She wore an elaborate red robe that was itchy and too heavy by how long it was. The sash accentuated her tiny waist while also slowly suffocating her.

But the worst part was the hair.

The Fire Lord forced her to cut it because of how " *savage* " it looked.

After the cut the ends of her straightened curly locks arrived at chin length. It certainly didn't help that her top-knot was invaded by the headpiece she wore.

The golden crown she wore had to prongs and shaped to resemble the Fire Nation's insignia.

That piece of jewelry was meant to be exhibited by the Heir to the Fire Lord. Catra was supposed to feel *proud* for being in possession of such artifact, but all she could think about was how heavy it was.

Today Catra was going to be officially welcomed to the Fire Nation with a gathering in her honor. It was weird, being back and having it all and still feel so empty.

She sat on the throne right next to the Fire Lord with a faint smile plastered on her face. The posture was impeccably erect and the chin was perfectly held high enough.

She observed as all the guests walked and talked across the room. They didn't have fun, Catra knew that. In fact, they were terrorized. To be in the Royal Family's presence was a nerve-wrecking experience. Everyone was so eager to stay on the Fire

Lord's good side and they would've done everything to keep things that way.

"I didn't know you could produce blue fire with such mastery."

The Fire Lord spoke with a neutral tone, loud enough so that only his daughter could hear. Catra internally panicked. Was he really trying to make conversation with her?

"You have become a true master of the element. I have never seen anybody use their knowledge in other arts and adapt them to their native one. Truly fascinating."

"Thank you, *father* ." The princess replied shortly, still not looking at him.

"But that leads me to question… if you could take out my little brother that easily, why hide your true potential?"

There it was, the trick question. Holding back was seen as a sign of weakness, and Prime knew that Catra did exactly that.

She had to act, quickly.

"It would've been boring if the Agni Kai lasted less than a minute. You wanted a show, I gave it to you."

Catra knew it wasn't enough to convince him, so she used the same manipulation tactics he used on her when she was younger.

"Besides, I like to taunt my prey before finally crushing them. Make them think they're winning, giving the illusion of victory and then… everything vanishes from under their feet. All their hopes are gone. *That's* what really destroys them."

The Fire Lord visibly smiled and went back to looking at the guests, satisfied enough with the answer.

"I guess I really did teach you well after all, child."

"Of course you did."

Adora had been meditating for hours, days, weeeks, months. She had been close to opening the last chakra so many times she lost count.

But the Catra she loved was still stuck in her head. Her mismatched eyes, the freckles scattered all over her body in random spots, her soft tail wrapping against her whenever she wanted to keep their touches as discrete, the way she'd laugh at anything funny that happened...

It all sounded too surreal. How was that Catra supposed to play with everyone's trust and Adora's feelings?

"Adora, focus." Light Hope scolded. The Avatar cleared her throat and straightened her posture with closed eyes and crosse legs.

Adora *had* to let go, whether she liked it or not.

So she recalled all the times Catra had been mean.

There was that one time when they were children, she wouldn't share her toys with her because she thought Adora had cooties, or when she (accidentally) pushed her down the stairs or when....

It won't work. Such a stupid idea .

Something deeper needed to be remembered, so Adora could only hold on to a story with many inconsistencies. Catra had no evil bone in her body, no matter what she tried to show to everyone else.

Or so Adora thought.

She lied to us, she used you. Catra doesn't love you, not like you love her.

The blonde held back tears as she repeated the words inside her head time and time again. It hurt, but it was necessary.

She faked it all. All the promises she told you, her confessions... none of it was true.

Slowly, Catra's smile turned into a memory of her after Adora found her in the desert.

The princess was angry, resentful, vindictive...

That was exactly what Adora needed. Slowly, Catra's memories didn't give her butterflies in the stomach. Instead, she felt pain at remembering all their shared moments.

All of Adora's thoughts stopped, and then she felt some sort of relief coming out of her.

"You have opened your last chakra."

She should've felt happy, but her body was full with sadness and anxiety after a failed attempt at evoking the Avatar State.

There was something wrong.

"Wh- What's going on? Why can't I enter the Avatar State?!"

Catra wore her royal attire for the war meeting she was attending to. Not only did the Fire Lord allow her to participate, but she sat on his right. She had finally gained her father's trust.

“We need to attack the Air Nation.” One of the commanders proposed. That single sentence caught Catra’s attention and caused her to speak up.

“Why?”

“Avatar Adora is dead. If we follow the cycle then the reincarnation will be found among the Air Nomads.”

Catra felt a tug on her heart as she remembered her old lover. She wondered day and night if she was okay. She was even tempted to write a letter, but knowing she was kept under observation, she couldn’t trust anyone. And then she remembered how misinformed the Fire Nation actually was. First of all, Adora was still alive. Secondly, in their eyes, she died while being on the Avatar State, so technically there was no threat to worry about.

Catra played those cards in her favor.

“Very well. If that’s the case then we’ll need vehicles that float on air to get us there.”

“I’ll have a talk with Entrapta later.” Catra glared at Hordak. He looked miserable. After the Agni Kai his life was spared and still got to maintain his position as general. The only thing he lost was just his title as prince and his honor – not that he had any before his loss.

The princess requested her friends to be released, but got denied. When asked why, the Fire Lord only dismissed her by saying they were both traitors.

So she tried to visit them, but nobody allowed her to. It all seemed like a big scheme against her, but she had to put up with it. There was no other option.

“I visited all four air temples. Even if the monks look like pacifists, they can be very dangerous if threatened. We’ll need our troupes to be at their very best…”

Perfect, setting a date so that she could refer it to the Rebellion after her future escape planned for the day of the eclipse. After learning about their defenses and the underground bunker, Catra knew the invasion plan was going to fail if Adora didn't manage to open the last chakra.

Her plan was to confront the Fire Lord that day and hopefully join the team again. That was, if they wouldn't get captured.

Only two weeks.

"The day of Prime's comet." She announced. "We will all receive the power of a hundred suns. What other perfect day to use?"

The Fire Lord seemed satisfied with the proposition enough to accept it.

"I think it's settled then. Catra, you will be in charge of the attack. With your cunningness and power, *I* will conquer the entire World."

The war meeting, although successful for Catra, resulted on almost all of her energies being drained out. Sitting on a chair whilst listening to old men arguing about obvious choices really was annoying. But at least the torture was done.

When the princess reached her own room, she noticed Uzuni pouring a cup of tea on her nightstand. It smelled like jasmine. The servant quickly bowed to the royalty and excused herself before trying to leave, but Catra quickly closed the door. She needed to talk with her.

"I'd actually like for you to stay. Take a seat." She instructed kindly. Although Catra couldn't trust anyone, there was still some feeling of familiarity shared with her.

"I want to talk about my last travel. Is that okay with you?"

The adult cheered up and smiled warmly at the princess.

"Of course. Go ahead."

"Very well. I travelled to the Southern Water Tribe…"

Catra started, looking for any sign of nervousness from her counterpart, but everything seemed to be in perfect order until she flicked the tip of her tail a couple of times.

Perfect.

"I stayed there for a couple of months. I hated the cold. Is it normal to suffer it this much, even with my fur?"

"Not at all, your highness. You were raised in a hot climate, therefore your body is not used to the freezing temperatures."

Catra nodded in understanding and took a sip of the beverage. It was quite good, but not as tasty as Scorpia's.

"I got to learn all about the culture and history. It was quite interesting. I even got to hear about a legendary warrior that loved not too long ago. Have you heard of Kamare?"

At that Uzuni's smile lost its genuineness and turned into a fake one. Catra could smell the fear coming out of her.

"I don't believe I have."

"She was the best waterbender among both tribes. She fought countless battles against the fire nation and then they killed her." Uzuni scoffed and eagerly finished her cup of tea before replying.

"That sounds like a painful death."

"Razz still believes she is alive."

"That old woman always says random things. You shouldn't pay attention to her." *There it was.* The little slip up

finally happened!

Busted.

“Funny, then how do you know who Razz is, Kamare?”

The woman’s eyes widened and she clumsily tried to stand up from the wooden chai she was sitting on, trying to reach the exit as fast as possible, but Catra stepped in between and pushed her backwards.

“Okay, chill. I’m not here to create problems. I just want answers. I’m not going to get you into any trouble, I swear.”

The servant almost hissed in response, but then remembered the princess was in front of her. So, she regained her composure, or at least tried to.

“I’m afraid I have to go.”

“Considering the fact that the Fire Lord definitely knows your identity —since, y’know, you were one of the biggest threats to him after the Avatar— then he allowed for your change of persona. Am I wrong?”

At that point Kamare had already given up. It was clear Catra discovered her.

“No, you are not.”

“Why are you not imprisoned?”

“The Fire Lord and I made a deal.”

The princess felt like she was being lied to with that answer, but understood her fears and let it slide.

“I- I won’t tell my father about this. I don’t want to get you in trouble. I know you’re not telling me the whole truth, but I must assume that you have your own reasons.”

Kamare sighed in pure relief and bowed in sign of gratitude.

“Just… I’d like to hear stories about your youth sometimes and learn from your past battles.”

“You will hear them, your highness—”

“Catra. Just Catra, please.” The brunette suggested. Being treated like a royal all the time turned exhausting.

“Catra, I will tell you all about my past. But right now, is not a good time. I have other duties to attend to.”

Kamare excused herself and turned her back on her, only to be stopped from leaving one last time.

“Razz says she misses you.”

“Mermista, Frosta, you’ll take out the turrets. Perfuma: you will help with your plantbending and take out as many soldiers as we can.” Glimmer explained the plan once again to everyone as they were on the ship on their way to the invasion. Behind their main ship there were at least ten other boats filled with warriors from all nations.

The Great Gates of Prime were only minutes ahead of them. That day would’ve gone to be remembered for centuries as the end of the war.

“Bow, do your submarines work?”

“They have no flaws.”

“Perfect. Adora, you’ll use your glider and go ahead into the Royal Palace and defeat the Fire Lord. Nothing can go wrong.”

Adora only nodded, not using any words. She felt terrified to say the least. She was supposed to have opened the seventh chakra, but something inside of her was deeply wrong, she could feel it. Her body and spirit weren't in harmony.

"Now!" The earth princess ordered to the troupes once they were close enough to the gates.

All waterbenders worked in synch and created a screen of steam that hid all ships from any sight. Nobody talked and nobody moved. They had to be as quiet as possible in order to go undetected. However, a massive burning activated itself after the sound of the loud alarm. Soon, jet skis rapidly travelled towards the fog. The resistance knew what to do. They all hurried up and evacuated the ships via submarines before the Fire Nation soldiers would've been able to arrest anybody.

Once inside Bow's newest invention, Mermista and Frosta used their waterbending abilities to move the machines under water and easily surpassed the Great Gates.

The means of transport made their way towards the inner sea and then to the coast. Once on the surface, Adora was ready to leave with her staff, but then Bow stopped her.

"Adora, wait." The boy handed her a new glider. The wood was thinner, came with blue wings and fins deployed through spring-loaded mechanism.

"Bow, this is amazing." Adora gasped as she held it in her very own hands. It was also considerably lighter compared to the ones Air Benders used.

"It even has a snack compartment. That was Catra's idea. I figured it might turn out useful after all." He admitted shyly.

Adora's smile dropped for a faint second at the mention of her past lover, but then she hugged him, and then Glimmer. Yes, losing Catra destroyed her on the inside, but the world needed the Avatar in that moment, not an angsty Adora.

“Thank you Bow. Good luck out there, commander Glimmer.”

“Good luck to you too, Avatar Adora. Now, go!” Adora wasted no time and went in search of the Royal Palace, ready for action.

While in air, she observed the multiple troupes of Fire Nation soldiers hurrying up to attack the invaders. There must’ve been thousands, but Adora knew they could take them with ease, especially during the eclipse.

The Avatar quickly reached the capital’s walls above the volcano and stopped up there to observe the situation. The city appeared to be completely isolated. Perhaps its inhabitants were hiding in their own homes, but that didn’t seem the case.

Everything was strangely weird. But Adora couldn’t waste any time with questions and instead made her way to the unguarded Royal Palace.

She blasted the main gate open with airbending and would’ve been ready to fight if it weren’t for the fact that nobody was inside.

Now she started getting worried. A strange feeling told her to stop looking for the Fire Lord and retire back to the main attack, but she had to find him. Adora desperately ran to the throne room only to find it completely empty.

They knew about the attack and evacuated the city.

Where did the Royal Family go?

Catra took a deep breath as she went inside her father’s room in their underground bunker. Her hair wasn’t tied up in a neat top

know or slicked back. Instead, the curls were let out and wild in the air, symbolizing her rebellion.

“Princess Catra, what are you doing here?” The villain asked in slight surprise.

“I’m here to tell the truth.”

“Telling the truth during the middle of an eclipse... this should be interesting.” He dismissed all of his guards, only Uzuni remained in the room. The woman looked at her with wide eyes. Catra knew she was scared for her fate, but she wasn’t afraid at all.

“First of all: the Avatar is not dead. She survived.” The heir to the throne finally announced and, for the first time ever, she saw fear in her father’s eyes.

“In fact, she’s probably leading this invasion. She can be on her way here right now.”

“Oh no...” Kamare whispered in pure desperation. The tension in the room could’ve been easily with a butter knife by how intense it was.

“Get out! Get out of my sigh right now if you know what’s good for you.”

Catra took a couple of steps back, startled by the Fire Lord standing up and angrily approaching her, but ultimately decided to not back up.

“That’s another thing: I’m not taking orders from you anymore.” He took another step closer to her and she proceeded to take out her dual swords. They couldn’t hurt each other without their firebending, so she figured out to bring her old weapons with her for protection.

“You will obey me, or this defining breath will be your last!”

“Think again! I am going to speak my mind, and you are going to listen.”

“Catra-” She glared at Kamare and the woman closed her mouth shut immediately.

The Fire Lord, knowing his disadvantage, sat back down on his throne.

Time to speak.

“When I was a child, all I wanted was for you to love me, to accept me. I thought it was my honor that I wanted, but really, I was just trying to please you. You, my father, who rejected me for all my life. My father, who allowed me to be abused by Shadow Weaver. My father, who didn’t even bother to look for me while I disappeared for five years until the very last moments of my freedom.”

“Dear, I did this to teach you a lesson.”

“It was cruel! And it was wrong.”

“Then you have learned nothing.”

“No, I’ve learned everything, and I’ve had to learn it on my own!”

Catra’s grip on the weapons tightened as she found enough bravery to keep talking. Prime failed to keep his composure with his burrowed brows and the pained grin on his face.

“Growing up, we were taught that the Fire Nation was the greatest civilization in history. Somehow, the war was our way of sharing our greatness with the rest of the world. What an amazing lie that was. The people of the world are terrified by the Fire Nation! They don’t see our greatness, they hate us! And we deserve it. We’ve created an era of fear in the world and if we don’t want the world to destroy itself, we need to replace it, with an era of peace and kindness.”

The man laughed in her face, making Catra feel intimidated once again.

"All your friends have gotten to you, haven't they?"

"Yes, they have." She took a deep breath to relax. Even if he seemed to go back to his unfazed attitude, she knew how angry he really was.

"I am going to free Scorpia and Entrapta from their prison. And I've also made a more important decision: I am going to join the Avatar and help her defeat you."

"Really? Since you're a full-blown traitor now and you want me gone, why wait? I'm powerless, you've got your swords. Why don't you just do it now?"

"Because I know my own destiny. Taking you down is the *Avatar's* destiny." Catra folded her swords back to their original place and began walking away.

"Goodbye."

"Coward! You think you're brave enough to face me but you'll only do it during the eclipse. You have any real courage; you'll stick around until the sun comes out. Don't you want to know why I've been searching for you? It is related to your *mother* after all."

Catra's steps drew to a halt all of the sudden as her curiosity perked up. She turned around and found Kamare standing right in front of her, basically protecting her.

"Sir, please-"

"Move out the way, woman! I am having a talk with *my* daughter." The adult's fur prickled up in distress. Catra looked between the two of them and gently pushed Kamare away from her.

"It's fine. I'll be okay." She stepped up in front of her and finally faced her father, indicating for him to talk.

“As you know, you were never a wanted child.”

“No need to remind me.”

“Your mother is not a noble woman. In fact, she isn’t even from the Fire Nation. You are a bastard child, product of a night that should’ve never happened in the first place.” He talked slowly, calmly. It seemed as if he had gained control again.

“I was merciful enough to not terminate the both of you. When you were little, I almost got rid of you because you started firebending at a very late age. And even then, you couldn’t control it. You were a total savage, like your mom and her people.” Catra scoffed at his degrading comment and growled as a sign of danger. She also felt Kamare tense up behind her, but she didn’t know why.

“But nevertheless, you showed great raw power, so I put you next in line for the throne. When you were gone, your mother threatened to reveal her true identity if I didn’t start looking for you. Poor thing, she was desperate. I sent Hordak to find you only after learning about how much your power increased.”

Catra’s heartbeat rose up in realization. Her mother was not dead and probably knew her personally if she was that worried about her.

“This means she’s alive... What did you do to her?!”

The villain chuckled and pointed at the woman behind her.

“I don’t know. Why don’t you ask Uzuni?” The brunette frowned and looked back at the woman. She looked guilty. Did she hurt her mother?

“Where is she? Tell me where she is!” When she didn’t reply, Catra showed her long claws as she was ready to fight. She had too many questions that were left unanswered, but all she could care about was to save an innocent person from Prime’s hands.

“Fool!” The Fire Lord exclaimed, gaining the princess’ attention again.

“You are looking at her.”

Catra’s blood froze in pure shock. She slowly turned to look back at the woman standing right in front of her and examined her terrified face. They both shared race, brown hair, the same fur color and the same shade of blue in their eyes.

Of course. It was so obvious!

“I-I can explain, I swear.”

The Fire Lord stood up from his throne and started making circular motions with his arms, provoking sparks.

The eclipse was over.

“Now, I’ll finally get to end your miserable lives!” In that very second, a lightning came out of the tip of his fingers and was destined to hit the both of them.

That was one of those moments were your life passes right through your eyes. All the laughs, all the tears, all the traumas and the beautiful experiences lived.

But not for Catra.

She acted quickly.

She caught the bolt with the fingertip of her hand. The immense electricity that entered her body was almost too overwhelming to take, but she had to resist.

Catra let the energy pass through the arm, then the stomach and up the other upper limb.

This technique was invented by herself after learning the waterbender’s philosophy of turning their opponents’

strengths against themselves. She had never used it before, but knew it had to work.

She extended the other arm and the lightning came right out of it and landed on the rock ceiling, making debris fall on top of Prime.

Now it was time to run.

Although all of the adrenaline in her body, Catra was left with only enough energy to stand, however, she fought the tiredness and started dragging Kamare by the arm.

"We have to go." She mumbled weakly as the pair wobbled. They had to hurry up if they wanted to make it out of there alive, but they were soon followed by angry guards.

Catra kept on running and running until she felt a slight tug on the sleeve and then turned around to see Kamare using her waterbending to hold the enemies away.

"What are you doing?!"

"Just run! I'll slow them down for as long as I can!"

Soon the woman was alone and fighting against dozens of men.

"Kamare, let's go!" She called desperately, but got ignored.

"Mother!" Catra yelled in hopes of gaining some sort of attention, but failed. She didn't want to leave her; she had to stay and save her before-

"I told you to go, I'll be fine! Don't be stupid and leave!" Catra looked into those tired blue eyes of hers and saw fondness in them. Kamare begged her to leave, and Catra had no other choice but to trust her on her word and hope she'd be fine.

The princess ran and ran through infinite tunnels until...

"What do you mean it's empty?!" Glimmer asked when Adora came back. The rebellion had already gained territory to the capital city and things seemed to be going better until that very moment.

Adora hurriedly explained the situation to her and Bow and they all decided to go back to the Palace, maybe the Fire Lord was hiding close to the location.

Glimmer clashed both of her feet on the ground and concentrated on the vibrations, there was definitely something underground, perhaps a structure, but it was all too fuzzy to see clearly.

The two earhtbenders worked together and found a bunker. Nobody hesitated before going down and exploring it.

They had few minutes left before the eclipse would've started and they wasted all of them by looking in every single room they had found until... Hordak and Shadow Weaver appeared in one of the chambers.

No words were exchanged and the battle immediately began. Although left without bending, the man could still use swords and bare hands to keep up with Bow and his fast arrows.

The young man launched attack after attack until one of his inventions released a net mid-air that trapped Hordak, leaving him defenseless. On the other hand, Glimmer and Adora were having a much harder time with Shadow Weaver. Although not powerful, she had very effective techniques acquired during the time spent working as a Dai Li agent in her youth. She disappeared through walls and reappeared in other random places, taking the girls by surprise before landing multiple hits on them. Her speed was unmatched, but her technique was predictable.

“Close your eyes!” Glimmer ordered Adora, suggesting for them to use the seismic sense on her.

In just a matter of seconds Shadow Weaver was on the ground with a powerful blow struck by Adora and Bow hurried to tie her limbs, incapacitating the woman from bending again.

“Come on, we’ve lost too much time. We need to hurry up!” Glimmer yelled and began running, only to stop after hearing Shadow Weaver’s voice.

“Don’t you want to know what happened to your father?” The other two teens glared at her and Glimmer raised her by the collar of the dusty uniform.

“What did you do to him?!”

“My favorite prisoner talks about you all the time. He was sure you were going to rescue him. Of course, you never came, and he gave up on you.”

Glimmer’s eyes shone with tears threatening to come out. She raised her fist, ready to give that woman a lesson, but Bow stopped her.

“She’s trying to make us waste our time.”

“He’s right. We have to find the Fire Lord!”

“So what are you going to do when you’ll find Catra?” Hordak spoke up instead.

Now it was Adora’s time to get angry.

“None of your business.”

“Are you really going to take her back, even after leaving you? You really are pathetic.”

“Shut up! If it comes down to it then she’ll have the Fire Lord’s same fate and then you’ll be next in line.” She replied threateningly, but he only chuckled as the eclipse terminated, gifting him of warmth.

“Seems like your time is up, Avatar. What are you going to do?”

“No no no no! It can’t be!” She yelled out of frustration while Glimmer kept on debating if she could end both of the villain’s lives right then and there.

“I-I can try and…”

“Adora: no. We have to go. We thought we had the element of surprise on our side, but we clearly were in the wrong. All we can do now is get away from here as fast as we can.” Bow suggested.

This was a massive loss for the rebellion, but they had never gotten that close ever before. Adora would’ve gotten another chance, she knew it.

“Alright, let’s go.” She whispered and achingly started walking away from the enemies with great sadness.

The trio hurriedly made their way out of the bunker and then the Royal Palace only to find Fire Nation’s hot-air balloons and airships floating in the air.

“My invention…” Bow mumbled, feeling guilty for creating it.

“What happened?!” Perfuma asked as soon as she noticed them. Soon enough Mermista, Frosta and Seahawk joined them as well.

“It was all a trap! We need to get out of here as soon as possible.” Glimmer freaked out.

And then they all heard a way too familiar groan.

Catra fought against a soldier to get one of the airships and seemed to be winning.

She looked like a wreck. Her hair was a mess and the sleeves were completely shredded, exposing her toned arms. The girl hit the man on the head with a club, knocking him out in an instant. She then felt her friends' presence and almost smiled. Happiness invaded her body, but she was still exhausted from the long day.

“Get inside, we have to go! They’re aiming for the submarines at the coastline. Your soldiers are not going to make it.” She ordered instead of playing nice. If they really did what she asked them to, then Adora was probably mad at her. And judging by how devastated they all looked, she still hadn’t opened the last chakra, meaning she still had to let go of her. Maybe if Catra played rude and distant it would’ve been easier for Adora to do that tedious task.

Everybody got inside except for the Avatar. She just stood here with clear confusion on that beautiful and damned face of hers.

“So, what? She literally betrays us and we follow her?!”

“Adora, I know it’s weird, but right now you have to trust us and get in before we get captured!” Glimmer pleaded. Still reluctant, she made her way inside.

“Route to the Northern Air Temple.” Catra said to Seahawk, who was already turning on the engine.

“What for?”

“The Air Nomads are in danger.”

Chapter End Notes

> What a ride, am I right? Catra is the daughter of a legendary water tribe warrior, Adora can't access the Avatar State, even though they've missed each other a lot the first thing they do

is srart bickering.... again, what a ride.
I'd say we are 2/3 into the fic, which means it's coming closer to an end. I'm really enjoying doing this crossover between my favorite TV shows so let me know what are the parts you've enjoyed the most among all these ten chapters :D

PS. If you want snippets and more fanarts regarding what I write I'd reccomend you to follow me on @etheriastribe ;)

The Boiling Rock

Chapter Summary

7.8k words of pure Glitra.

Chapter Notes

TW: sexual assault.

See the end of the chapter for more notes



"What do you mean the Air nomads are in danger?!" Glimmer asked, but Catra barely had any energy to stand.

The feline wobbled to where Melog was laying and fell to her knees as she nuzzled into its' thick fur, finally achieving some sort of comfort. In order to get to the courtyard, she had to pass through the stables where she heard a way too familiar meowing.

She didn’t even hesitate for a split second before taking it with her.

“The Fire Nation is gonna attack them the day of Prime’s comet. We can’t let that happen.”

“*We*? Can somebody please explain what is happening here?!” Adora asked in disbelief. It almost seemed as if everyone was fine with having Catra with them. None of them seemed angry at her, making Adora question her morals. Why was she the only mad one?

“Okay, we warn them. Then what? The war was supposed to end *today*, and now we don’t even have a plan anymore.” Bow reminded with worry. Mermista, in the meanwhile, started checking up on the princess but got quickly dismissed with a faint *I’m fine* .

“We are going to take back Scorpia, Entrapta and King Micah. I know where they are. We need all the help we can get.”

“I’m with Catra.” Glimmer said as matter-of-factly. She finally had the chance to rescue her father and she wasn’t going to waste it.

“I uh… there’s also someone else. It’s kind of a long story, but the legendary warrior from the water tribe, Kamare, she’s alive and probably there. We’re busting her out as well.” Catra admitted, omitting the little detail regarding her true identity. If she’d told them the truth, they would’ve thought that the rescue was something more emotional rather than strategical.

“She’s alive?”

“Can somebody explain to me what’s going on?! She literally betrayed us. The attack failed because she probably ratted our intentions out!” The Avatar finally said as she looked at the traitor, but the brunette just closed her eyes and hid behind Melog’s fur, knowing that Adora couldn’t possibly hurt her.

Even if she hated her.

“Can we talk about this tomorrow? It’s been a very long day.” Bow begged and Perfuma finally exploded.

“We’ve been lying to you.” She blurted out, gaining glares and groans of frustration from both Frosta and Mermista.

“Catra asked for us to. She thought it’d be easier for you to access the Avatar State at will once you cut her out of her life and to keep your head fully in the game. I think she did it because she didn’t want to be a distraction for you.”

“Is that true?” Adora looked at her friends right in the eyes, well, tried to. They were all looking elsewhere to avoid making eye contact.

She felt hurt, sad, angry. But most importantly; she felt betrayed. These people were supposed to help her, not put her through *more* pain. They all knew how much Catra meant to her, and yet decided to keep lying to her face.

And Catra, well, her request to lie was what most hurt Adora. How could she have done it? Asking their friends to leave, surrender willingly to the Fire Nation, leaving her life behind… leaving *Adora* behind.

It was all too much.

The Avatar turned her glare to Catra, but the woman was already fast asleep. She desperately clung into some of the animal’s tufts, almost as if that creature was the only thing left in the world that was meant to be hers and nobody else’s. In the middle of the debate, the airship kept on getting blasts from the enemies that followed them. Seahawk did all he could to avoid the attacks along with Bow as his co-pilot and eventually lost the other machines among the dark clouds. It caused a bit of turbulence, but nothing they couldn’t handle after the adventure of the day.

They reached the Western Air Temple when night came and were all greeted by Netossa and Spinnerella,
Adora’s airbending teachers.

"We have an urgent message to deliver to the council!" Bow pleaded and got quickly dismissed.

Whatever it is, we can talk about it tomorrow morning.

They kept on repeating over and over again. Their uncaring attitude would've made anyone angry. But everyone understood their philosophy and after an hour or so, they let go.

All of them got the luxury of having a room assigned for each of them. Usually, they would've insisted on sleeping in groups, but the high tensions were too much to handle, especially Adora's.

Once in her room, the Avatar started crying uncontrollably with the internal turmoil happening in her mind.

Catra's really back and she isn't a traitor, but she is a liar. All the months spent trying to hate her turned out to be useless, because she didn't use you; Her feelings are real.

She told herself, but then other questions rose up in the air.

Was this her plan all along? To make you fall in love with her and then dump you to help you open your chakras or were her actions genuine? And if so, does she really think she's a nuisance?

Adora wanted answers, *needed* them. Her body gravitated towards the door, but she stopped herself.

She was still angry after all.

If Catra truly cared about her, then *she* was the one supposed to go to her and explain. Catra, on the other hand, slept without a single problem. Her body was exhausted after redirecting the lightning and her mind too tired after processing all the events of the day.

She really had a mother, and she was alive. Something about that revelation actually made her happy, but also worried for Kamare's life. The Fire Lord only tried to kill them because Catra provoked

him. Maybe when it came to decide Kamare's new punishment he opted to send her to the Boiling Rock. After all, he considered the death sentence as something barbaric, so the chances of her being alive were high.

Nevertheless, the princess easily closed her eyes and drifted into a peaceful sleep.

"The Fire Nation is going to attack you and you have no intention to act up on it?!" Adora yelled at the council of four men. It didn't matter if they were supposed to be the wisest beings among the Air Nomads, their decision was reckless.

"That is not what we said, young Avatar. We will activate our defenses if necessary." One of them said, making the past lovers get even angrier.

"My father is going to annihilate all of you if you don't do something. He has vehicles that float in the sky, getting up here is going to be extremely easy. You have to do something." Catra bickered in favor of Adora. They were the only ones allowed to talk with the elders because of their political importance in the matter.

"How can we believe you, princess Catra? You *are* the enemy." The brunette scoffed and got closer to the bitter old man that dared to retort to her justified comment.

"Because I attended war meetings that talked about this genocide. The Fire Lord won't go easy on you. Whatever gets on his path to conquer the world will be destroyed with no mercy. If we want to avoid that, we need to attack them first!" If looks could kill, Catra would've already died at least five times. Maybe she overstepped the line.

“How dare you? The Air Nomads are pacifists!”

Fuck the line, the nomads were being too unreasonable!

“Oh, so you’d rather get your people slaughtered because of this stupid philosophy?!”

“How about you all evacuate to the Eastern Air Temple?” Adora suggested kindly to calm down the tension. Even though all she wanted to do was to rip her hair out, she had to be the peacekeeper in that meeting. Both parties were on the offensive and couldn’t find common ground, which was desperately needed.

“It’s the furthest one from the Fire Nation so it’ll take longer for the army to reach it. Your people are going to be safe and by the end of Prime’s Comet the Fire Lord will be defeated –without your aid, of course.”

“That does sound like a better option than fighting.” The same male that argued with Catra earlier replied, looking much happier at the proposal.

“You two can leave now. We need to make an important decision.”

Adora bowed while Catra was already walking out of the room. The blonde groaned and pulled the princess by the tail, making her yelp in pain.

“You need to pay respect to them!” Adora whisper-yelled.

“I’m not doing shit; they were rude to me!” At that she had enough. She grabbed Catra by the scruff and forced her to bow her head like a mom would do to their impolite child.

“Fuck off.” Catra scolded after they were finally out.

“I don’t know if you’ve noticed, but we’re trying to avoid a mass genocide here. You need to stop behaving like a spoiled brat!”

Catra wanted to yell at her because of all the frustration, but all she did was to turn her back at Adora and whistled for Swift Wind to follow her into her room. She wasn't going to argue with her, the last thing she wanted was to make things worse.

Once in her room, she found Glimmer sitting on her bed, *weird* .

"Sparkles?"

"We need to go to the Boiling Rock. We have to save my da-! Everyone. We need to save everyone."

Catra frowned suspiciously at her. Glimmer didn't have any reason to worry about anyone else besides King Micah, but didn't pay much attention to it. The more aid she got, the better chances she had.

"You've said it yourself: we need all the help we can get."

"Let's say I agree, how are we going to get there? Seahawk is still trying to fix the engine of our airship."

"We can go with a flying bison."

"Are you nuts? Those things aren't exactly discreet for infiltrating that prison." Catra deadpanned and then remembered that the dirigible had a hot-air balloon in the vehicle's inside in case of emergencies.

"Alright, listen up. We have a war balloon and we're going to use that to get there."

"Are you serious?!" Glimmer smiled and happily petted Swift Wind, who was sitting on Catra's shoulder, causing for their faces to be close.

"We can't tell anyone, though. The mission is going to be risky and the last thing I need is everyone forcing us to not go."

"When do we leave?"

"Tonight. We'll just tell the others we went hunting for some meat."

Glimmer got on her tiptoes to scratch the lemur's head and Catra could feel her hot breath against her face. It was a bit awkward for her at first. Only Adora dared to be this close to her face -and sometimes Bow as well to massage her ears, despite her protests.

But at the end she didn't really mind the closeness. They were *only* friends after all.

Right in that moment the door opened, revealing Bow with a smiley face that then turned into a sad one.

The two girls pulled away awkwardly and Catra cleared her throat in discomfort.

"Hi Bow! What are doing here?"

"I wanted to talk with Catra. What are *you* doing here?"

"I wanted to talk with Catra, too."

"Did I… interrupt anything?" He asked. His tone gentle but also pleading. Inside his head he hoped for a clear no, and that was the response he got. He would've believed it if it weren't for their awkward replies and nervous glance.

"I'm gonna leave now. So you two can talk alone." The earth princess announced and made her way out of the room, giving Catra and Bow some privacy.

"What's up?"

"Are you okay?" His tone was warm and nurturing, just what Catra needed, but a small voice in her head kept telling her to keep distance.

“What do you mean?” After so many months spent in a rightful paranoia for being observed and controlled at all times, she maintained the defense mechanism.

“You went back to your father, Shadow Weaver and Hordak. You always told me how terrible they were to you. Did they do anything to hurt you?”

The princess sat on the bed, followed by the archer.

“They tried to. I had to fight an Agni Kai with Hordak, but I won. Shadow Weaver and I didn’t cross paths, so I guess that’s something good. Then the Fire Lord tried to kill me yesterday and now I’m here. All things considered I’m still alive.”

Catra replied shortly and with a hint of sarcasm. It was all true, but she didn’t want for him to worry about her. Then, she felt a comforting hand on her shoulder.

“But are you really fine? Like, mentally? That environment is very toxic after all. I’ve noticed you’re always over the edge and you’re also hyper aware of your surroundings.”

They both knew the answer to that, but Catra didn’t want to say it out loud. Instead, she scooted closer to him and let him hug her and even let him pet her ears. Bow didn’t even squeak in delight when he heard the soft rumble coming out of her chest.

Catra didn’t feel the urge to cry, there was no need to. She didn’t feel exactly secure in his arms, but it was at least very reassuring. She finally felt at ease, relaxed. It was nice.

Catra and Glimmer left in the middle of the night without nobody noticing. The travel ahead of them was going to last twelve hours

at the very least.

Glimmer slept while Catra kept the balloon on the right route and blasted fire into the tank to keep it moving, but when morning came, an uncomfortable silence fell upon them.

They had never been truly alone until that moment.

"Pretty clouds." The small woman commented, trying to sound casual.

"Yeah… fluffy." *Spirits*, Catra really was socially awkward. *Fluffy*, seriously?

"Both you and Bow had an amazing idea with these war balloons. Y'know, a balloon… but for war."

Okay, maybe Glimmer was at her same level of dumbness, which made her feel better.

"If there's one thing the Fire Lord is good at, it's war."

"Yeah, it seems to run in the family."

Catra should've felt somewhat offended by it, but she actually was proud of her analytical mind, it got her out of many dangerous situations.

"You're pretty good at war too, Sparkles."

"Keep the lies to yourself. We failed. The invasion was *my* idea in the first place. It was *my* decision to stay when things were going wrong. It's *my* mistake and it's *my* job to fix it."

"It's not your fault, okay? Shadow Weaver spied on you guys and told the Fire Lord about the plan. It would've gone perfectly fine if it weren't for her."

But even with the reassuring words, Glimmer still felt guilty. "I have to regain my honor."

“You’ve never lost it. You did all you could with the best intentions. You were brave enough to keep up with the attack until the very last second. If anything, that gives you *more* honor.”

At that, she chuckled, sparking Catra’s interest.

“You know, you’re actually pretty wise.” Glimmer admitted, making her blush in embarrassment. She had never been complimented like that ever before. It felt nice -not like when Adora did it, it was a different type of nice.

“I guess that Air Nomads have already got into me. I’m glad we left. Can you imagine me sitting on a log to meditate day and night?”

“Boring.”

“Super boring.”

Then, Catra scratched her neck uncomfortably.

“Hey uh… thank you, by the way. For telling Adora I was evil. I know that must’ve been hard for all of you.” Glimmer sighed and looked at the white clouds with sadness.

“Yeah, I did not like one bit of it. I hope she’ll forgive us.”

“Hey, you’re her friend. Sooner or later she’ll come around. Just give her some space and respect her wishes.”

“Is that how you two would make up after a fight when you were younger? By *respecting her wishes* ?” Catra looked upset for a quick second, and then she shot fire at the tank once again to distract herself.

“When I was a kid, my emotions were very intense -they still are, but I manage to not explode most of the times. I would always push Adora over the edge with my feelings. I made her really upset a couple of times. I learned the hard way that you can’t

always be thinking about yourself. Other people have emotions too, and you need to take them in consideration."

"That's actually a pretty good advice. I think I was like that as well with Bow."

"Really?"

"Yeah. I'd get jealous if he made a new friend. I was afraid he'd leave me behind."

"Me too." Catra whispered. The only difference was that Adora did leave her behind, but that was in the past. She was the Avatar, of course she couldn't set her duties aside for a spoiled princess.

"Why didn't Adora use the Avatar State during the invasion?" She finally asked. The question had been on the back of her head for a couple of days by then. It all seemed too strange.

"She did unlock the last chakra, but she can't enter it."

"Why?" Catra asked through gritted teeth. Adora did let go of her, but their sacrifice seemed to have been made in vain.

"We don't know. But we think that it has to do with the lightning that almost killed her. Light Hope says she was hit in one of the chi paths."

Well, that was very, *very*, unfortunate.

With the passing of hours, the conversations turned into more lighthearted ones with Catra asking Glimmer about her adventures with Bow and Adora. The funniest story was when they first crossed the Serpent's pass only for fun and almost got killed.

And then, Catra caught sight of the volcano where the prison was.

“There it is! There’s plenty of steam to keep us covered. As long as we’re quiet, we should be able to navigate through it without being caught.”

That was supposed to be the plan, but luck wasn’t on their side. By entering the hot zone, the air on the outside was just as hot as the air inside, so the balloon began losing attitude quickly. It didn’t matter how many blasts of fire Catra threw at the tank, it still didn’t work.

“Hop on my back!” She ordered when they were just about to crash. Glimmer didn’t even question her command and did as she was told to, too fearful for her life.

The brunette propelled the both of them in the air by using the fire that came out of her feet and managed to do a decent landing on the very base of the rock where the prison was.

Their vehicle, on the other hand, sunk into the boiling water, but neither of the two women seemed impressed by it.

“I figured this was a one-way ticket.”

“And you still decided to come along?” Catra asked, surprised. Glimmer’s determination was truly admirable.

“You don’t seem too frustrated about the situation, so I guess you knew what was going to happen as well. You’re risking it all for your friends and I’m doing the same for my family.”

“Touché.”

“They left to haunt meat?!” Adora almost yelled after reading the written letter. It was Glimmer’s handwriting; she could tell because Catra’s was practically unreadable. The news came to a shock to her. Those two never got along in the first place, why would they leave without anyone else? But after all, liars stick together, right?

Bow looked like he was basically on the verge of tears, so Adora got closer to him, even if she was still mad at him for lying.

“Why do you look… like that?”

“I don’t know if I should tell you.” He whispered. Of course, *another* hidden truth.

“But I think they’re starting to get romantically involved...?” He sounded confused, but not as confused as Adora.

“What do you mean?” She asked, trying to play it cool. She wasn’t interested in Catra, not anymore at least. She only asked for clarification.

“Yesterday I saw them interact, and their faces were very, *very* close. I think they were about to kiss. And now, this? It doesn’t… It just…”

Adora stared right ahead of her. Were those two seriously having an affair at a time like this? And when did they start having it? There was no way they got together in the last 24 hours, so they had a secret relationship going on for six months at the very least.

Did Catra cheat on her? No, they weren’t together in the first place.

But Glimmer knew how she felt about Catra and still stabbed her in her back. She was a traitor.

Then Adora looked into Bow’s brown pupils and saw herself reflected on them. Bow was just as heartbroken as Adora was.

“You like Glimmer, don’t you?”

“I love her. But this… I can’t do this Adora.”

“Me neither.”

“You look ridiculous, Sparkles.” Catra said after they both had put on uniforms used by the guards. The brunette had to sneak into the supply room at night to get them, risking their mission, but she did it effortlessly.

“I hate you.”

“Are you ready?”

“We need to lay low and find the others as soon as possible. Meet me at the yard in an hour?” They knew the plan. Catra was supposed to check inside while Glimmer stayed outside, and that was exactly what they did.

During those sixty minutes, Catra proceeded to get some food from the lounge and took her helmet off to eat with no fears.

Very few people knew about the existence of Prime’s daughter, and they were mostly found in the capital city.

Catra’s face had been captured in multiple portraits that remained *inside* the Royal Palace and her face was barely shown in public.

Even if there were wanted posters about her, those could only be found outside the Fire Nation. The Fire Lord knew she was too smart to stay there, so he figured she was outside the territory and announced her existence only to the rest of the world.

She happily ate some fire flakes and then approached a table full of other soldiers in need of some answers, but how was she supposed to communicate with them?

They were total strangers and the only thing they had technically in common was their job.

Think Catra, think!

"Can the new gal ask you veterans a few questions about the prison?" She asked seductively to the group of women, catching their attention.

"I'm sorry, beautiful, but you can't date other guards." Catra almost gagged at the compliment, but contained herself for the sake of the plan.

"Not really interested in dating, if you know what I mean." She sent a sultry look at all three of them and couldn't believe the hunger in their eyes. Was she really luring them with her flirty attitude?

"But I didn't want to know that. The Boiling Rock, I heard that one the Fire Lord's servants revolted against him and wondered if she was sent here."

"Oh, yeah. I heard about that. Truly interesting case." The same woman said. Her brown eyes kept wandering between Catra's lips and body, making her feel self-conscious. She only had to keep up the flirting for a few minutes and then she would've been free from that torture.

"I heard she's actually from the Water Tribe. She was supposed to get here this week, but I think her travel got delayed for whatever reason." She almost let a breath of relief. Her mother was alive! And she could save her, although that meant postponing the plan.

"Why are you asking, love?"

"I, uh… like you said, interesting case. I was just curious."

"Hotman." Glimmer said to the guard right next to her on the yard. During the time off she learned that prisoners that used firebending were put in the cooler, but there were no signs of her father or Catra's friends.

"What the fuck, Sparkles?" Catra asked, confused, making the other girl panic.

"What? Is there something wrong? Adora told me that's how you greet people from the Fire Nation." Of course, Adora would say such things. How could she *not* ?

"Yeah, if you are like eighty or from the colonies."

"Well, now all the guards I've met will think that I'm a weirdo."

"Whatever, it doesn't matter. I've talked with the people here. Kamare should get here in a couple of days, I was thinking we could wait for her before and then escape."

"I don't think it's a good idea. We can't risk it all for a person we've never met. We don't even know if she's still fit for fighting."

Glimmer's reasoning wasn't wrong, Catra knew that, but she couldn't help the anger building up in her body.

"I-! Do you… any news?"

"I haven't seen Scorpia and Entrapta."

"Just fucking peachy! This mission is turning into…" And then the brunette spotted someone unexpected, making her mismatched

eyes basically pop out of her skull.

The girl was wearing the prison grab as she sadly sat on the floor. Her olive eyes and locks remained untouched.

“It’s Lonnie!” She announced excitedly, but Glimmer didn’t budge.

“…Who?”

“The leader of the Kyoshi Warriors! I met her about three years ago. I didn’t k ow she was here, but we have to bust her out as well.”

“So, are we going to free every single person we recognize or…?”

“If they’re helpful and we have a debt with them then yes.”

“As the Earth Kingdom’s princess, I suppose it’s my duty to free her.” Glimmer saw how guilty Catra looked and understood that the girl meant something to her. Besides, how was she supposed to regain her honor by leaving her citizens rot in a prison?

“Are you sure?” Catra asked, still unsure. She felt like she was asking too much; selfish.

“Totally. I won’t let any of my people suffer in here. “

“Great! You’ll talk to her and I’ll wait outside the cell, just in case anyone walks by.”

“Why don’t *you* talk to her?”

Catra felt blood rushing to her face and thanked the spirits that she was wearing her helmet in that moment. “Trust me, you don’t want to know.”

Glimmer entered Lonnie's cell and was greeted with a harsh glare and scolding tone.

"What is it? Did I do something wrong?"

Glimmer scoffed at her attitude. Never in her life had she ever encountered someone that acted so disrespectfully in front of a princess except for Catra herself. And then she remembered she was dressed up as the enemy. Adverting the anger from the other girl, she slowly took off her helmet and saw how her expression morphed from angry and daring to shocked and scared.

"Your majesty! I'm sorry."

"You're cool. Now, I don't have a lot of time left, so let me get straight to the point." Lonnie nodded, and the princess explained the escape plan. Catra, on the other hand, was not having a good time outside the cell. The nerves of being caught were destroying her and the moment she heard a guard walking towards their direction she knocked on the metal door to alert Glimmer, but it was already too late.

"Excuse me, I need to get into that cell."

"N-no, you can't go in there!" She said with way too much fear to not arouse any suspicions.

"The prisoner could sneak up on you." And then Catra recognized it was the same woman who flirted with her earlier.

"How about a deal, beautiful? I leave the prisoner alone if you and I spend some quality time together." She towered over Catra and saw how those brown eyes literally undressed her in her imagination.

She felt sick to her stomach and her heart felt heavy all of the sudden.

“How... how about we go to the lounge where the others are?” Catra proposed instead, but the taller woman grabbed her by the wrist and started dragging her away.

“Where did that flirty attitude go? Are you shy because we’re all alone? Let me tell you hun, I *love* shy girls. Come on, we’re going to my room.” Catra desperately tried to pull her arm free, but the woman’s grip only tightened, not getting the hint.

“I don’t want to go.”

“What’s wrong, are you afraid I’ll tell the warden? I promise you, it’s going to be our little secret.” She turned around and trapped her between the wall and her own weight before forcing her into a kiss.

The woman’s lips were dry and harsh on hers, and her breath was heavy. She tasted like fish, *revolting* .

That was the turning point for Catra, she punched her so hard in the face that she heard a crack noise coming from the nose, but she didn’t stop. She threw as many kicks and slaps as possible and continued doing so after the woman loudly asked for help.

Glimmer, who had just gotten out of the cell, didn’t know what to do. She didn’t even know what happened between them two just seconds prior. However, she could see madness in Catra’s eyes and understood that the other woman was automatically on the wrong.

But they still couldn’t risk their plan. So, she made her way over the two fighters and pulled Catra off of her, restraining her.

“You’re under arrest!” The princess declared and felt how tense Catra still was. Her claws were fully extended and her breathing was irregular.

“Catra, it’s okay. We’ll figure it out.”

It wasn't okay. Catra was tied to a chair in a dark room all alone with the same woman she attacked and the warden.

"Everything would've turned out just fine for you if you had stayed quiet." She whispered, and Catra spat fire out of her mouth in an attempt to attack her that was blocked by the short man standing in front of her.

"Well, well, well. I never thought I'd find you here, Princess Catra." The tall girl's expression shifted to a terrified one.

" *Princess* Catra?"

"As soon as I'll be in charge, you're gonna be the first person to try out my personal guillotine." She replied with a wicked smile and enjoyed the terror in her eyes. Sweet, *sweet* revenge.

"Quiet!" The warden called out. "You're my special prisoner now. And you'd best behave, if these criminals found out who you are – the traitor princess who let her nation down- they'd tear you to shreds."

"So, what's in it for you? Why don't you just tell my father to come and collect a reward?"

"Oh, in due time, believe me, I intend to collect."

Great, just great.

Lonnie and Catra silently mopped the floor as Glimmer stood in front of them. Neither of the old acquaintances dared to say a

word to each other, it was far too embarrassing.

“I see you guys have rekindled your... friendship?”

“Actually, it wasn’t quite a friendship, especially in the moment before Hordak arrived and burned down our village, remember?”

Catra started blushing as she remembered the last moments spent together, but then resumed her task.

“Yeah, sorry about that. Nice to see you again.”

Glimmer sent a questioning look at her, but Catra ignored her. No way she was going to tell her past story with Lonnie. The trio then secretly hid behind a staircase, making sure no one watched them.

“Alright, I have an idea. I checked out the coolers again, and the point of them is to keep firebenders contained, right?”

“Yeah...” Catra said painfully. She already knew the plan would include her being isolated into one of those freezing machines.

“So, they're completely insulated and sealed to keep the cold in. Well, to keep the cold in, it also has to keep the heat out, right?”

“Get to the point, Glimmer.” Lonnie frowned at her impudence, impressed at how someone could ever use such tone with the future Earth Queen.

“It's a perfect boat for getting through the boiling water. I walked around the perimeter. There's a blind spot between two guard towers. It's the perfect launching point. I already tested it out. We'll roll the cooler into the water and just float with the current. It'll take us straight across. As long as we don't make a sound, no one will notice.”

“Sorry, but it’s not a good idea. There’s too many of us to fit in there.”

“Actually, no. I mean... do we *really* need to
save Scorpia and Entrapta?”

“What do you mean?” Catra asked in a threatening tone. She wasn’t going to leave them behind, not again.

“Entrapta is actively helping them build machines
and Scorpia literally tried to murder Adora.”

“Entrapta is a good person and I’m totally certain that Scorpia was brainwashed.”

“What about Kamare?”

“We are taking her with us! End of story.”

Glimmer observed Catra’s angry expression and kept her mouth shout, wondering on a way to save everyone and still escape.

“I have another plan, but it’s much more dangerous.”

“Shoot.”

“First, we let all the prisoners out of the cells and guide them into the yard. Then, we start a riot. We use the chaos to our advantage and run to the last floor where my
dad, Scorpia and Entrapta are. We can easily take down the guards if we work together. In order to escape, we’ll use the cableway.”

“That sounds impossible.”

“Well, either we do it this way or we leave someone behind. Your choice, Catra.” Glimmer retorted rather aggressively. All the pressure and stress building up was definitely not helping their strong personalities to get along.

The brunette hissed at her, but then looked down.

“Fine then, we’re using the cableway.”

“Glad we’re on the same page.”

Then, they heard bells ringing. That meant that the prisoners could breathe fresh air outside the walls. Once out, Catra saw the gondola approaching the roof of the prison and the world stopped spinning for her. Maybe Kamare was in there!

“Welcome to hell!” The warden introduced sarcastically, and all the prisoners got out of the means of transport that took them there.

Some of them were young, others, were very old. Some short, some tall. Both men and women were trapped there. With each face that wasn’t Kamare’s, Catra’s heart sunk a bit more. And then, no one came out of there. It was over.

“Hey, you! Get off the gondola!” And finally a magicat came out. She had brown hair and blue eyes.

Her mother was there.

Glimmer’s curiosity perked up as she travelled to the top of the tower. She wanted to see what the big deal with her was and why Catra was so obstinate on rescuing her as well. All the prisoners were lined up as the warden spoke to them.

“Welcome to the Boiling Rock. I'm sure you've all heard the horrible rumors about our little island. Well, I just want to tell you that they don't have to be true, as long as you do everything I say.”

He stopped in front of Kamare who looked downward. “Look me in the eye when I'm talking to you.” He said, but got ignored.

“No.” She simply said and Glimmer almost smiled. That woman was really stubborn.

“Oh? You’d rather look at my shoes? Then take a look!”

He raised his left leg and dragged Kamare by her handcuffs down onto the floor, forcing her to kneel over, his face expressing anger.

The warden stood over her, keeping his foot firmly pressed on the warrior's handcuffs.

“I know exactly who you are, Kamare of the Water Tribe. So strong-willed. But don't worry, we'll get rid of that in time. Now look me in the eye!”

Kamare reluctantly lifted her head to look at the warden in the eye and glared hatefully at him. That was the exact same look Catra had when she accepted Glimmer’s plan. So serious and intimidating.

“See, isn't that better? You will all do as I say or pay the price. You will all...”

He began to walk forward only for Kamare to lift her left handcuff slightly, tripping the warden and causing him to fall flat on the ground. Glimmer stifled a chuckle, as the two guards he was standing behind rushed to aid the warden.

She definitely had a strong and witty personality.

“Kamare, right? You were awesome out there!” Glimmer said as she entered the woman’s cell at night, immediately alerting her. She rose to her feet and extended her right arm out, hand clenched in a fist.

“If you take one step closer, you’ll see how *awesome* I am.” The princess panicked and took off her helmet.

“I- I’m not the enemy. I am the princess of the Earth Kingdom and I’m here with Catra to rescue you.” The woman softened up and grew teary-eyed.

“My daughter is here?”

“I don’t know, maybe I’ve seen her somewhere. What’s her name?”

“Uh... Catra?” And then everything clicked in Glimmer’s mind. Well, almost everything. She told her that her mother was dead, and Glimmer felt she wasn’t telling a lie. But the two women were practically identical: same hair, species, same blue in the eyes...

“Wait a minute, aren’t you supposed to be Kamare, a legendary warrior from the Southern Water Tribe?”

“I am.”

“And you’re also Catra’s mother?”

“Positive.”

“But how... I mean- you and her... she and you...”

“So she didn’t tell you.” Kamare sighed and sat on her bed with her head hung low.

“I understand, she learned about my true identity the day of Black Sun. I guess she’s still processing it all.”

Glimmer frowned in disappointment for not understanding what Catra was going through earlier because of how invested she was on saving her own father.

“Ma’am, you’re gonna be reunited with your daughter very soon. We are escaping tomorrow with other people. What I need you to do is to...”

The very next day, Glimmer approached the guard in the charge of the cell doors, ready for action.

“Hey, I just got orders. Let the prisoners out into the yard.”

“But we’re in the middle of lockdown.”

“Oh, okay, I'll just go tell the warden you said that. I'm sure he'll be glad to hear about you undermining his authority. What's your name again?”

“Wait! Don't tell the warden. I'm just a little confused.”

“Hey, I'm confused too, but the warden's in a bad mood, and ... irrational, so if you ask me, it's best not to question it, and just do what he says.”

“Yeah... you're right. We're letting them out!”

The guard opened all the doors by pulling the levers. The prisoners headed for the yard and Catra, Glimmer and Lonnie soon met.

“Where’s Kamare?” The brunette asked, earning a scoff from Glimmer.

“You mean your *mother* ?” Catra’s ears pinned back to her head as she hissed defensively, only to relax when she heard that soft tone of hers.

“Catra, are you okay?” She turned and immediately wrapped her arm around the grown woman, feeling some kind of warmth in her heart.

“You’re really here.” She whispered. Kamare smiled and gave her a tight squeeze before letting her go.

“As much as I’d like to talk to you, we have an escape plan we need to put on.” The princess sighed in defeat and looked at Lonnie.

“Do you know how to start a riot?”

“A prison riot? Please.” Lonnie looked around and pointed at a blonde boy. He looked defenseless and tiny, just the perfect catch.

“Hey, Kyle!” She grabbed him and lifted him in the air, bouncing the poor victim up and down.

“Riot!” And just like that, all the prisoners went crazy and started fighting against guards and among themselves.

“We need to get inside!” Glimmer ordered, and they all ran to the upper floor of the structure.

“Catra, are you sure my dad and the others are up here?”

“Affirmative. Well, at least for your father. He’s in a wooden cell.”

“Why a wooden cell and not a metal one?”

“Let’s just say you he invented a new style of earthbending.”

“Excuse me?” A guard appeared right in front of them and Catra easily knocked him out with a simple punch in the face.

“Metal. He can bend metal. I don’t know how he does it… there!” She pointed at a wooden door right down the hall and handed her mother a bottle of water.

“I need you to cut through the wood with it. Can you do it?”

Kamare smiled at her beloved element and got to work with no complaints. The technique she used was far superior than Mermista’s, Frosta’s or Perfuma’s. She moved with fluidity and decision.

The door got destroyed in less than three seconds and the girls came in.

Micah was sitting on a corner, confused as to what was happening. Glimmer smiled widely at him, but he only recognized Catra.

“Princess?”

“Get up. We’re getting you out of here.”

The bearded man didn’t hesitate and followed them into the dark hallway. Glimmer looked at him with hope in her eyes, but the man was probably too busy processing the events to notice his daughter in front of him. After all the last time he saw Glimmer she was barely a toddler.

Catra desperately opened every door she’d find until there was a specific one that drew her attention. There was a dim light inside and Catra could very well see Shadow Weaver’s silhouette. She didn’t even hesitate to open it, but before she could attack, Micah had already trapped the old woman by using metalbending.

And then the moment arrived. Scorpia had her eyes closed shut and kept on shouting “No.” repeatedly.

Catra saw a lantern that travelled a circular trail and destroyed it. Only then, did Scorpia open her teary eyes.

“Catra?” The princess didn’t think twice before hugging her best friend tightly. It was hard not to start crying, but she managed.

“It’s me. You’re gonna be fine now. I promise.” Micah freed the prisoners of the metal cuffs that forced her to stay sat on the chair.

“What were they doing here?” Kamare asked, and the King replied.

“Dai Li brainwashing. I guess that’s how they convinced her to participate in the attack.”

“I-I didn’t want to hurt you, wildcat. I swear!”

Catra smiled warmly at her. “I know. Don’t worry.” She said, and then her eyes landed on Shadow Weaver. The girl created a fire dagger and approached her, only to be grabbed by the arm by Glimmer.

“We don’t have time!” She reminded rightfully, and Catra was glad she didn’t try to stop her by saying some moralist bullshit. Glimmer understood Catra’s resentment perfectly, and that was why they knew what was best for the other. That was exactly why Catra limited herself to only spit on her face instead.

“Savage, like always.” The old woman deadpanned, but the heroes were already out of the cell.

“Do you know where Entrapta is?” Scorpia nodded and led the group to what seemed to be a laboratory.

“Entrapta, Entrapta!” Catra called out and the response came immediately.

“Oh, Catra! Hi.” The girl with purple hair said as she observed a project displayed on the table.

“We need to go, now!”

“Go? Oh no, I have everything I need here.”

“You can’t stay here. It’s dangerous. We’ll take you with us. Don’t you miss us?”

“I do. But I like science.”

“We have an inventor with us and you two can share ideas and learn more together. Working alone doesn’t sound too exciting after a while. He was the original inventor of the war balloons.”

“What?! Take me to him, now!” Catra sighed in relief, typical of Entrapta.

The group successfully made it up to the top of the tower where Lonnie already was.

Weirdly enough, she had the warden all tied up in front of her.

“Care to explain?” Glimmer asked.

“Bargain. If we escape with the gondola they could cut the ropes, but with him on board with us, they won’t do anything.”

“That’s… pretty smart. I forgot how clever you actually are.” Catra said as they made their way to the mean of transportation.

“Part of the package. Muscles *and* brains. Not too mention looks.”

The brunette scoffed and waited for the rest of the group to be inside before pulling the lever.

“You’re too cocky.”

“Oh, please. Don’t act like you don’t love it. I mean, we did go on dates.”

Catra chuckled and jumped inside the gondola as she remembered the old times.

Glimmer, in the meantime, looked shocked at the revelation. That explained why Lonnie didn’t use the word friendship to describe their relationship. They were *romantically* attracted to one another!

The guards started filling up the top of the structure and looked at the warden with them.

“Cut the ropes!” He ordered, making everyone in the gondola laugh.

“If they cut the ropes then you’ll die!”

“Oh, they know that.” The man said simply, and his subordinates actually started cutting the metal wires.

Catra looked at their speed and how much time it would’ve taken the gondola to reach the destination and sighed in relief.

“We’re safe! If things get too risky then we’ll jump. Don’t worry, we’ll be close enough.”

“Good idea, Sparkles.”

“Thanks, Catra. I think your genius is rubbing on me.” The two girls looked at each other fondly.

Just when they were about to reach destination, the gondola started swinging repeatedly. The guards were almost done with the job, but they were already safe. Everyone quickly jumped off the gondola and then to the solid ground while the warden was sent back into that same unstable carriage.

“If that woman was on the island, that means that she must have come here somehow.” Lonnie said, referring to Shadow Weaver. She then walked up a large hill by the sea and spotted a large airship.

“There! That’s our way out!” She announced, and Glimmer patted her back.

“Good thinking. Let’s go.”

“Thank you, your majesty.”

King Micah froze in place. That teenage girl definitely looked like him and she gave him a sense of familiarity. That was *his* daughter.

“Glimmer?” The girl smiled shyly.

“Hi, dad.”

“Okay, as much as I love happy reunions, we have to go or they’ll catch us!” Scorpia announced nervously and Catra nudged at Entrapta.

“Wanna show me how to ride one of those airships?” She asked, knowing it’d get the genius excited.

“Let’s get it started!”

Chapter End Notes

Just to be clear, Glimmer and Catra are just friends and about Catra and Lonnie... I'm not gonna say anything, but we're going to get jealous Adora VERY soon.
If you liked this chapter, please comment and leave kudos! You have no idea of how much an engaged and active audience means to me. :D

I'm Yours

Chapter Summary

Jealousy and smut.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes



Adora was training with Spinnerella when a Fire Nation airship approached the temple. Immediately alarmed, they reached the

yard were the other Air Nomads and team Avatar already were, ready to fight.

But then, right as the vehicle landed and the door opened, Catra came out with a shy smile and a wave of her hand.

Adora felt her heart sink once again at the view of her face. She was finally back, but the anger still remained and even resurfaced with more intensity.

"It's cool! No one is gonna attack you!" She announced, and then came out of the flying machine, followed by people nobody imagined to see.

Scorpia came out first, and Perfuma didn't hesitate before engulfing the tall woman in a tight hug. Then Entrapta wasted no time and approached Bow.

"Hi, I'm Entrapta. You must be Bow! Catra's said so many nice things about you. I find your inventions truly fascinating! I was wondering if…"

As the girl with purple hair kept on rumbling, Lonnie appeared, but nobody recognized her, so she just stood alone in a corner. Then, Glimmer finally exited the airship with her father, who didn't get recognized by anyone except for Bow. The man immediately kneeled to the King without thinking it twice. Everyone stared at him weirdly and Adora raised an eyebrow at Glimmer, looking for answers.

"This is my dad." She announced proudly, and then everyone kneeled along Bow.

"B-But I thought… where did you two go?!" The Avatar asked, completely disoriented. The events were simply too confusing.

First, Catra and Glimmer almost kiss, then, they leave together and then, they come back with a Fire Nation airship and the people they lost in the past. What was Adora supposed to make out of that?!

“The Boiling Rock.” Catra replied with a big smile, the first one she had worn in months. “We saved them.”

The brunette turned her head to look at Kamare, who was a bit hesitant to approach the group, but Adora immediately smiled at the woman, recognizing her.

“Uzuni! You were imprisoned too?”

“I, uhh…”

“It’s a bit complicated, but uh… her real name is Kamare.”

Adora felt like her mind was about to explode with all of her theories and this situation.

What was that supposed to mean? She was Uzuni, the woman who nurtured Catra and spoiled Adora from time to time, not a legendary warrior! Mermista and Frosta immediately approached the woman and bowed.

“It’s an honor to meet you!” They said with cold sweat on their foreheads. Kamare frowned and looked at her daughter while pointing at the two of them.

“Frosta and Mermista?”

“Yeah.”

“Oh.” She then turned to them with a kind smile. “It’s an honor to meet you too. Catra has told me so many nice things about both of you.”

Frosta felt like fainting at that moment. Not only did her idol acknowledge her presence, but she also talked to her! Catra then approached Lonnie and wrapped an arm around her shoulders, alerting immediately Adora.

“And this is Lonnie! The leader of the Kyoshi warriors! Without her I wouldn’t take a fan along with me at all places. She’s going to

join us and if one of you dares to disrespect her, I will punch you.” Lonnie blushed and giggled at the declaration:

“As if I need your protection. I could literally beat your ass, kitty.”

“Uh, yeah... three years ago! Now I can knock you out in less than a minute.”

“Bet you a hundred gold pieces you can’t.”

“Oh, it’s on!”

“Catra, wait-!” Adora called out, but got no response as the two women ran away to duel.

Why were those two so close already? Catra mentioned knowing her three years ago, so why all that familiarity? When she first met Adora, the only thing she received was a constant glare and distrustful behavior.

Bow and Adora were once again together, making up possible hypothesis of what was going on between the women they cared so much about.

“Do you think it’s possible?”

“I don’t know, Adora! Glimmer knows how you feel about Catra and Catra probably knows you love her.”

“Correction, love-*d* .” The blonde said, putting emphasis on the past. She didn’t love Catra, in fact, she *despised* her.

“So it’s very unlikely for them to be… *that*. But I know what I saw, their faces were so close!” Bow sadly sighed and held his head between his hands. The weight of thinking was simply too much.

Adora noticed his exasperation and rubbed his back in comfort. "You really care about Glimmer."

"What if… what if I'm not good enough for her? She's a princess. Of course she'd go on and date someone high-ranking. I'm just a simple inventor and archer."

"Hey, no! No self-disdain in here, okay? You are an amazing human being and I know Glimmer definitely feels something for you. She hasn't told me anything but the way she looks at you… it really says a lot."

"You really think so?" He asked with raspy tone and a voice crack. Adora nodded without hesitation at the question. Glimmer and Bow were meant to be together and Catra was getting in the way of that.

"Adora, have you really gotten over Catra?"

"Of course I have." She replied without thinking about it. Catra was in the past. She was just a liar that played with her feelings. She was a bratty and demanding princess with terrible sense of humor and communication skills. Every time Adora would complement her, she limited herself to move her head away and growl instead of saying something like *thank you* or *you're beautiful too* .

She'd also hide her pouty face in the crook of Adora's neck and would nuzzle into it as an alternative response.

The Avatar tried not to think about those big mismatched eyes, *or* the infinite freckles across her face and back, *or* the pointy nose that would get red whenever she blushed, *or* how beautiful her laugh was whenever she'd cackle at one of her own jokes, *or* how cuddly she was at night, *or* …

Okay, stop it!

"Alright Scorpia, you'll sleep on my bed tonight." Catra explained to her best friend. The tall woman faintly nodded in response and the brunette sighed before engulfing her in a warm hug.

"Do you want to talk about what they did to you back there? Seeing Shadow Weaver with you in the cell really worried me."

"I, uh… I don't remember a lot actually. She'd always come into my cell and do that weird thing with a spinning lantern. I-I…" The brunette took her hands in hers and gave a squeeze in reassurance.

"If it's too hard for you to continue, then you should stop. I'll be ready to listen when you'll be comfortable."

"I *am* comfortable. It's just very hard to remember, literally. I only have blurry memories of when I was brainwashed.
I can't even recall the attack in Ba Sing Se. I mainly remember the weekly visits from Shadow Weaver… I'm so sorry Wildcat."

"Hey, it's cool. That wasn't you. Now both you and Entrapta are safe with us. Nothing bad will happen to you. I promise."

Scorpia sighed in relief and Catra started purring, knowing that the buff girl would always relax with the sound produced by her chest.

Then, someone knocked on the door. Catra tiredly stood up from the bed and found Perfuma. "Hi, I'm here to-"

"I'll let you two talk." Catra dismissed herself quickly without even hearing the blonde. She knew those two were romantically involved *somehow* and understood that they needed some alone time. So, she headed to the top of the tower.

Adora was there as well.

Before she could do anything about it, the Avatar turned around and stared at her wide-eyed.

“What are you doing here?”

“Perfuma and Scorpia invaded my room and I have nowhere else to go. What are *you* doing here?”

“Couldn’t sleep.” Adora simply replied and an awkward silence fell upon them.

“Do you want me to go?” Catra asked cautiously. *Please say no*, she thought.

“I actually need to talk to you.” The princess slowly approached her and stood next to her, facing the dark sky.

“What’s up?”

“Are you and Glimmer an item?”

Well, that was certainly not was she was hoping for when Adora mentioned a talk. Why was she asking about *her* and *Glimmer* ?

“What?”

“Bow said he saw her in your room and your faces were really close, like, as if you were about to kiss.”

“What do you care?”

“I *care* because *Bow* is hurt. I don’t care about you like that.” Adora spatted out a little too quickly for Catra’s taste. Those words stung deeply, but she couldn’t show her hurt.

“We were talking about the rescue plan. She was that close because she was petting Swift Wind. Sparkles and I are *just* friends. I’m actually pretty sure she has a crush for Arrow Boy.”

“Great, so now all it’ll take for them to get together is to notice their obvious feelings for each other.”

“Yup.”

“How long do you think it’s gonna take?”

“At least thirty-six years. They’re completely oblivious.” That caused for Adora to chuckle and *damn* did Catra miss that melody. It sounded like a mithycal creature, so rare that nobody believed its existence by how perfect the description was. All Catra wanted was to hear it over and over again in an ever-ending loop.

“Sure are.”

They stared at each other with dorky smiles before Adora’s eyes turned cold again, ruining the moment.

“Why did you leave alone with Glimmer?”

“We couldn’t wait any longer. The moment was perfect, but all you wanted to do was to stay here and plan another attack.”

“It was dangerous and reckless. You put both of your lives at stake. You should’ve thought this through.”

“And I did. Everything went smoothly.”

“Then why do you have a busted lip and bruises on your wrist, huh?”

Catra hissed. Adora was right, but it was horribly hard to admit the truth, especially for someone as stubborn as her.

“What happened in that prison, Catra?”

“It was nothing! Glimmer was talking to Lonnie about the plan and I had to patrol.” Adora sent her a look that meant *go on*, and Catra sighed painfully before continuing the story.

“There was just this dumb guard, she must’ve not heard me when I said *no* to going into her room and then kissed me.”

Adora gripped the metal railing with such rage that her knuckles turned white. The thought of someone forcing Catra onto something like that made her blood boil. “She kissed you against your will?”

“Relax, you should’ve seen her face after I was done with her.”

“Did she do anything else? Are you okay?”

“I am fine. Just a bit… I don’t know, weird. It’s like -I feel dirty. I already took three showers but the feeling of her body on top of mine is still there.”

“As soon as we’re done with this, I’ll kill her. I promise.” Adora said. Her stare was cloudy and lost in pure madness. Catra knew she was getting angry, but didn’t understand why. She was fine after all.

“Adora, your friends didn’t mean any harm when they lied to you. They only did what I asked them to, which was meant to help you.” The brunette changed argument, hoping to find a more light-hearted one, but Adora only got even angrier on the inside. How was breaking her heart meant to help her?

“I-I am not mad at them anymore. I understand why they did it. I just need a little bit of time to process it all.”

Catra nodded and whispered a miserable *good* before leaving Adora alone again.

“Alright, now I want you to shift your weight through the stances.” Kamare explained to Adora, Mermista and Frosta as she taught them waterbending. Most masters were too old to teach the art properly and the result were poorly
trained waterbenders like Frosta and Mermista, whom trained with Razz herself. The other waterbenders left the tribes to fight in the war so there were no other options.

But now, the greatest master in waterbedning history was standing right before them, *of course* they wouldn’t waste the opportunity to learn properly the art.

“The shift?” Frosta asked, confused. Since all of them made very notable mistakes, the woman decided to begin from the very basis.

“Here’s the secret to bending: energy comes from the earth, through your roots and then to your branches.”

“My roots?”

“Use your legs, Adora.” Mermista answered, and all of them proceeded to imitate Kamare’s move. She called it “streaming the water.”

Catra observed the scene from the other part of the yard, above a rock. She was hidden by a tree so that the others wouldn’t notice her presence. Ever since Kamare’s return she didn’t know how to introduce her to the others as her mother. Nobody would believe her. Hell, she still couldn’t believe it *herself* .

She was the daughter of the Fire Lord *and* a legendary warrior. She was the mix between two opposite elements and still felt like an outcast in both cultures. With all of her years traveling she had never found a place that made her feel like she really belonged there.

The only thing that felt like home to her was Adora, but she hated her. To be honest, she couldn’t even blame her. She lied to her.

But that wasn't the time to get too sentimental, they were in the middle of war. Catra sighed and observed Kamare's movements before imitating them. The adult moved the water around her with ease. Catra emulated every single wrist, arm and leg movement with ease and then created a stream of blue fire as a replacement for water to better recreate the move.

In just a matter of seconds, her flames showed as much fluidity as water with the way they moved.

Catra was fully invested in the training until-

"Hey Wildcat! What are you doing here? Ops, didn't mean to scare you off- Why did you set the tree on fire?!"

Scorpia asked after making her lose focus and causing for the burning to happen. Catra was quick on her feet and began extinguishing the flames before she found herself covered in water.

"Catra? What are you doing here?" Kamare asked with a surprised and yet kind smile. The brunette returned the gesture with a blush and light chuckle that disappeared once Adora opened her mouth.

"Yeah, what are *you* doing here?" The two past lovers shared a glare, their competitive nature shining through.

"I… I was just looking at how much of a mess you are!"

"Pft. You're not even a waterbender."

"And yet I know the art better than you!"

"You don't!"

The two of them kept on bickering for what felt like hours. They raised their voices at each other and bumped their foreheads together.

Adora towered over her easily, but Catra was just as intimidating with her threatening voice and sharp fangs on full display. Somehow it got to the point where each of them raised their fists at each other, and right before they could land a hit, Kamare soaked them in water.

"You," she pointed at Adora. "Go back to practice. You,"

Her finger landed on the direction of her angry daughter. "Are going to have a talk with me, missy."

"What? No!"

"I didn't ask you. We are going to talk, *now*." Catra's tail swished left and right in protest, but her ears lowered down in submission. The two women left to a corner while the rest of the group stared at the scene in amazement.

"Why are they acting like *that* ?"

"Kamare raised Catra, but I've never seen her act so…"

Motherly .

"Okay, what were you thinking? She's Adora!" Kamare said in a scolding tone, causing for Catra to cross her arms over her chest and look down in stubbornness.

"I don't care if she's the Avatar, I can take her down *easily* !"

"That is not what I meant." She started off and rested her hands on the shiny royal armor. "She was your best friend. What happened to you two?"

"We were apart for a lot of time. We just have different visions…"

Kamare frowned, she knew that wasn't the whole truth. The woman looked at her daughter and then back at Adora repeatedly. The way they looked at each other showed love, even through the pain. But their arguments made them look like…

“You two were a couple! Of course, it was *so* obvious!” Catra limited her response to the reddening of her cheeks and nose. It was beyond embarrassing for someone to figure out their past that easily.

“We weren’t a couple! It was just a distraction. And I’d really like for you to not shout it. Not everyone knows about us.”

“Sure, I’m sorry. Wait, did she hurt you? You know I’ve got your back no matter what.”

“Yeah yeah, I know. It’s fine. It was more of a mutual thing.”

Well, that was certainly one way to put it. Catra wanted for them to stay together in the South Pole, but Adora said no. Then, she had to end things permanently to help her unlock the last chakra. She didn’t want to, however, there was *no other option* .

It wasn’t that hard to notice Adora was in love with her, and Catra couldn’t allow for such thing to happen. They both had roles to fulfill, there was no time to play make believe.

“Okay, well, if you ever need help with anything then don’t hesitate to come to me.”

“I know, thank you…” Was Catra allowed to say *that* word? She had always referred to the woman as Uzuni, then Kamare, and now-

“Mother?” A lot of time was bound to pass before the word would’ve naturally spilled out her lips without so much hesitation, but the smile on the adult’s face was enough to make the journey worth it.

“Okay, okay. It’s your turn.” Mermista pointed at Lonnie as the group sat on the ground in front of a warm campfire at night. They all decided to spend the evening together talking, something they had not done in forever.

“How did you meet Catra? You two seem pretty close.” The princess scoffed at the question, knowing that a very embarrassing moment was about to come.

“She stopped by Kyoshi Island about three years ago. That’s it.” Catra sighed in relief and thanked the spirits that Lonnie decided to keep it short and cohesive instead of talking about-

“Oh, that’s not *it* . Remember the multiple dates you went on? In fact, you guys were in one the moment Hordak arrived and took me with him.” Entrapta added casually with no hint of resentment, but Catra felt a bit guilty. It was precisely for the distraction of a date that she lost one of her dearest friends.

“You were a couple?!”

“Well, that explains why they’re sitting so close to each other.”

“Oh my gosh,

“Princess Catra, stealing hearts since birth.”

Catra and Lonnie shared a look before sitting further from one another with bright red blushes on their faces. It was beyond humiliating.

“We were not together; I am sitting next to her because she doesn’t have as much familiarity with you guys-”

“Oh, I really wonder why you two have *such* intimacy.” Seahawk suggested with a wink, earning a fire blast thrown at him that he barely dodged.

The group laughed, but Adora stayed silent, looking at the pair of two girls. Catra had never told her about Lonnie, or what their

relationship was exactly, and there she was, explaining it to everyone else.

In that moment the Avatar felt a disgusting emotion rising up. Adora felt like she was missing something that the others had, especially Lonnie, Scorpia and Glimmer.

Catra was finally opening up with other people, which was great, but Adora felt like a sudden outcast. Catra wasn't having personal and deep conversations with her anymore, she reached levels of closeness with other people that Adora wished to have back *only* for her. It was unfair, to have had such a beautiful relationship with someone and then saw them being happier without her because of a series of unfortunate events.

Adora was jealous.

Something in her mind snapped. She took one last bite of her apple before looking at the brunette right in the eyes.

"I wanna train with you tomorrow, *alone*. Meet me at the yard at nine." She said coldly and then left the group without even waiting for a response.

Catra paced back and forth repeatedly. She came earlier. There was something in Adora's eyes that made her feel nervous about the training session. She acted like a totally different version of herself, Catra barely recognized her with that predatory look of hers. All throughout the day she'd spied on the blonde, but she looked and sounded like her usual-self whilst training with first Kamare and then Spinnerella, so maybe things were going to be normal.

“Get ready. I have a lot of energy to *release* .” Adora ordered, startling the brunette.

When did she get here?

“Did you hear me? I don’t want to waste any time.” Catra frowned but nodded, assuming a defensive stance.

“Oh, you’re not going to attack?” The Avatar mocked with a smirk on her face. Catra felt shivers running down her spine as all of her hopes to meet the cheerful Adora vanished. “What’s the matter, too scared?”

The blonde did a reverse pivot with her right fist, making Catra flinch in anticipation, but the real hit came with the kick on the stomach that was not avoided by the counterpart.

“Seriously? I haven’t even used any type of bending yet. Oh well, guess I’m going to-”

Catra recovered instantly and returned the same hit on the exact spot. Like usual, Adora got *too* cocky *too* fast.

“What’s the matter, cat got your tongue?”

And so the battle began. Adora gave it her all into the strikes, but it was easy for Catra to avoid them and counterattack. With the more moves the brunette landed and avoided, the more frustrated Adora grew. Catra wondered what got into her in order to charge at her with such violence. Never in their past trainings had she ever been that aggressive.

If felt terrifying.

But also thrilling.

“Where’s all that confidence? I thought you wanted to train. This should be as well considered play time.”

Adora had enough. She used her element advantage to distract her opponent by sending a gust of air behind her neck. Catra turned around and the blonde used the opportunity to grab her by the arms and trap both wrist behind her back with the help of just one hand.

"Always ready to talk shit, but look at you now, you can't even move." Adora turned Catra's wrist ever so slightly to apply more pressure, making her whine in pain. Then, she pressed her against the nearest wall. Catra could have very well freed herself with ease, she knew that. One simple kick to the knee and the trick was done, but she wanted to see what that was leading to.

And also because she missed the closeness with Adora.

She was right behind her, her front pressed on her back. The hot breath on the neck made her relive old memories of them alone at night.

"I think it's safe to say that I've won, *Kitten* ." Adora whispered hoarsely, making a reference to Lonnie's nickname. If she could make Catra blush, then Adora was certain that the princess was going to scream with her.

When Adora didn't move and Catra could feel the smell of incertitude coming out of every pore of her skin, she finally picked up on it. "Why did you *really* bring me here, Adora?"

The Avatar took a couple of shaky breaths. It could've been so easy to just keep on with the duel, with the fighting, but she was too tired.

Instead, she gave up on her primal instincts and laid her lips on Catra's neck, leaving hot kisses.

Catra should've been surprised, after all they had spent months apart and fighting, but the touch was all too familiar to her. She tried to turn around, but Adora still kept her arms tied behind her back, making it impossible for her to make a move. Catra moaned when the kisses slowly started to turn into bites.

“You better not leave-”

“That’s not my problem.” Adora started to leave a trail of bites down her collarbone. She wanted everyone to know that Catra and her were special, something *more* . “For all I care you could be walking around with your neck fully exposed and I’d still wouldn’t give a single fuck.”

She pressed Catra harder against the wall and used her free hand to move her head to the side so that she could look into her eyes.

“Adora…”

“Be a good kitten and I’ll reward you. Do you want to be rewarded?”

Catra wasn’t supposed to be that turned on by a simple nickname, but the way Adora said it with such possessiveness made her feel dizzy. It was intoxicating, she needed more.

“Please.”

Adora seemed to contemplate for a second, then, she freed Catra from her grasp and headed towards her own room. “Follow me.” She instructed coldly, without even looking at her. The brunette obliged happily to the order, but Adora’s pace was simply *too slow*. Catra was impatient and needed release in that exact moment, she couldn’t wait another minute.

Adora calmly opened the door that led to her dorm and patiently waited for her to enter the room. Once they were both in, she locked it with that same slowness that was not appreciated.

Catra wasted no time and rested her hands on Adora’s lips, kissing the fabric that covered her back. The blonde roughly pushed her away and turned around to face her, the previous tranquility completely gone.

“No touching.”

Catra frowned, the whole point of this was *to* touch. “Why not?”

“Because I said so.”

“And who do you think you are?”

Adora raised an eyebrow, her tone irritated. “The Avatar? Who do you think *you* are?”

“I am your princess. You are my subordinate.”

“Oh, is that so?” She chuckled and got dangerously close to her lips. Catra closed her eyes in anticipation, but no kiss came.

“Frankly, I do not care. You will do as I say. I know you will. Trust me, I’ll reduce you to a whimpering mess. When I’ll be done with you every touch is going to be unbearable. I will break you, princess.”

Catra stared at her wide-eyed. Adora had a dominant side, but not as rough and confident as that one. Adora seemed amused by her reaction and sat on the twin bed, looking the nervous woman with hunger in her eyes.

“Strip for me.” She commanded. Catra freed herself of the heavy royal armor, but she knew Adora wanted more, and she was happy to oblige. She took off the brown vest and then all of her clothing on the upper part of her body, including the belt and cloth wraps. But it wasn’t enough for Adora. She didn’t say a word, she didn’t have to, but Catra expected to be undressed. Stripping with a public made her feel self-conscious. To be honest, she was supposed to make the moment hot and steamy, but the nerves of having some alone time with Adora after months forbid her from making the show entertaining.

“Are you just going to stare?”

“Are you gonna keep talking? I told to you take off your clothes.” They both glared at each other impatiently until the brunette finally gave up and undressed herself completely.

Adora smirked and got up, walking circles around her. “See? It wasn’t that hard.” She whispered and then finally trapped Catra in a steamy kiss that started directly with the tongue. Neither of them had enough patience to take things slowly, at least for their *own* pleasure.

Adora harshly guided Catra to the bed and laid on top of her as the kiss got more heated with each passing second. The Avatar’s hands travelled everywhere on Catra’s body, not checking in. She didn’t have to, the princess’ whines and suppressed moans were enough of an encouragement to move her kisses down to the jawline, then neck, collarbone… until they reached the chest area. Catra gasped when she felt Adora’s tongue wrapped around her left nipple as the right one was not left behind and got twiddled by the blonde’s free hand.

She bit her lip to contain her moans, earning a tutting sound from Adora.

“Why do you always have to make things so complicated?” She asked quietly, and for a mere fraction of second, Catra saw the kind and selfless Adora she missed so much. But it all vanished when she moved her thumb to her lower lip and then put it inside her mouth.

Out of instinct, Catra licked the flesh that pressed against her fangs and then began sucking.

“I want to hear you scream my name. I want everyone in this damn temple to know you were here tonight. They need to know that you are *mine* .”

Adora finally confessed with arrogance. She was jealous, she accepted it, and she needed to act up on it to make that selfish feeling go away.

“Are you mine, kitten?”

Catra released a weak moan before nodding, but that wasn’t enough yet. Adora pulled out her thumb and glared at the girl

laying beneath her.

“Say it. Say you’re mine Catra.”

“Adora-”

“I need you to say it.”

Catra tilted her head back to lay on the soft pillow and avoid Adora’s blue orbs piercing through her soul. “I’m yours.” She whispered.

The blonde wasn’t satisfied.

She grabbed her chin and moved her face so that she could stare at her in the eyes as she said it. “Again.”

“Fuck you.”

Adora actually laughed, like she had said something funny, but something in her gaze darkened. When the sound died down, she put on her indifference mask.

“To me it seems like you’re the one getting fucked.” She started off, her index finger traveling from the chest and then to the navel, only to continue moving south.

Then, her hand cupped Catra’s warmth, causing for her to whine in protest and buck her hips upwards, looking for the forbidden friction.

“You need to stop acting like you’re the one in charge when I get to have you like this… a mess. That’s what you are, a mess.” She said aggressively as one finger slipped inside her center with ease because of how wet she already was.

The intruding was welcomed with acclaimed join. Adora smiled at seeing Catra with her eyes closed, her chest rising and falling with the quick breath. It was breathtaking. She wished nothing more

but to make her suffer with every lingering touch and teasing kiss.

So, she got surprised when after curling her single finger upward, Catra shivered and shook uncontrollably and rocked her hips upwards erratically as her insides tightened around Adora repeatedly. The brunette closed her eyes shut and opened her mouth in a loud cry of joy.

Adora didn't move, waiting for the reaction to be over. Only when Catra stopped her chaotic movements did she pull out, earning a low whine.

"Did you seriously…? With *one* finger?!"

"You… you teased me!"

Adora smirked, getting another idea. She climbed on top of Catra, circling her clit with feather-like touches. "*This* is teasing."

She kissed her ear softly as she trembled. "We have barely started, Kitten."

Catra silently gasped at the use of the nickname and grabbed Adora's face, kissing her, but the blonde pulled away immediately.

"I said *no touching* . Only I am allowed to. Do you want me to use a fucking rope to tie you with?"

Catra quietly looked down and sighed, giving up. "I'm sorry. I'll be good. I-I promise."

"Say that you're mine. Look at me while you say it."

Blue and golden eyes met ocean orbs in an intense glare among the two of them. It was infuriating, and Catra enjoyed it.

"I am *yours* , Adora. Only you get to have me like this."

Adora expected something more, and Catra knew exactly what.

“I’m *only* yours.”

Chapter End Notes

Be sure to let me know your opinion of this chpter in the comments. Feedback is very much necessary to grow as a writer :D
PS. Don't get too excited just because these two slept together... things are not getting pretty for them yet.

I Want You Back

Chapter Notes

There will be some MINOR Catralonnie, don't you worry your little Catradora hearts.

See the end of the chapter for more notes



Catra panted tiredly on the mattress once they were done. Adora smirked above her, admiring the work of art she created, and then

laid down next to the leaner woman. Both of their skins were glistening with sweat because of all the activity.

Spirits only know how many hours those two spent in bed together, touching, kissing, devouring one another.

“That was good.” Catra whispered with a faint smile that was not reciprocated. Adora stood up and looked for her clothes on the floor.

“Yeah, you can leave now.” She said while handing her garments, without making eye-contact.

It had been like that for the past two weeks: they fucked, no aftercare whatsoever, and then Adora wanted Catra to leave.

“Can’t I just-”

“No. I don’t want anyone to walk into your room and not see you there.”

Catra reluctantly started getting dressed and squinted her eyes at Adora. “Who would go into my room?”

“Oh, I don’t know. You were alone with Glimmer a couple of weeks ago. Also, do I need to talk about Lonnie?” The blonde replied with venom in her words, but instead of giving Catra a clue about her jealousy, it only confused her even more.

“What about her?”

“You…” Adora sighed and gave up. “You seem to be pretty close, that’s all.”

No words were said after that. Catra put on her armor and wobbled to the door, her legs barely holding her weight.

“Lonnie’s a friend. We went on dates years ago. I’m just hanging out with her because she hasn’t integrated herself to the group yet.” She whispered before leaving Adora alone in the dark.

They were both hurting, but it seemed as if they couldn't get out of that limbo.

Adora had Catra back, somehow -physically, but she wanted more. She wanted late night talks and cuddles and promises, but she kept telling herself she couldn't trust her, no matter what.

Catra lied to her, and she still didn't know if making Adora fall in love with her was her plan all along of if her feelings were real.

The Avatar suffered in silence; her internal turmoil was tearing her apart little by little every time she saw Catra's face.

"…And that's how I defeated a Fire Nation army at the South Pole." Kamare told excitedly to Frosta as they were sitting on the yard.

Catra watched the scene from afar with a smile on her face. It was nice to see the both of them so happy. That woman was the best at story-telling. She'd always tell her about the Fire Lord's conquests and made them sound so epic that she even convinced Catra that her father was a good man for a short period of time.

"How is your bonding coming along?" Glimmer asked as she approached the feline. Catra got scared for a second, but then remembered that she actually knew about the matter.

"I don't know. It's weird. I've known her for all my life, and now… we have this awkward dynamic where we have no idea on how to act. Now she's allowed to be motherly but I've never been a daughter. I've always been *Catra, future Fire Lord* ."

Glimmer nodded in understanding. "Coming from one princess to another: I get it, but now you get to be the *real* Catra. Not only

are you a daughter, but you're also a friend and potentially even a soulmate."

"How's *your* bonding going?" Catra questioned, knowing they were practically on the same situation.

"He's trying his best, but he's still stuck with the idea that I'm still a toddler."

"Yeah, well, you can't really blame him. Whenever I visited his cell, he'd always talk about how you couldn't sleep without your personal collection of stuffed animals and designated blanket."

Glimmer blushed at playfully hit her shoulder. "In my defense, I was a kid."

"Don't play with me, Bow told me you still bring your favorite peluche everywhere you go."

"*Traitor*." She muttered under her breath. "But at least they're both doing their very best. The other day I heard the both of them exchanging parenting tips." She started off with a chuckle.

"I think your mom is giving you space. Perhaps she's waiting for you to make a move."

"Do you think I should make it?"

"That depends, do you want her in your life?" Catra actually thought about it. That woman was another innocent victim of the war that still had plenty of kindness to share with the world. Kamare was a selfless being that sacrificed herself for Catra in so many ways, it would've been stupid for her to refuse the offer.

So, she made her way over her and Frosta and sat next to the girl.

"You've got more stories to tell?" She asked, and she swore Kamare started finally living by the way her eyes lit up in enthusiasm.

The woman told another tale about her younger days and the training with Razz. Catra listened attentively
until Frosta yawned. The brunette glared at her for disrespecting her mother like that. But then noticed that it was already late at night.

"I'm going to sleep now. Goodnight." The teen said tiredly and waved at the pair before leaving.

Kamare waited until she was gone before frowning.

"What's up with you?"

"What's up with *me* ?"

"Yeah, you. You've been acting weird lately. One minute you're as relaxed as ever and then you're suddenly over the edge for the rest of the day. Are you okay?" She asked, squeezing Catra's shoulders with her hands in reassurance.

"I'm fine. It's just that I get..." *fucked by Adora countless times but she acts like she doesn't know me outside of her bedroom.*

"Distracted. And then I remember this stupid war."

"Hey, it's gonna be okay. Adora is training restlessly all day and night on her waterbending and airbending. She's made huge improvements so far." Kamare's words were supposed to comfort her, but Catra groaned, remembering that it was a real issue and not just a cover-up story for her lies.

"We can't rely on *just* her. There's a whole army that needs to get defeated and we don't have enough troupes. There are only a few of us against thousands of them. And Glimmer and I are not so sure on how to prepare—"

"You are both master strategists, I'm sure you'll figure it out. Now, how about you go to sleep? It's late." The princess slowly nodded and closed her fists in incertitude. Were they supposed to hug now, or was a bow enough?

What do mothers and daughters do? Think Catra, think!

She thought of the only available example of Glimmer and Queen Angella.

"Goodnight, mother." She said and gave her a quick hug before hurriedly walking away, afraid of rejection. What if it was too soon? What if Kamare didn't want to cross those boundaries? What if—

"Goodnight, sweetie! Sleep tight!" She heard from afar, but didn't turn around to look at the woman. She didn't want her to see what a mess she truly was.

"You can leave now." Adora said in that same cold tone that Catra was starting to now hate. The possessiveness and passive-aggressive behavior were a bit of a turn on at the beginning, but she was getting tired of being used only for sexual pleasure.

Pleasure that only *she* received, because Adora couldn't stand being touched.

"I'm tired." The brunette pleaded, and saw a glint of selflessness in her eyes that quickly vanished.

"You know I don't want people—"

"And yet you want me to scream your name and mark my neck to show everyone that I'm *yours* ." Catra spatted back, saying the last word with disgust.

"That's not… y'know… I don't have to explain anything to you."

“Yes, you do!” Catra finally exploded. “I don’t recognize you anymore! You want be to be yours, and yet you don’t wanna be *mine* ? I can’t touch you, or even talk to you unless you order me to. Then, you won’t even say hi outside of this fucking room and yet gladly talk to the others.”

Adora stared at the naked woman standing in front of her with reciprocated anger.

“I know I’ve lied to you. I’m trying my best to be forgiven, but I can’t help it feel like you’re taking advantage of the situation.”

“*I* am taking advantage of the situation?!”

“I am not a fucking toy you can play with until you get tired, Adora. You’re mad, I can see that in your eyes every time you look at me.” She said with sadness in her tone. It hurt deeply to admit it, but it was the truth: Adora hated her.

“But being this angry doesn’t give you the permission to play with my feelings for revenge.”

“I am not playing with your feelings!” At least that wasn’t Adora’s intention, but seeing how much she had hurt Catra, she regretted her actions.

“Then what are you doing to me? Why can’t I talk to you? Why can’t I touch you? Why can I let you do anything you want to me and get nothing in return?”

“Because you betrayed me, Catra! And yet… I seek your company.” Adora admitted shamefully, causing for Catra to take a step back.

“Then tell me how I can regain your trust so we can start all over again.”

“You don’t understand. I can’t believe a single word that comes out of your filthy mouth. If you don’t want to play by my rules then you can leave. I don’t care.”

Catra's response was going to condition their relationship permanently, they both knew it. The selfish part of her heart told her to stay, to take anything Adora would give her and not complain, but the brain suggested to leave immediately.

Catra didn't need a toxic connection with an angry woman she barely recognized, she needed a happy relationship with *Adora* .

Catra wanted to be happy, and if she had to suffer before getting there, then so be it.

The brunette left the room.

Catra sat alone in her dorm, bored out of her mind. Kamare was giving lessons to
Adora, Mermista and Frosta, Perfuma and Scorpia were probably together, Glimmer attended her first metalbending class with King Micah and Bow and Entrapta were talking about engineering stuff, Lonnie was likely wandering around the temple as always.

That left the princess by herself, and with Swift Wind. Melog was in the stable with the flying bisons, the monks said it was too big to stay in her room.

She sighed sadly as she thought about Adora. She wondered if it was all her fault for ruining their relationship like that, for causing so much hurt. Maybe Adora treated like her that because of all the pent-up anger caused by Catra's lies. Perhaps she should've gone to her and apologized, maybe-

No, it wasn't *only* her fault. She couldn't give up on her decision that easily. If things were going to stay like that, it was best for them to part ways.

Then, three knocks were heard and Catra opened the door. “I thought you were hanging out with Perfuma.” She said to her best friend.

Scorpia smiled. “Wanna show me what you’ve learned so far?”

The two of them stood at the very edge of the temple, one wrong step and they would’ve fallen to death.

“I see you’ve improved a lot, Wildcat.” The tall woman complimented with a big smile and sparkly eyes after Catra made a show off of herself by demonstrating her all the moves she had learned. “You’ve really put in the work.”

“I guess I did, but I still prefer using my weapons, though.”

“Why not both? You use your weapons as an extension of your body, and you do the same thing with your bending.”

Catra started thinking about it. It would’ve been amazing if she used her swords and lit them on fire at the same time, it could’ve even done double the damage. “That’s a pretty amazing idea.” She admitted, then, her smile fell.

“Hey, Scorpia, can I ask you a favor?”

“Sure, anything for you.”

“I want you to shoot a lightning at me.” Scorpia stared at her in shock at the insane request.

“Are you mad?”

“Maybe I am, but trust me, I know what I’m doing.” Well, not really. The first and only time she redirected the lightning she didn’t actually realize what she was doing, but managed to pull it off.

“I am not doing that! What if I hurt you? What if-”

“I’ll be fine. I am going to show you something. I may not know how to lightningbend, but I’ve learned something quite amazing. I need you to have faith in me; you will not hurt me.” Catra reassured, and took multiple steps back, ready for impact.

Scorpia, on the other hand, was still hesitant. “I don’t know, this doesn’t sound like a good idea...”

“It is! Don’t be a wuss and strike me big gal.” The tall woman sighed and started moving her arms in a circular motion, creating sparks.

Catra didn’t have enough time to prepare before the bolt hit her. Like on the day of Black Sun, she caught the flash of light with the fingertips of her hand. The electricity made her body produce immense amounts of adrenaline, causing for her to feel at the top of the world. She almost didn’t want to let go, but all the power she possessed in that moment was bound to disappear one way or another. So, she let the energy pass through the arm, then the stomach and to the other hand, providing exit for the attack Scorpia directed at her.

But this time, she could still stand on her feet instead of feeling like a weakling. “You... you didn’t use your full power.” Catra pointed out tiredly, but Scorpia didn’t listen to her.

“Holy cow! Did you just- How is that possible? I mean, is that how-”

“I told you to trust me.” Catra said with a chuckle. “I developed this new move. Since I still can’t produce lightning on my own, I can at least defend myself against it and possibly hurt the opponent.”

“You’re a mad genius!” Scorpia laughed in relief and picked the brunette up, spinning her around.

Catra sat as far as possible from Adora on the weekly campfire, leading her to be right next to Lonnie.

Glimmer had just demonstrated her new achievement in metalbending by molding a spoon into a bracelet that perfectly fit her wrist. Micah had taught her the technique, and frankly, with all the new sub bending elements in fire and earth, Catra wondered if there were any for water.

"Do you have any hidden skills to show us?" She asked her mother. Kamare's face turned dark with grim at the question, scaring the daughter.

"There is one, but it's very dark. I developed it in battle." She started off and everyone listened with care.

"I was surrounded by at least ten Fire Nation soldiers, I had no water, but I felt the full moon enriching me with its energy. There had to be something I could do to escape. In that moment, I realized that where there is life, there is water. Those people were nothing more than skins filled with liquid."

"You mean…"

"*Bloodbending*. Control the water in another body. Enforcing your own will over theirs." Everyone stared at her in pure horror. To reach someone inside and control them sounded like a nightmare come true.

"I didn't want that kind of power. I used it once, during the full moon, only to survive."

"That sounds…"

"Can you teach me?" Frosta asked enthusiastically. The Fire Nation tried to wipe them out, their entire culture. They had to fight them whenever they could, wherever they were with any means necessary.

“Sorry can’t do kiddo, not even if I wanted to. I managed to do it only once in very precarious circumstances.”

“Woah, your mother is a badass.” Lonnie whispered in Catra’s ear, easing the atmosphere.

The brunette chuckled and suddenly Adora’s eyes were on her in a matter of a second. The Avatar observed how close those two were sitting, how close their faces were. If Lonnie moved an inch closer, her mouth would’ve brushed against Catra’s cheek.

Adora missed Catra in more ways than one.

“You know, I was thinking… You and me, we could get some dinner together. Sort of a date situation.”

Catra felt her cheeks becoming hot at the suggestive tone she used. Although the proposal sounded great to take a moment of fun, she was still insecure. “Well, that’s really sweet, but I don’t think so. I don’t feel very date-worthy.”

“Are you kidding me? You’re the smartest, funniest, toughest, talentedest, incrediblest girl in the world.” Lonnie wrapped an arm around her shoulders and if looks could kill she would’ve been buried already. Adora felt her blood boil in jealousy. She wanted to know they were talking about and why Catra was *blushing* .

“You really feel that way about me?”

“I felt that way since the first moment I saw you. Trust me, I know we’re gonna have so much fun together. Like old times.”

Catra sighed and shook her head in denial multiple times, not believing her own reply. “You know what? I could use some fun. Okay, sure.”

Adora paced back and forth in her room. The overthinking was going to kill her sooner or later. She was still confused on whether she was still angry and distrustful of Catra or if everything was okay.

The only thing she knew was that she missed Catra in all of her aspects, not only the physical one. She wanted to talk with her, tell her secrets and stories, to take her on dates and see her eyes light up at every gift she'd give her. She needed to take things seriously with her and make it official. She didn't want to hurt Catra the way she did anymore. Making her suffer was the least of the things she wanted to do, but she got too blinded by her own negative feelings to even notice it.

Adora was going to settle things once and for all.

She finally took enough courage to go over her room, only to find Kamare there.

"Uh… hi?" She said questioningly.

"Hi, Adora. I guess you're looking for Catra, aren't you?"

She nodded. "Yeah, do you know where she is?"

"She's on her date with Lonnie." Adora's heart stopped beating in that very moment. So that was what they were whispering about at the campfire: a *date*.

"Oh dear, she was so nervous. She told me she hadn't gone in a date in so many years that she had no idea on what to do."

"Do you… do you know where she is?"

"Can't you wait until she comes back? I'm sure it won't take long." From the outsider's perspective with little to know information that Kamare had, Adora was a threat to her daughter's path to happiness.

"It's urgent. Please, I *need* to talk with her."

Kamare glared at her and then sighed. "They should be taking a walk in the main yard."

Adora thanked her before basically running towards destination at maximum speed. She couldn't lose Catra, not like that.

At the very worst, they both needed proper closure.

Once outside, she spotted the couple sitting by a bench in front of the big fountain. They were the only ones there; all the other monks were asleep by that time of night. The stars enlightened the blue sky and fireflies flew around the place. Everything was so magical, and Adora cursed herself for not planning something similar earlier.

Catra didn't wear her royal armor and her hair was not as wild as usual, giving her a more glammed-up appearance. Her eyes reflected the moon and Lonnie kept staring at them, almost as if she were hypnotized.

Adora couldn't blame her, they had the same effect on her too.

Seeing how they were laughing and enjoying themselves, the Avatar couldn't help but feel like an asshole if she ruined their moment. Instead, she hid behind a bush that gave her a perfect frontal view over them, waiting for the date to be over.

"I've had fun tonight."

"I didn't remember we could…"

"*Relax*? Yeah, me neither. It's been so long."

"We've both changed." Catra said with a sigh and Lonnie seemed to contemplate before turning her body around to face her. The warrior held the princess's hands in hers and drew lazy circles on them with her thumbs.

“For the better, though.” She replied, moving one of her hands to cup Catra’s cheek affectionately. The touch-starved catgirl leaned into the contact and closed her eyes.

“Remember how much we used to bicker over nonsense? You were so bossy and I had little to no patience…”

“Yeah. We were both so immature.”

“Catra, sometimes things change. But that doesn’t mean they get worse, sometimes…” Lonnie whispered with gentle tone as she leaned in. The hand that was once pressed against the cheek moved to the back of Catra’s neck, pulling her face closer. Their lips brushed against each other when she spoke again. “They can change for the better.”

Adora couldn’t look away from the scene. Her whole body and soul ached because of the heartbreak, but she kept on observing. Catra’s lips quivered like they did every time she was uncertain about something. Her frown expressed deep thought.

Just as they were about to kiss, Catra placed her palm over Lonnie’s chest, a silent request for space.

“I don’t think I want the change, Lonnie.”

The other girl leaned back, respecting Catra’s wishes. “What do you mean?” She asked with a calm tone.

“I can’t hurt you like this. I don’t wanna give you false hopes. I-I... I don’t think we should date. I want you as a friend.”

Lonnie’s smile fell, but she still maintained composure at the rejection. “I understand. Friends?” She held out her hand for Catra to shake, and the girl eagerly accepted the offer.

“Friends.” She confirmed.

Adora quickly ran back to Catra’s dorm, finding it empty this time.

They were going to talk.

“What are you doing here?” The princess asked in total outrage when she noticed her presence in the chamber. Adora opened her mouth to talk but Catra preceded her. “I thought it was already pretty clear that whatever we had is *done* !”

She lit her hands on fire and got dangerously close to the Avatar, anger taking over her. “You can’t treat me like a fucking-”

“I’m here to just talk. If that’s okay with you, of course.” Catra stared at her for a good minute before backing up and crossing her arms over her chest.

“There is nothing to talk about.”

Adora sighed and looked down. “I want to talk about *us*. I know you’re... open to meet other people.” She said, knowing that if she told the whole truth she’d get murdered right then and there.

“What’s that supposed to mean?”

Adora took three steps back, feeling the tension building up again. “You went on a date with Lonnie, I was just making an observation.”

“That is none of your business!”

“Catra, I want the both of us to have closure on this thing. We are both hurt, can’t we just clear things up? If after tonight you don’t want to have anything to do with me, then I’ll leave you alone, forever.”

Catra huffed in denial. She knew the conversation they were going to have wasn’t going to be a peaceful one. They were going to argue once again, that was for certain, but Adora was right: they needed closure.

“I give you five minutes to talk. Then, I want you out of here.”

“First of all, I wanted to say that I’m sorry for hurting you. I was so blinded by my anger that I didn’t notice I made you feel so neglected, so *used*.”

Catra sat on the mattress of her bed, she was already emotionally exhausted because of Lonnie, and now this? “If you are so angry at me, then why did you bring me to your room in the first place?”

“Just because I’m angry at you doesn’t mean I still don’t...”

Love you, love you, love you!

“Care about you. You mean so much to me, Catra, I wish I realized that sooner.”

“I know I told you to be selfish, but what you did was beyond egoistical. It didn’t matter what I felt, you were only interested in reclaiming me like a fucking property. All because of your envy.”

“Envy?”

“It’s not that hard to notice you were jealous.”

Adora felt embarrassed. Was it really *that* obvious? “You’re right, I am jealous. For so long I thought that all I needed to be finally happy was to have you in bed.” Adora struggled to get the words out, she didn’t know herself what she felt. “But I was so wrong, and that caused you pain. I now know that I don’t want you per se, but I want *us* ...”

“Adora, you’re not making any sense right now. You’re gonna make my head explode if you keep saying nonsense.”

“I want for us to talk again, spend time together. I want you to tell me your deepest and darkest secrets and I want to tell you mines. I want us to cuddle at night, under the stars, while I tell dumb jokes and you laugh. I want to experience life together with mutual support.”

Catra got back up on her feet and stood in front of Adora with a frown. “Then why are you acting like this?”

“Because I’m terrified, Catra!” Adora confessed, looking down in fear of rejection. “I’m scared that you’ll lie to me again. I don’t have any trust in you, I don’t know how to believe anything you’ll say to me.”

She expected to be yelled at or kicked out of the room. What she didn’t expect was for Catra to press her back against the wall and then to gently grab Adora’s arm, positioning it against the rocky surface.

If it weren’t for the height difference, their faces would’ve been extremely close, but Adora could basically rest her head above Catra’s.

“Wh- What are you doing?”

“You can tell if I’m lying this way. Focus on the vibrations of my heart.” Adora nodded and concentrated on the touch.

“It’s beating pretty fast.” She observed and Catra audibly gulped. How could anyone blame her? Adora’s tits were right in front of her in almost fully display if it weren’t for the clothes.

“I’m just a bit nervous. Give me a minute and then you can start asking questions.” She ordered as she closed her eyes to distract herself from the mundane view. “Okay, go ahead.”

“Were your feelings for me real?”

“Yes.” No alteration of the heartbeat, everything stayed steady, except for the color on Catra’s cheeks that quickly turned into a deep shade of red.

“Was it your plan all along to leave for the Fire Nation? After all you had a letter ready for the occasion.”

"I figured it was an option, yes, but I didn't plan on leaving you. You…" Catra took a deep breath before continuing. Expressing feelings made her feel vulnerable, in danger. "You were barely alive and the army was about to break in, there was no *other* choice."

"Did you purposely made me care for you so much to that it'd be more painful -and therefore, easier- for me to open the last chakra after you left?"

"No. All we ever had was genuine."

"Then why did you write in that note to lie to me?"

"Like I said: I figured it was an option. My plan didn't include making you like me so that I could rip your heart out in order to help you achieve the Avatar State. If I'm being honest, I didn't have a plan. What I felt for you, what we shared, it'll always be special to me. But if you had to sacrifice us in order to end the war, then so be it."

"Would you do it again?"

"*Yes*. I hate hurting you, but I did it for the greater good. I'm sorry."

Adora fought back tears. They both were ready to give up so much for the war, and it didn't feel right. It wasn't fair for them to suffer like that, not when they were so young. They were supposed to be happy teenagers living their lives, not warriors dedicating their existence to a war.

"Alright. One more question: why did you get so angry at the South Pole?" Adora asked hoarsely as she remembered the last night they were in tune with one another.

"One minute you asked me to stay with you and the other you slammed the door."

She felt Catra's heartbeat starting to fasten and her breath quicken for a good minute before the calm came back.

"I acted out on feelings. You rejected me and I got angry. I thought that maybe… I don't know… we could be *together*." The princess whispered the last word with caution, almost is it were a curse.

"I'm sorry for snapping at you like that on that night, and I'm sorry for lying to you." Catra almost chocked on her words. Sensing the nervousness and frustration, Adora wrapped her arms around her back and pulled her in for a tight hug.

"Do you trust me now?"

"This definitely is a step forward."

"That's good. That's good." Catra kept on repeating as she rubbed her cheek on Adora's collarbone repeatedly, subtly marking her.

Adora definitely picked up on the intentions, but let it be. She actually missed it.

"So what now?" The feline asked with a mumble. The Avatar moved one of her hands to pet her hair and then her ears, earning a low purr that Catra definitely tried to contain.

"I'd like for us to continue what we had going on in the past, but this time I want to take you out on dates, spoil you rotten, hold your hand and kiss you wherever we are. Does that sound good? If not, I'm perfectly fine with staying friends of course. I could never force you to be part of something you-"

"I like the sound of that." Catra said, the sound of her raspy voice muffled by Adora's shirt. The blonde sighed in relief at the sign of acceptance, and even dared to leave a soft peck on Catra's head.

"Did you have fun tonight?"

“If you’re worried about Lonnie, just say it.” Adora tensed up, but Catra only chuckled. “She tried to kiss me, but I just couldn’t do it. We agreed on staying friends.”

“Was I part of the reason why you rejected her?”

“Don’t get too cocky now.”

“I won’t.” Adora promised and pulled slightly back so that she could see Catra’s face. It had never looked happier in her opinion. The enormous smile travelled from one cheek to the other and her squinted eyes expressed nothing but fondness.

The blonde rested her hand on the woman’s waist and slowly leaned in until their foreheads we touching. She met her eyes, silently asking for permission, but Catra took the lead instead.

She cupped Adora’s face and trapped her lips in
a breathtaking kiss that sealed their newfound peace.

“The five minutes are *definitely* over. Do you want me to leave?”

“No, I just got you back.”

Chapter End Notes

I know this chapter was a little bit boring, but it was hella necessary for character development. Anyway, we are getting closer to the end! Be sure to let me know your thoughts about this chapter and the fic so far so I can get as much feedback as possible and improve myself :D

Talking to the Moon

Chapter Summary

Lots of Catradora in this chapter.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes



Catra was training in an isolated room of the temple. The monks recognized her power as too destructive and decided to give her a private area where she could exercise without causing any damage.

Those were the last twenty-four hours spent as guests. The next day they had to leave at dawn. The day of Prime's Comet was in about three weeks and they needed to be as prepared as possible and in order to do that, the group had to be in Fire Nation territory.

They were all going to stay in Catra's family house in Ember Island for the time being. No one set foot inside there for years so it was perfectly safe for them to stay.

Catra's breath was heavy and irregular after training for about three hours, but the amount of energy in her body was practically infinite. The new progress and acquired strength allowed for her to get more excited with each improved movement.

Then, the door opened, surprising her and causing for the feline to grab her dual swords out of reflex. The fur on her body and tail was all ruffled up as she growled as a warning, but calmed herself once she noticed it was her friend.

"Easy there, Wildcat. It's just me." Scorpia said and looked around the empty space. All the rock walls were heavily burnt and there were even cracks and deep holes scattered all around. The wood pavements were practically nonexistent as the concrete underneath was showing.

"Woah. Did a storm happen?" Catra smirked wickedly and shrugged as casual as possible.

"Who knows? I might've gone a little bit too hard on the training today."

The tall woman shook her head in denial and chuckled at the situation. "The monks aren't going to be happy..."

Catra, on the other hand, seemed nonchalant about the damage. With the way the council of elders treated her in the beginning, she figured they deserved a taste of their own medicine. "Which is *exactly* why we're leaving tomorrow morning. Anyway, why'd you come here?"

"Adora was asking for you. I figured you'd be here. Let's go."

Catra stood frozen in place, fear evident in her eyes at the announcement. "Why is she looking for me?" She asked, thinking of all the possible scenarios as to why she requested her presence. Did they need to have another talk about their relationship? Was Adora regretting her decision of forgiving her?

"I don't know, I didn't ask her. She's waiting for you in your room, so I guess it's a private matter?" Catra hesitantly followed Scorpia outside the room and into the long and narrow corridors of the temple.

"I have no idea what she wants to talk about, seriously. It could be a million things if we're being honest."

"Well, I don't understand why you're so worried. Aren't you two friends now?"

"I am not nervous. I have no idea what you're talking about." Catra replied with incertitude in her voice and puffy tail.

"I came here as soon as I could!" Catra announced once she entered her own room. Her voice was trembling and panic was obvious. She wondered why she was that nervous, usually that was Adora's role, not hers. "I was training and I was really sweaty. I didn't want to-"

Adora stood up from the bed and made her way towards her with a gentle smile before engulfing the brunette in a soft and delicate kiss. It took Catra a few seconds to register the event, but eventually she relaxed and gladly returned the action.

When the blonde pulled away, Catra had already managed to calm down.

“So... what’s up?” She asked, trying not to sound nervous. On the other part, Adora started to fondle with the princess’ red sleeves, showing signs of anxiety like irregular breathing and red face.

“I-I wanted to ask you out on a date. Is tonight okay?”

Catra stared at her with a deadpan face for one, two, three seconds, and then-

“Are you serious right now?” She pulled away from Adora’s touch and angrily opened the bedstand’s drawer.

“I’m sorry? I-I didn’t want you to get mad.”

Adora blurted out immediately with hurt. Maybe she was wrong to consider that they were at that relationship status already. Catra turned her head to look at her with disgust and then groaned before turning her attention back to the surprise she had for the blonde. Then, she turned her body to face her with her hands behind her back.

“I can’t believe you’d do this to me, Adora. Especially right when...” The brunette finally showed what she held, revealing a beautiful bouquet of colorful flowers. Catra had to spend the entire week in Perfuma’s company in the infinite gardens of the temple to select the plants she liked the most. “Especially when I planned to ask you out as well.”

Adora released a sigh of relief, all the tension finally leaving her body. Then, her cheeks flushed in a bright shade of red as she realized the meaning of Catra’s words.

“You did?”

“I was trying to plan this small thing...” She handed her partner the flowers with a shy motion and her heartbeat doubled when their fingers brushed against each other. When did Adora turn her

from a heartless warrior to a middle school teenager with a stupid crush? No, what she felt wasn't a crush, it was something more.

"We were supposed to *casually* find each other in the gardens and then I'd ask you out."

Adora was stunned at the declaration and felt warmth to her chest. Catra cared about her, Catra liked her, and not in a friends-with-benefits-way, but in a relationship-way! She looked down at the flowers and smelled them. The scent reminded her of vanilla and honey with a hint of... orange? It was definitely a particular choice, but Adora loved it nonetheless.

"Woah, I can't believe you like me! That is so embarrassing for you."

Catra immediately jumped in the defensive. "Don't you dare make a big deal ab-!" Her display of anger was interrupted when Adora lowered herself and left a lingering kiss on Catra's cheek that left a burning sensation and caused for her to blush even deeper.

They met at the entrance that led to the main garden. Catra still wore her usual attire, but put effort on straightening the hair and wearing a top knot. Adora, on the other hand, wore a dark red dress with a scarlet cape and shawl that she borrowed from Netossa and her hair (for once) was down, putting her gold locks in full display.

The two women stared at each other in an awkward silence. Neither of them were sure on what to do, or on what *not* to do.

“You asked me out on a date, you should know what the plans are.” Catra said with an eye-roll, causing for Adora to become more agitated than she already was.

“Well, you wanted to do it first, so I thought you already planned on it.”

Adora wasn’t wrong, but she wasn’t necessarily right. Still, Catra decided to give up on the argument. The last thing she wanted was for them to fight again. Plus, she needed to get Adora’s trust back again. After all, she had already made the first move, now it was her turn to take a step forward.

“How about a simple walk?”

“And then?”

“Dinner at my place.”

Adora scrunched her eyebrows and stared at Catra with an accusatory stare for what felt like hours to her. “I am not going to eat your-”

“I have some meat and if the monks catch us eating it we’ll be considered state enemies.” Catra replied immediately, her lips moving at full speed. “Since none of them come into my room I thought it’d be a great place to cook it, but if you don’t want to it’s totally fine! I know how much you hate eating vegetables and- and so I thought that maybe…. you know what? Let’s just do something else. How about…”

Adora looked at her wide-eyed. Never in their lives had Catra ever shown this nervous side of her. It was a completely new event to assist to -and also entertaining, usually the Avatar was the hot mess.

“Hey hey hey. Calm down.” She said with soothing voice as she put her hands on Catra’s shoulders. “Meat sounds great. Do you know how to cook it?”

"I know how to *not* burn it." Adora chuckled and left a quick peck on the other girl's forehead.

"You're lucky we've been eating nothing but vegetables for almost a month."

The walk went perfectly, well, almost perfectly. Adora tripped here and there because of her clumsiness, but Catra was always ready to catch her. Then, the Avatar sat on the grass and started making a flower crown, it was a trick Perfuma taught her. Catra didn't say a word, just stared as her fingers worked through the plants, not knowing was she was doing.

When Adora laid the flower crown on the princess' head, she didn't hesitate before asking her to do one.

Adora's crown couldn't quite compare to her work of art, but it was definitely a start. Plus, it was the thought that mattered.

When they reached Catra's room, the brunette immediately got to work by impaling the meat in a stick and using her bending to cook it.

Adora watched carefully as she noticed how controlled Catra was with the heat. That was really the first time seeing her as a fully realized master of the element. Yes, producing fire to attack in the way she did was near to impossible, even for the best masters, and yet, controlling it to get weak results was one of the hardest things for her to achieve. But now, with all the calmness of the universe and immense patience, she could do it.

When the meat was done cooking, Adora immediately took a bite of those juicy ribs and released a moan in delight. They were perfectly well-done, just as requested.

Catra chuckled at her dorkiness. Adora truly was special. She needed to be protected at all costs, no matter what the price might've been.

All she had to do was exist and Catra was already head over heels over her. She didn't care about her being the Avatar, no, Adora was the kindest, funniest, toughest, most beautiful woman in the entire universe. She was the one that made her go crazy with a simple look and lose all of her sanity with a gentle kiss.

She was the one she lov-

"This is amazing! Where'd you learn to cook like this?"

It took Catra a few seconds to get back from her trance, and even then, she was still nervous. "I uh… at the South Pole. I am pretty sure I became Razz's personal chef. I can't complain, though."

"Why not?"

"If my cooking skills get you to be this happy over a single piece of meat, then it's definitely worth it." The words spilled out of her mouth without even doing a double check in her mind. Everything she had just said was the pure truth, although she wished to have said it with more romantic words instead of a snarky remark.

But still, it was enough to get Adora's cheek flushing. She almost choked on her food, but played it off smoothly.

"I like your hair. I mean, the cut. Not that I don't like your hairstyle- I *really* like it! But the change you've made-"

"Th-thanks. Kamare cut it at Prime's request."

Adora immediately regretted saying that compliment. What was she thinking?! Catra cut it while she was in the Fire Nation, *of course* it was Prime who made her cut it!

Sensing her panic, the princess sent a reassuring smile. "It's fine, dummy. I'm glad you like it. It feels… lighter."

"So… you and Kamare seem close." Adora asked, trying to change subject in hopes on touching something lighter, but Catra felt her own heartbeat fasten. "We are." She admitted shortly.

“I didn’t remember her being so protective of you. I mean, she didn’t even want me to interrupt your date with Lonnie. Could you imagine if…?” Adora stopped on her words, noticing Catra’s fur raise up, her tail ruffled up and her ears completely up.
She got worried, what did she do wrong? And why was Catra so nervous all of the sudden?

“You okay?”

“Yeah, yeah… I just… yeah.”

Silence fell upon them, and it wasn’t a comfortable one. Adora waited for her to say something, anything, but the other girl looked highly conflicted, almost not wanting to talk. She had always been reserved with her emotions, that was what they forced her to do ever since she was a toddler, so Adora knew she had to push her a little further. “Catra, do you wanna say something?”

“I do, and it’s also kind of important… but I still have to fully process it before telling you. It’s not anything bad, I swear. I just…” The feline growled in frustration, expecting rejection, but Adora simply smiled at her and cupped her face with her hands so that blue and golden eyes could met ocean ones.

“It’s okay. We agreed on one step at a time, didn’t we?”

Catra closed her eyes and nuzzled into the kind touch, feeling guilt washing over her soul. “When I’ll be ready, you’re gonna be the first person I’ll tell. I promise.” She then proceeded to hold Adora’s hand and gently kissed every single knuckle, whispering *sorry* repeatedly. The date was going so well, and then she had to ruin it all with her stupid confusion.

“Hey, Catra?” The princess only hummed in response, still not opening her eyes. “Can I kiss you?”

Again, she kept her eyes closed, trying to conceal surprise, but she nodded in affirmation.

Their lips touched and the world stopped spinning. Both of their bodies were involved in a delicate dance that allowed them to show tenderness. Their fingers tangled together and their fronts touched, but didn't press. Everything was so gentle and tender. Kisses like that one were truly hard to find, but worked amazingly to make the couple lose sanity.

For once, Catra finally took charge of the action and licked Adora's lips with her tongue, and the blonde happily opened her mouth, allowing for her tongue to slide in.

The choreography became more heated, more passionate. The lovers' delicate touches turned intense and possessive, especially from the princess, whom led the Avatar to the bed.

But Adora felt weird about it, she was the one in charge. She needed to guide Catra, not the other way around. So, when she climbed over her, she grabbed her wrists, ready to flip them over, but Catra stopped her.

"You're always being so good to me, giving me everything I want. Let me return the favor." Catra asked with pleading eyes and Adora stayed quiet for a bit.

Leaving the power to someone else made her feel quite uneasy. She was the Avatar, she had to take care of people, and therefore take care of Catra. But she was exhausted of it, she needed a break. And besides, that would've counted as a step forward.

She let herself go.

That morning Catra woke up in an empty bed. It felt cold and lonely, no lying about that. Why did Adora leave her alone? And how did she not notice it? Her senses were hyper vigilant all the time, even when asleep, Adora must've really tired her out the night prior.

"Catra, it's time to go." She heard her mother's voice say from outside the door.

Shit.

They had to leave the temple today! The princess jumped out of bed before yelling a quick *I'm coming* and then got dressed as fast as possible. She looked in the mirror and saw how much of a mess she was. Her face and hair screamed "I've just had sex!" from every angle. She hurried up and washed up her features with care and tied the nest on her head in a tight top-knot.

Before exiting the room with the luggage prepared the previous night, she put on the armor the monks hated so much because of what it represented: war.

"I'm ready!" She beamed with excitement once she met Kamare outside of the now empty dorm. The older woman kindly smiled at her and guided her to the yard.

"You should see how Entrapta improved the airship! It flies faster, it doesn't have a tracker, it has more protection and even a couple of bedrooms for people who want to stay in." Catra only nodded in response, her mood dying out even more. Their little vacation was over, and that meant putting the war in the first place, before anything or anyone else. The thought of leaving Adora behind again made her feel anxious, but at that point she was good at maintaining a poker face.

Once reached the yard, she observed the goodbye hug shared between Micah and Glimmer. The King wanted to go back to Ba Sing Se to protect it, he suspected that the Fire Nation wouldn't

stop itself at the Air Nomads. No, they were aiming for a greater control over the world.

Glimmer cried and cried, but also smiled at the thought of her parents finally reuniting. The day of Prime's Comet was going to be the decisive end of the war.

"I guess I'll see you around?" Lonnie asked Catra after approaching her. The princess nodded and smiled at her friend. Lonnie decided to follow Micah on his journey since he was her king; she had to protect him.

"Of course. I'll invite you to my coronation."

"I'll go only if I get front row seats."

They both giggled and exchanged a firm handshake. "Deal." Catra promised, and right then she felt Adora's hands on her hips and chin on her left shoulder.

She stood frozen in surprise. They still hadn't told no one about their affair and there she was, acting like *that* in front of their friends. They didn't want to keep it a secret, of course, but also didn't talk about making it a public thing.

Lonnie stared at the scene with amusement in her eyes and looked at the Avatar right in the irises. "She's a catch." She said, referring to Catra.

She felt Adora release a quick kiss to the side of her neck before chuckling. "Sure is."

"Well, I'll leave you two alone now. I have to go. Netossa is waiting for us on the flying bison." The Kyoshi Warrior said, because she was leaving with King Micah to defend the capital. It was her duty to protect the land.

Catra felt like Adora's sudden display of attention was caused by jealousy, but after not sensing a single shift to get away from her when Lonnie left, she felt warmth in her chest. "Why'd you leave

tonight? I woke up all alone.” She asked in a whisper, trying not to sound hurt.

But Adora knew how uneasy she was, so, she lovingly kissed her cheek before replying. “I’m sorry, but I forgot to prepare my bag. I would’ve woken you up, but you looked so peaceful. I didn’t want to ruin that.”

Catra was grateful for not facing Adora, or else she would’ve seen how flushed her face was at that point. “Whatever. What’s up with you being touchy?”

“I just thought to myself: *hey, Catra -the most amazing person in the world- is standing right there. It’d be a shame to not greet her properly.* Lonnie got to you before I could, though, such a bummer.” She said dramatically, making the other girl laugh. “By the way, thank you for tonight, I really needed it.”

Catra fought back a smile, after all Kamare was still standing right next to them, discreetly watching the scene with side-eyes. “I’m glad you enjoyed it. How about we go on another date?” She whispered dumbly, not remembering that the adult had her same hearing abilities. Adora, on the other hand, didn’t seem to notice, or even care about it.

“I’d love that.” Adora whispered as well, and Catra’s attention was back to Glimmer and then shifted to Kamare.

The warrior observed the scene with sadness, and the brunette saw incertitude in her eyes. “Do you… are you thinking about going with King Micah, or to the South Pole?”

Kamare shot her a soft smile and then shook her head in denial. Catra released a sigh of relief, at that point she couldn’t imagine a life without Kamare in it.

“Now that I have you truly back, I’m not going to give you up again. I’m staying by your side.”

“Thank you, mother.” The words slipped out of her mouth unconsciously, and the prize to pay was everyone looking at them in shock. Well, almost everyone, Glimmer, Micah and Lonnie already knew.

Adora gasped as realization hit her. She literally talked about Catra making love to her in front of her *mother*! She immediately pulled back and remained at the respectable distance of five feet away from her while she started panicking mentally.

Catra probably didn’t tell her the whole story about their past. She knew she wouldn’t have said a single mean word about her, but mothers will be mothers. Kamare was protective of her, that was the reason why she didn’t want her to interrupt Catra’s date in the first place! What could the woman possibly think about her in that moment? Touching and kissing her daughter right in her sight.

She was totally sure Kamare hated her and definitely screwed up.

“Excuse me… but what?!” Frosta shouted excitedly and ran up to Catra.

“You’re her daughter?!”

The princess looked at her mother, who smiled encouragingly at her, and then back at the child. “Positive.”

“But you’re also daughter of the Fire Lord.” Perfuma beamed.

“Also positive.” Everyone stared at them for a silent minute, and then a bunch of *ew*s started to rise at the thought of the very unusual pairing of parents.

“I don’t wanna think about it! I don’t wanna think about it!” Scorpia repeated, holding her hands between her claws.

“Does this mean you can also bend water?” Seahawk asked. At that point Catra thought he was making fun of the situation, but no one ever knew what was the real deal when it came to him.

“I never would’ve guessed you two were related.” Mermista said, and then Entrapta joined the conversation.

“Actually, it makes a lot of sense. Same species, same shade of blue in the eyes, brown skin, brown hair… I mean, come on now, it was pretty obvious Catra’s has heritage from the Water Tribes and from Kamare.”

“You knew?” Adora shrieked out.

“Of course I knew! I’m surprised you didn't, especially since you’ve known her all your life.”

Catra should’ve been surprised, but it was Entrapta they were talking about. She was the smartest person in the world. No one could beat her.

Catra looked at the night sky from the roof of the large mansion. The travel didn’t last long, especially considering that the temple was relatively close to Ember Island. She got the main bedroom, the place where her father slept. She replaced all the sheets, pillows and comforter with new ones and burned the used ones until there was nothing left of them but ashes.

“I figured I’d find you here.” Adora’s familiar voice said, startling Catra.

“What are you doing? It’s late.” She asked, and the Avatar sat next to her on the edge. She was supposed to be asleep in Bow’s and Glimmer’s room at one of their sleepovers, not awake on top of the roof.

“I could ask you the same thing.” Adora playfully shoved her shoulder and Catra wanted to make a joke about it, but she rested her head on the blonde’s shoulder.

“Sometimes I like to stare at the moon. I don’t know why I’ve always been nocturnal, I just am. Firebenders rise with the sun, but sometimes I feel like I rise with the moon.” Adora stayed quiet, listening to her patiently and rubbing lazy circles on her back. “My bending isn’t altered at night. I’ve never tried using it during an eclipse because I’ve always thought it was stupid to even think about it, but I’ve never felt a lack of power when the sun isn’t around.”

“Who knows, maybe it could be because of
your waterbending genes?” Catra chuckled at the thought. It was simply ridiculous. Such things could only happen with the Avatar.

“You’re a dummy.” She said lazily as she rubbed her cheek against Adora’s jawline so that their scents could finally match instead of having her smell like Glimmer and Bow.

“I’m serious, it can happen sometimes. I once travelled to a Fire Nation colony in the Earth Kingdom and one girl could lavabend.”

“So what now? You want to study hybrids to understand sub-elements?”

“I think I’ll leave that to Entrapta.”

Catra dramatically clutched onto Adora’s shirt and nuzzled in the crook of her neck, straddling her. “Please don’t.
She’s gonna torture me.”

The Avatar laughed and kissed her forehead, earning a blush on the top of Catra’s nose. “Don’t worry, I’ll keep this our little secret.”

The princess’s smile fell as she kissed her cheek. “By the way, I wanted to tell you first about Kamare, but it just slipped out in front of everyone.”

“I know you did. It’s okay, there was no malice behind it.” Adora reassured and Catra swore her heart exploded because of the strong emotion she felt in that moment. She could’ve kissed her nonstop right then and there, and she was about to, if it only weren’t for the other girl opening her mouth again.

“How does it feel to be the child of a legendary warrior?”

“Pretty awesome actually. Now, why are you here?” Adora’s face darkened and Catra saw the glim in her eyes disappear as she looked at the satellite in the sky.

“Today’s the full moon.” She simply said, and the feline understood the meaning: Yue.

Catra slowly climbed off her lap and sat back next to her, wrapping an arm around her shoulder in support.

They didn’t say another word, they didn’t have to.

The war was close to an end, and they were going to get justice for all the victims.

Chapter End Notes

Okay, I wanted to write a drama-free chapter because our babies deserve some calm and peace every once in a while, sue me.
Ps. The end is nearrrrrr

Welcome to the Family

Chapter Summary

Drama, angst, love declarations, war AND even more content ahead for this LAST chapter of the saga.

Chapter Notes

Here we are, at the end. Thank you so much for walking through this journey with me. I'd like to say that I do half of the job and you (yes, YOU) do the other half by commenting, leaving kudos, or only reading.
Your support really means a lot to me, and I hope this chapter will be worth the wait.
Have fun!

See the end of the chapter for more notes



Catra was mesmerized by the beautiful scene happening in front of her. Adora was whimpering, moaning, gasping and other indecent sounds came out of her mouth with no restrictions. Her blunt nails sank into her back and travelled south, but Catra felt

pleasure at that -at the soft pain. Her fingers slipped in and out of her lover's warmth in a fast, decisive and *precise* way, always hitting the perfect spot.

Adora opened her watery eyes and surged forward to kiss her with no restraints, her tongue immediately welcomed in the happy mouth. Catra chuckled mid-kiss and moved her lips to her neck while the other hand started playing with the left breast, leaving ghost-touches and tracing all the marks that her fangs left on her skin, claiming.

"Your voice is hoarse with desire, princess." She whispered coyly, and received a soft gasp in return. If there was one thing that turned Adora on, that was praise. "This is what you've been waiting for all along: me fucking you, treating you the way you deserve. Like a queen, because that's what you are."

Catra stopped her sloppy actions to move her mouth on Adora's forehead, kissing it gently. Adora was close, it was clear –the way she quivered and writhed under her was an obvious clue. She didn't stop or slow down, she knew that if she did, then she'd get punished for it with a sweet torture, but that night was supposed to be all about Adora. She wanted to spoil her, make her happy, give her one last good memory of her before the final battle.

"Good girl. You can come, I've got you." Those words, those four last words were the ones that made Adora reach her peak. Her back arched forward into the touch and her eyes shot wide open.

Catra observed as they released a white and blinding light. Immediately worried, she wrapped both arms around Adora, holding her tightly and caressing her blonde and silky hair. After a few short seconds, Adora reciprocated the embrace with tiredness.

"A-Are you.... are you okay?" She asked with worry, but Adora calmly nodded and kissed her cheek.

“Amazing. Thank you.” Catra sighed in relief, but still didn’t let go of the matter.

“You sure? I mean you-”

Adora chuckled and started petting her ears, earning a low purr in response. “Wow... cocky, aren’t we? Okay, you made me come. Big deal. I’m still alive after your heavenly work on me.”

The princess gave up. Maybe she just saw something that didn’t happen and her eyes played tricks on her. She quickly forgot the event and rubbed her cheek under Adora’s jaw affectionately.

“Are you marking me?”

“I don’t know what you’re talking about.” Catra replied with a grumble and a deep blush that she kept secret by hiding in the crook of her neck.

“Is this like... your version of leaving hickeys?”

“Shut up, you’re embarrassing me.”

That sentence resulted in a genuine laugh coming from Adora. “It’s cool, I won’t tell anyone. Wouldn’t want to ruin your reputation.”

“I hate you.”

“And that’s when I’ll boost us up and reach the first airship. Although, there may be too many of us to reach...” Glimmer explained as they all sat on the floor of the living room. She was assigned with the task of taking the airships down, along with Mermista, Frosta, Bow, Perfuma, Seahawk

and Kamare. Scorpia and Entrapta were not going to participate in the fight, it would've been too risky.

"I can propel some of us with water, but I'll need the help of Mermista to make it powerful enough to take four people. You'll go with Bow and Frosta." The adult warrior proposed and everyone agreed.

"And I can just use my fire bending to get up there. It'll be easy." Catra said, and suddenly everyone looked at her with... sympathy? She didn't have a good feeling about the situation.

"You're not gonna fight. You'll stay here with Entrapta and Scorpia." Adora instructed solemnly and Catra understood that she wasn't talking to her as her friend, but as the Avatar.

"What do you mean?" She asked with closed fists, trying to stay calm. "I have to fight. It's the fatherlord we're talking about."

"Exactly. After tomorrow, you'll have to return to the Fire Nation so that when the *Fire* Lord falls, you can assume the throne and restore peace and order." Adora argued back with the same monotone voice, but everyone could see how nervous she looked.

"I want to-"

"If you joined then it'd be the wrong way to end the war." Kamare jumped in, resting her hands on Catra's shoulder in sign of comfort. "History would see it as more senseless violence a daughter killing her father to grab power. The only way for this war to end peacefully is for the Avatar to defeat the Fire Lord."

"This is stupid. I don't even know if I want to take the power for myself. I don't wanna be a new *him* ."

"You won't. You are an idealist with a pure heart and unquestionable honor."

Catra got fed up. She slapped the hands away and cried out loud: “I have made so many mistakes!”

“Yes, you have. You struggled, you suffered.” Bow commented with one of his gentle smiles. “But have always followed your own path. You’ve restored your own honor, and only you can restore the honor of the Fire Nation.”

Catra would not buy the bullshit. She couldn’t let Adora fight alone.

“I honestly agree with Catra.” Mermista added. “She’s strong and could be a powerful asset to us. We have to be honest here. Adora has fully mastered two out the four elements and without the Avatar State it’s gonna be very hard for her to win without any help.”

“Ouch.”

“Okay, maybe that was too direct.”

“That’s rough, buddy.”

“We should keep her as backup, just in case none of us can’t make it in time. It’d be dumb to leave her behind.” Everyone looked at Adora for an answer, but she only stared at Catra. The two of them had a silent conversation. The future Fire Lord pleaded her while the Avatar kept on debating for what seemed like hours.

“You’ll be the last resort. You are allowed to join in if I’m knocked out and no one else is there to help.”

Catra wanted to start dancing in the middle of the room by how happy she felt, but she restricted her actions to a simple nod. Adora sighed and walked away to their room, looking defeated already.

“You should probably talk to her; she needs someone close to keep her company and open up right now.” Perfuma suggested,

and Kamare's ears perked up.

"Close? What do you mean, *close*?"

"Why can't Glimmer or Bow go? She looked really mad at me."

"You know why."

"No, I don't know why she should. Would you care to elaborate?" Entrapta, already fed up with the boring conversation, opened her mouth.

"You daughter and Adora have established a special emotional and physical bond. Haven't you noticed? I mean, they spend the night in the same room after all." Entrapta informed,
and Catra's face turned a deep shade of red. Her mother looked at her in confusion until realization hit her.

"Oh my-"

"I am going to talk with Adora!" She finally announced and immediately stormed off. She was not going to talk about her confused love life with her own mother and the rest of her friends being present. *Nope*!

When she was in front of the door, she knocked three times before hearing a frustrated *come in*. When she got inside, she was met with the blonde sitting on the edge of their shared bed. Catra wanted to join her, but the angry energy her lover irradiated made her stop at the doorframe.

"Hey there, 'bud."

"Why did you want to join so bad? You could've just come back to the Fire Nation. Why fight? I am the Avatar; you can leave this to me."

"So that's what's all this is about, your savior complex?"

“It’s about you potentially dying.” Adora snapped back and then looked back at the ground. Cautiously, the brunette sat next to her at a safe distance.

“I want to be there because I have to protect the only thing that I can’t live without. That’s you, Adora.” She confessed shyly, slowly wrapping an arm around her. When she was met with no sign of resistance, she got closer to her counterpart. “I know you’re stubborn, but you have to understand that it’s very unlikely that you’ll make it out alone without the Avatar State.”

“If I could just... If I could figure out what’s wrong then I’d be able to fix it. I just want you to be safe.”

Then, an idea popped in Catra’s head. She asked Adora to lie down on the bed and positioned her hands a few inches from her torso. “Maybe I can help you with it. Do you trust me?”

“You already know the answer to that.” *Ouch*. Okay, that stung a little, but at least she was honest with it.

“Well, you have no other choice. I need you to stay still.”

“And what are you going to do in the meanwhile?”

“I’ll be using fire to detect what’s wrong with you. You will only feel just a bit of warmth, nothing bad will happen to you if you stay still.” Adora sighed, but nodded before resting her head on the soft pillow. Catra got to action and produced faint red flames, moving her hands around to feel Adora’s heat. In her research, she felt a cold area at the very base of her neck, where Scorpia hit her with her lightning.

“Are you done yet? It’s getting hot in here...” Adora asked after minutes of her investigation, and Catra pulled away with a frown.

“I’ll take that as bad news...”

“Your chi path is blocked. Only another trauma will open it and allow you to enter the Avatar State.”

“That is great news! Hit me!”

Catra knocked on Adora’s head after hearing the absurd request to make sure there was something in there instead of a huge gap of air where the brain was supposed to be. “Are you crazy? I could actually kill you.”

“We have to take the risk!”

Catra’s gaze softened as she moved her hand under the blonde’s chin. “Adora, did you forget what I said earlier? Do you really think that I’m capable of purposely hurting you?”

“You put the war before me once, why not again?”

Catra scoffed and pulled away. Emotional pain is totally different from death!

“Because this is stupid even from a logical point of view. If you die, there’s no one that can defeat the Fire Lord. We’re not taking any chances.”

Adora opened her mouth to counterattack, but got stopped.

“End of story.”

The group stood in the Wulong Forest, the airships kept on getting closer with each passing second. Tensions were high as the final battle was finally coming.

Catra and Adora stood together on a stone pillar, their earlier fight long forgotten. Catra could feel the power of the comet through her blood. She felt immensely stronger compared to any other

day. Thanks to her acute view she could see her father completely shirtless and knew it was time to back up. She turned around to hide, but Adora grabbed her wrist.

“Catra, wait! I want to tell you something…”

“Now?!”

“Yes, now.” Adora sighed, and then continued. “I don’t know if I’ll make it out alive. But if I don’t, I want you to know that-”

“I love you, Adora.” Catra confessed, looking at her right in the eyes. She wasn’t afraid, not anymore. Adora was right, maybe she was not going to make it out alive. All possibilities were open at that point. It was hard to accept, but it was the truth.

Adora’s cheeks turned crimson red as she released an audible gasp. Her brain stopped working right then and there. “Would you like to be my girlfriend after all of this is over?”

The proposal was blurted out rather quickly and in an awkward way, but it was in pure Adora’s style.

“An by the way, a girlfriend is when-”

“Yes!” Catra said excitedly, but then looked above them and knew they had to hurry things up. “I mean… yes. I’d love to be your girlfriend. I have to go now.”

She quickly kissed her cheek and hid behind another stone pillar, making sure she couldn’t be spotted in any way.

Did she seriously reveal her feelings for Adora? And they were going to be girlfriends?!

As soon as Adora spotted the Fire Lord, she got over her in-love mindset immediately, she had a war to end.

She saw him starting a fire that ignited the earth and knew that it was her moment.

The Avatar closed her eyes and breathed deeply,
then performed several spinning kicks, using earthbending to send giant sections of the stone pillar beneath him toward Prime's ship and jumped to another pillar. The chunks of rock whistled past the side of the enemy's airship, which caught his notice.

The last few pieces of rock struck the airship's engine, causing him to lose balance and stop his attack. Smoke drifted from the engine, signaling its lost power and began to descend. Prime looked down to see her and Adora spun her body around, gathering her energy, and unleashed a huge fire blast at his ship, striking the final blow to its engine, thereby destroying it.

He jumped off of the platform he was standing on, using his firebending to fly like a rocket and landed in front of the Avatar.

"After so many years of running away from me, the universe delivers you to me as an act of providence."

"I'll give you one last chance. We don't have to fight! You have the power to end it here and stop what you're doing."

He smirked wickedly and Adora felt terrified at his look. "You are right, I do have the power. I have all the power in the world!"

Prime jumped, spun in the air, and slammed his fist downward, creating a circular wave of flames that spread directly towards Adora, whom jumped over the attack and slammed her hands and feet into the stone pillar right below her. She earthbended the piece of the pillar she was holding into the air, then rotated it around and kicked the chunk of rock toward Prime. He leaped away using his firebending. In mid-air, he propelled himself at her using a jet of fire from his feet. At the same time, the Avatar jumped toward Prime, sending a wave of fire at him. He kicked

forward and shot a fire blast from his foot. The two attacks collided in a fiery explosion.

Catra looked at the scene in pure disbelief.

"Woah…" She muttered under her breath. Never in her life had Adora been that serious during a fight. And the landscape... beautiful on its chaotic way. The battle happening amongst them was decorated with airships colliding in the background, meaning that the small group was managing to do their job just fine.

Adora and Ozai were evenly matched. Though she was able to counter the Fire Lord's powerful bending, she was unable to land any significant attacks herself, even with the element advantage. They jumped from one pillar to another, and Catra noticed a change in Adora's fighting style.

She got scared and started chickening out, basically running away from the grown man and using defensive techniques instead of offensive ones. If things continued that way, then she would've gotten tired soon. The enemy seemed to be fed up with her behavior and more frustrated with each missed hit, so he resorted to a relentless barrage of lightning generation.

The Avatar avoided them, but he didn't stop. Catra knew she had to intervene quickly, so, when Adora found herself cornered among the rocks and the villain shot another bolt that she couldn't have possibly avoided, she jumped in the middle, redirecting it.

Everything happened so fast, and yet, when she caught it streak of light in her body mid-air, she felt the world moving in slow motion. She was used to redirecting because of all the training she did with Scorpia, but catching it in movement caused for her to perform it in the wrong way. She felt a burning pain in stomach that travelled right through her heart. Nevertheless, she had enough focus to point her fingers at her own father, ready to kill him without any form of resentment.

But then, she remembered her mother's words. A daughter murdering her own flesh and blood for power would've caused more harm than good. So, she changed direction at the last second, aiming for the sky instead. Even if she would've died, the fear in Prime's eyes was enough to make it all worth it.

She felt on the rocky ground with a loud thud, but she immediately stood back up, ready to continue fighting.

"Catra... why am I not surprised to see you?" The Fire Lord asked, highly irritated for interrupting his fight.

"Are you okay?!" Adora questioned instead, and although she was in pure pain, she could only think about not looking as a weakling in front of the man who raised her.

"I am fine." She said coldly, and then set both her hands on blue fire with a threatening smirk.

"You know, I'd be interested in fighting you. I'll admit it, you're strong, but not at my level, child." He smiled and took a step forward, causing for Adora to push Catra behind her, acting as a shield.

"How about this? If you want to fight so badly, then you should..." He snapped his finger, and Hordak appeared from his hiding place behind a pillar, walking slowly towards them. Catra noticed multiple burning on his face and many scars scattered across the body.

"Have a rematch with my little brother. I've trained him personally for this day."

"How did you-"

"Dear, it wasn't that hard to put two and two together. You said you were going to join *your* Adora. I knew you'd be here, trying to distract me from my true goal: defeating the Avatar once and for all. And once I'll..."

As he kept on rambling, Catra paid attention to the way Hordak moved. He tried to be subtle about, but his closed fists that were slowly raising were a clear sign of what was about to happen.

"No!" She yelled, positioning herself in front of Adora to protect her from the powerful fire blast that sent them flying against the rocky wall.
Little did they know, that the base of Adora's neck got hit by a protruding piece of rock that was perfectly aligned to the scar on her neck. Upon collision, her thought chakra got unblocked, and Adora received a vision of her Avatar predecessors, all in the Avatar State, lining up beside her. On the outside, though, she looked as calm as ever and her eyes glowed in a bright shade of white.

The beast got unleashed.

As the Fire Lord approached the pile of rocks in which they were both submerged in, Adora emerged from the rubble and immediately sent him flying backward with a powerful air blast to the chest, making their fight finally start.

In the meanwhile, as Catra got rid of the dust, she admired the scene with a smile on her face.

Adora did it! She awakened the Avatar State at last!

However, she couldn't get too distracted, after all the enemy was standing right before her.

Hordak assumed a fighting stance and smirked. "I'm sorry it has to end this way, niece." He said with a false sympathy that got reciprocated.

"No, you're not."

"You know, I won't be easy to take down this time. I am stronger than ever before and you're already weakened." He

claimed calmly, referring to the failed lightning redirection that injured her.

"I don't know what you're talking about, old man. The only reason why I won't kill you is because I want to see you rot in the same prison you locked my friends in."

Not a single words was spoken after that. They walked in circles, waiting for the other one to start the attack,
and Hordak's impatience forced him to spin and he sent a sudden blast of fire toward Catra. The fighter brought her hands up and jumped forward, bringing her arms down in front of her. She bent a flame in each hand and they emerged, sending the fire toward Hordak.

Their flames collided, forming a wall of fire, blue battling with red. As the structure began to die, the general leapt up on a jet of fire and kicked his legs forward, sending a wave of fire
from his feet during each of the three spinning kicks performed.

The move did not surprise Catra in the slightest, she easily predicted the typical Fire Bending fighting style; always aggressive and direct. However, his technique was what caught her off guard. He turned out to be much more precise and his movements weren't as sloppy anymore.

But Catra couldn't allow herself to retreat. So, she kept
on shooting fire while being pushed back by the red flames colliding with hers once again. Her power was stronger and managed to push her uncle back as he turned his foot around in order to steady himself again.

Understanding that the attack was not going to end in no-one's favor, they stopped. The now scared and
confused Hordak leapt forward with a blast of fire that he swung at Catra. Just as she was about to be
hit, she thrusted her palms outward to create a wall of fire that sliced the flames.

Just as predicted, Hordak let the aggression take over him, forcing him to use too much energy. He kept on panting heavily as he gritted his teeth and narrowed his eyes in determination.

She wouldn’t admit it, but she felt extremely worn out from Prime’s lightning. She was pretty sure that her lower abdomen got severely burned. She only wished for the battle to be over, but she had to fight for it.

Hordak opened his left fist, and with the other hand punched two large fireballs toward his niece, and the fire emerged to create one massive blast. Catra’s fear-filled eyes reflected with orange from the oncoming attack, but she dodged using a fire propulsion. She flew forward into the air with the jets of fire coming from her feet and hands. Then, she thrusted her fists forward creating two blasts.

Hordak crouched with his arms outward, blue and orange flames swirling around him. Catra was flying toward him as she swerved to the right to dodge the last blast and then she shot fire at him to circle him, a trail of flames coming from her feet. Hordak quickly defended himself by creating a shield of fire for protection. He even tried to attack her, but she was too fast with her circling movements.

So, he stopped firing at her, crouched, and began spinning and kicking immense and powerful flames from his feet. Catra was flying forward and when she saw his intentions, she tried to stop, but it was too late.

The princess fell and rolled forward onto the ground, whining in pain at the wound on her chest that was slowly taking the life out of her body.

It would’ve been so easy to give up and let Adora avenge her. She hoped for her eyes to close and her suffering to be over after years of pain and sadness, but she couldn’t do it.

She had just rediscovered the joy of life, her friends were finally safe and she made some new ones, her mother was alive and Adora was going to be her girlfriend. That day was going to mark the beginning of her new life, and Catra didn't intend to give up, not yet.

She rolled on her back and slowly started getting up. Her elbows supported her upper body until a foot stepped on her midriff, pressing and twisting the stinging wound.

The girl yelled in pain as her hands flew to his calf in a desperate attempt to push him off of her, but Hordak only persisted and continued his torture with more euphoria and a sadistic smile on his face.

"You've always been nothing but a nuisance! You're just a spoiled brat who thinks everything will be given to you!"

He sank the heel with further strength, forcing Catra to cough blood out of her mouth. She could barely breathe and the drenching sounds coming out of her mouth highly damaged her vocal chords. She desperately called for help, but nothing seemed to get her noticed.

"But you're all alone now. Your Adora won't come to save you and you'll die in loneliness like the worthless creature you are!"

Catra felt like floating away, watching the whole thing happening to her. The scene became more and more distant…

Until she woke up again.

She couldn't give up, not yet. There was one last hope for her and she hoped it wouldn't kill her.

There was only a move that she never got to perform correctly, and it all happened because she only focused on the physical process of it and not the spiritual one.

But in that moment, getting beaten up to death, she felt at peace. A peace that she never got to experience until then.

So, she focused on the energies inside of her with all of her concentration. She weakly moved both her arms forward and noticed sparks coming out of her fingertips before finishing the technique. One last mental effort and fully extend arms later, a lightning came out.

Hordak noticed too late the attack coming at him, and when he did notice, he was already a lifeless body scattered several feet away.

Catra weakly smiled looked at the red sky. One airship after another was falling or colliding. Hopefully the others were safe.

She finally closed her eyes in satisfaction, losing all senses.

Adora was winning.

The power flowing through her veins made it all easier.

But Prime still persisted on trying to fight a lost battle. He flew away from her charged attacks by using jets and tried to land any sort of damage with whatever was at his capabilities.

But the Avatar effortlessly dodged every single one of his failed attempts.

She travelled by using bending all four elements simultaneously around her, creating a sphere. It turned out to be a very useful technique, she could use it to main repeated and destructive attacks while it also shielded her from other dangers.

While the Fire Lord tried to escape, she chased after him and bended small fragments of rocks that were floating around her, turning them into bullets.

He barely avoided them because of the pillars protecting him. However, she used his own protection against him by bending two of the structures so that they could crush his body.

He avoided again.

Adora got fed up.

She moved her left arm forward with a circular motion, causing for the water she bended to wrap around his leg and turned it to ice before slamming him back to the ground with pure brutal force.

In the moment of the impact a loud sound of cracking could be heard, and his breath stopped.

Adora landed on earth, turning the defense mechanism off at will. She approached the body and was so close to check for his pulse until she felt someone wrap their arms around her.

"You did it you did it you did it!" A squeaky voice called out loud and Adora recognized Glimmer. She turned around and before she could see her face she was engulfed in a tight group hug involving everyone.

Well, almost everyone.

"Catra?" She asked weakly, her own legs barely holding her to stand.

Adora remembered leaving her to deal with Hordak and after that all the memories got blurry. She barely remembered her last attack to the Fire Lord and was worried as to what could've had happened to her lover.

Everyone's expressions turned slightly dark, but the only one who replied was Bow, pointing to her body lying on the ground, Mermista desperately using her curative abilities on her and Kamare worriedly holding her head and talking to her.

"She's being taking care of. Hordak really messed her up. Luckily he won't be around anymore to do anything else."

Adora knew what that meant, but she didn't have enough time to process it before surging towards the direction of the girl she loved.

Everyone was so distracted by the scene that they didn't even notice the ruler's body's disappearance.

Adora hurriedly made her way over Catra and once there, dropped on her knees and held the feline's hand tightly. The full moon was starting to rise and its light shimmered on the princess place and dusty face.

"What happened, Adora? She was supposed to be the last resort. Why is my daughter like this?!" The warrior asked with rage, not looking at the Avatar. Her tears fell on Catra's face, wetting her cheeks.

"She- she… Prime had me cornered and threw a lightning at me . Catra just- she jumped in and redirected it, but she was immediately back on her feet, I swear! And then Hordak showed up and then… I don't remember, everything is a huge blur!" Adora turned to Mermista. "Is she gonna make it?"

"If I brought you back from the death in Ba Sing Se, then I can do this as well. Catra had some serious internal bleeding, but I've already solved it. Now, she's just very weakened and I can sense a few broken ribs. Aside from that, she's okay."

Both women released a sigh in relief, and right in that moment, Catra slightly opened her mismatched eyes. "Hi mom." She said weakly, and Kamare released even more tears before gently massaging her daughter's scalp.

Adora didn’t say anything, not wanting to ruin the moment, but Catra managed to steal a smile from her.

“I love you too.” Adora confessed, rubbing her thumb against Catra’s palm gently. “I didn’t say it before because I forgot - y’know, with the war coming to an end. Now I am here though, and I love you. I love you so much, Catra.” Adora felt her own eyes welling up with tears of happiness this time. Catra was alive, she was going to be fine and they would’ve been able to be finally together.

“Okay princess, no need to get all mushy on me. I’m good.” Catra said, trying to hide the creeping blush growing on her face and the tip of her ears. “Are you good? Is everyone okay?”

“Everyone came out of this well and alive. You’re the only one who scared us.” Mermista deadpanned, but the worry on her face was obvious.

“All the airships are down?” The princess asked, and didn’t even notice the rocky ground replacing Kamare’s tights
as a cushion bong for her head.

“No firebender made it to any of the Air Temples, or Ba Sing Se.”

“Is the Fire Lord-?!”

It all happened so fast.

Prime was not dead, he only faked being unconscious, and when presented the opportunity, he vanished in the shadows only to appear once everyone’s defenses were down.

He took the opportunity to charge at Adora behind her back with fire on his hands, but an external force stopped him completely. His mind and body were completely disconnected from one another.

It wasn’t until he saw Kamare’s face that he understood what was going on, what everyone understood.

Bloodbending.

The woman kept her arms and hands rigid, impeding him of movement.

“I won’t let you hurt anyone else in any way ever again.” She moved her left arm upwards, causing for Prime to mimic the same movement, but more exaggerated. His arm cracked and understood her intentions.

“Maybe you got lucky before, but now it’ll be your end.”

The Fire Lord couldn’t breathe anymore and started desperately gasping for air. Kamare wanted to kill him, and she was going to, if only it weren’t for Catra.

The brunette was up on her feet again, rigorously holding onto Adora for support.

“No, I’ve got a punishment that’s far worse than death.” She said weakly as she walked closer to the man who once she considered her family.

“Use bloodbending to close his chi paths so he won’t be able to bend anymore.” She commanded, looking at Prime right in the eyes.

The woman didn’t question her choice, just forced the grown man to kneel before resting her thumb on his forehead. Understanding where the paths were was a bit complicated, but once found, she managed to close them with ease.

Catra silently dismissed her with a nod and smirked devilishly at the fallen villain. “I will lock you down in a rusty cell with your little brother’s body. You will see it rot right before your own very eyes and soon realize that it’s gonna be your same fate. You won’t see the sunlight anymore and it’ll drive you slowly to insanity. Your empire, fell right under your feet.”

She didn’t expect fear, but she also didn’t expect the look on his face. His smile was gentle and the eyes showed fondness for the first time ever.

“I have really taught you well, my beloved daughter. You have finally become the machine I designed you to be. Welcome to the family.”

Catra was trying to put on her ceremonial robes in her room, at her home. Getting ready for the coronation ceremony was very important, so she had to dress up for the occasion. But the injury Prime caused her and that Hordak aggravated still had a tool on her. Every movement or torsion hurt. Luckily she was scheduled with daily healing sessions with Mermista for the time being.

“Ouch!” She hissed quietly after a wrong movement,
and Kamare stepped forward.

“You need some help with that?” She asked, but didn’t actually need an answer since she got to work immediately to aid her.

“Where will you go now?” Catra asked cautiously. They had never talked about the topic before, but it had to be discussed.

“I’m thinking about paying a visit to Razz for a while. This place brings me so many memories of… *him*. The only thing keeping me here right now is you. I hope you’ll understand.”

“I do. I’ll come by to visit you whenever I can.”

“That’s very unlikely, sweetie, but I appreciate the offer.” The woman replied with a sad smile. Being the Fire Lord was a very hard task that required someone’s full time, especially with the

current situation of the country. “I’ll come by from time to time. Maybe monthly visits to check up on you. And if you ever need help you can always send me a letter.” She suggested instead as she wrapped the golden belt around her waist.

“Tell Razz I said hi.” Catra asked with nostalgia in her voice. The old woman really helped her through her spiritual journey and became her friend during those months spent in the cold.

Kamare stepped back and admired the Fire Lord attire that was once sign of terror and then evolved to respect with her daughter.

“I’m proud of you, my fierce warrior.”

As Catra approached the throne room that led to the Coronation Plaza, she noticed Adora standing in front of the closed door, facing her with a kind smile.

Okay Catra, play it cool.

“I can’t believe one year ago I was navigating the desert with you holding me as a prisoner. And now…”

“And now I’m your girlfriend.”

The title still made her face blossom red. It was finally nice to have everything cleared up. No more questions, no more what if’s. They were a couple, they were officially together.

“Yeah, we are girlfriends.”

“I can’t believe a year ago the Rebellion was at its highest. The word is so different now.”

Catra sensed her nervousness -Adora had always panicked when it came to large crowds- so, she put a reassuring hand on her shoulder. “And it’s gonna be even more different… when we’ll build it *together*.”

And a kiss sparked among them. It wasn’t passionate or rushed like all of their previous one. This one was calm, loving and delicate, like a breath of fresh air.

Catra’s hands rested solemnly on her hips while Adora pulled her closer with a tug of her collar, both savoring the sweet taste of love.

“Spirits, I’ve always wanted to do this.” Adora mumbled and Catra chuckled with a raised eyebrow.

“Come on dummy, we don’t wanna miss the ceremony.”

The brunette stepped out first and found the entire plaza full of thousands of people from across all four nations. She was immediately greeted with applause and cheers, but she humbly raised her hand to request silence.

“Please, the real hero is the Avatar.” And in pure Adora fashion, the blonde tripped over her own feet and almost fell on her face if only it weren’t for her airbending saving her just on time.

Catra giggled, but quickly recollected herself to continue her speech.

“I promised myself that I would restore the honor of the Fire Nation, and I will. The road ahead of us is challenging: years of a war led by my own father has left the world scarred and divided. But with the Avatar's help, we can get it back on the right path and begin a new era of love and peace.”

She then kneeled to the ground and a Fire Sage put the Fire Lord’s headpiece into her top knot.

“All hail Fire Lord Catra!”

The group of survivors and monarchs relaxed for the rest of the day, enjoying each other's company, talking and drinking tea that Scorpia made.

Catra and Adora stood alone on the terrace that led to the meeting room where everyone else was, and the Fire Lord noticed something unusual. Bow and Glimmer were being more touchy and affectionate than ever, always hugging and holding hands.

"I think they're onto something." She whispered to her girlfriend suspiciously.

"Catra, they got together the day of Sozin's comet." Adora replied with a chuckle.

"What?! Why did I not know that?"

"You were too busy trying not to die."

"Touché."

The two of them looked at the horizon, the sun was setting, and the sky assumed a beautiful orange coloration. Everything was so peaceful now, no war, no deaths, just them.

"I love you." Adora reminded her with a peck on her cheek that was quickly reciprocated.

"I love you, too."

And when night came, their journey finished. A full life of happiness and prosperity awaited them.

The end.

Chapter End Notes

Aaaaggggghhhh! I can't believe it's over guys! Thank you so much for supporting me through this journey. I REALLLLLLYYYY hope you liked this fic as much as I did writing it. I was thinking that you guys should comment your favorite parts of the story and why you like them so much. That'd be cool, right?

Btw I am aware that I might've left some plotholes, so please, if you have any questions, ask ahead! Perhaps I'll even write small one-shots to answer you and give you more content in the future!

If you want to know about my writing and drawing process, you can follow me on twitter @etheriastribe where you'll also find my CC. You better stay tuned beause I'll be releasing a college au preeeeeetttyyyy soon ;)

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!